FRIDAY
October 30, 2026

DELHI
CITY EDITION
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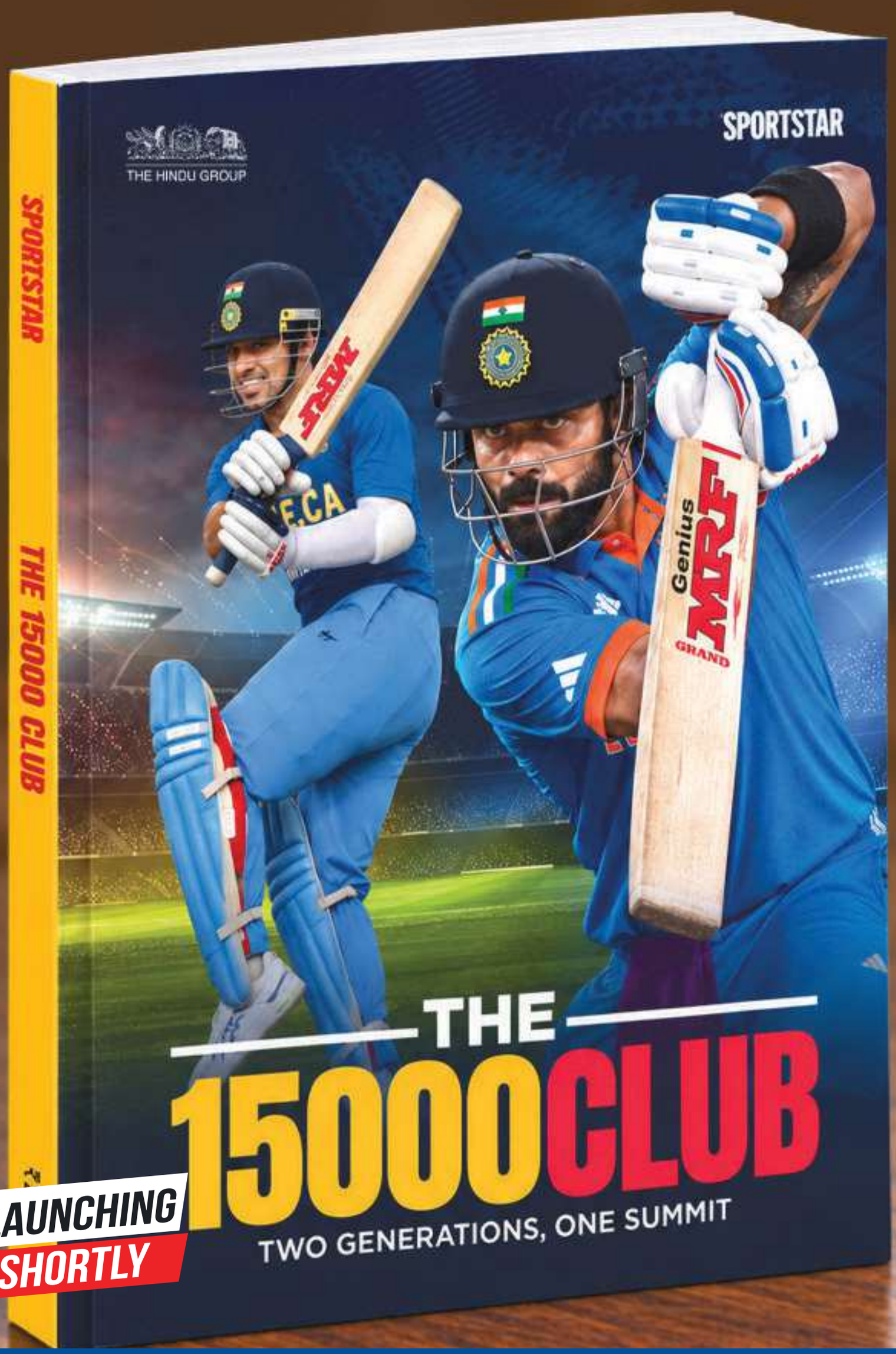
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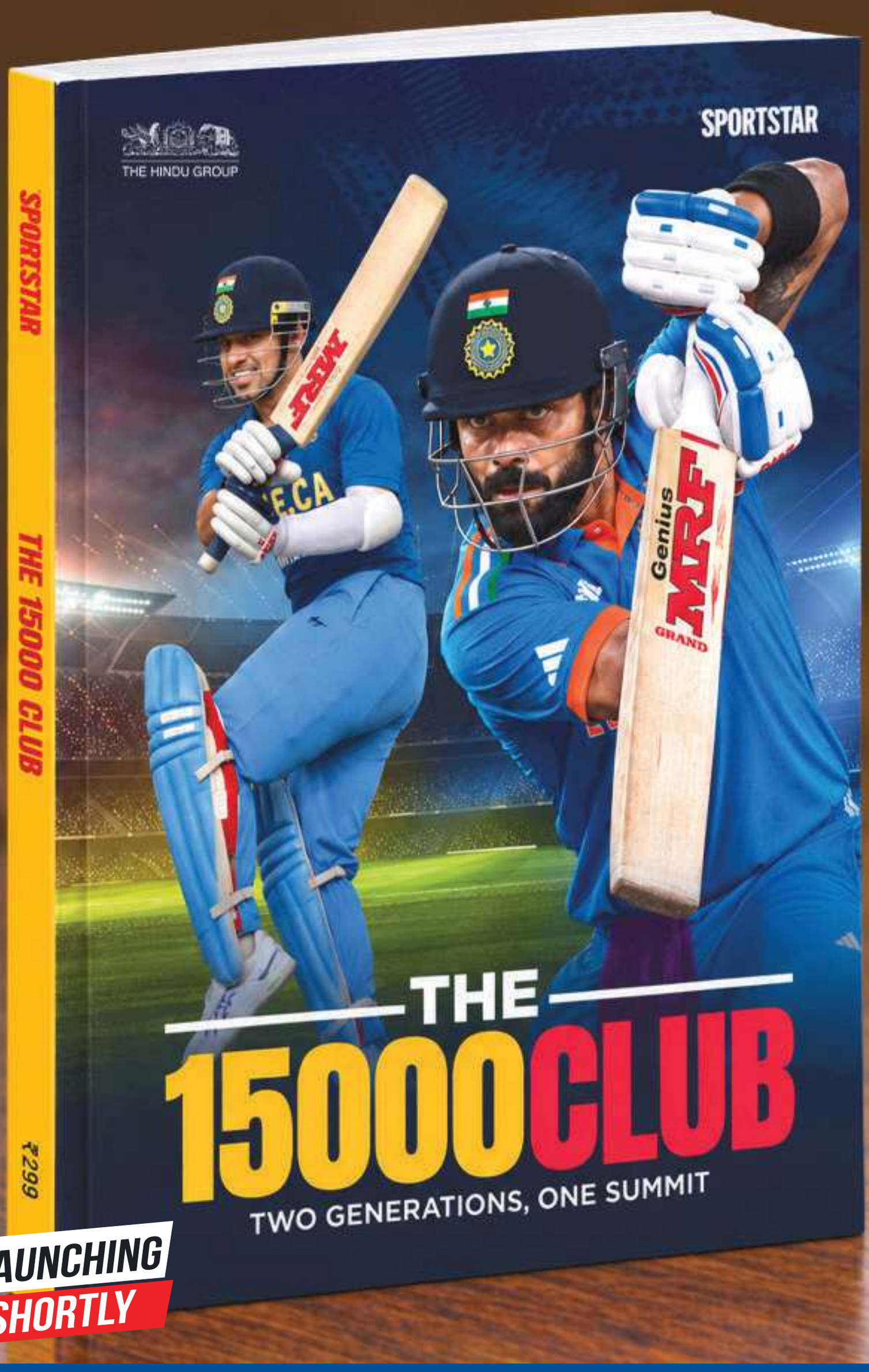
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IN BRIEF



Stir ends as Jamia issues time frame for student polls

NEW DELHI
The Jamia Millia Islamia administration on Thursday agreed to the protesting students' demands to set dates for drafting and approving the students' union constitution and holding polls, following which the protesters called off their 18-day protest. » Page 2

Arunachal: rally seeks release of anti-dam agitators

GUWAHATI
A rally was held in Arunachal Pradesh's capital, Itanagar, on Thursday demanding the release of people detained for opposing the push for a mega dam as a counter to China's hydropower project. » Page 12

SC seeks compensation for digital arrest scam victims

Top court expresses shock that educated people still fall victim to such scams; it seeks details of FIRs in digital arrest cases; court to examine directions proposed by the RBI to curb cyber fraud

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday called upon the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to mandate financial institutions to fully indemnify digital arrest victims if the crime happened from a lack of institutional diligence. Expressing "frustration" at digital arrest scamsters siphoning off crores from the national economy annually, the top court also questioned how educated people remained gullible enough to believe they can be detained over mobile phone calls.

Noting that over ₹800 crore fell into the hands of cyber fraudsters impersonating law enforcement agents in a year, Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant said, "We are really shocked... Why can't people understand? What is the issue with these victims? Are they not normal, sensible people?"

> Why can't people understand? What is the issue with these victims?... What is this fear of arrest? Can they not understand a basic thing that no one can be arrested over a mobile phone call... Just throw your mobile against the wall ...We feel frustrated... Why can't we stop this crime?
> **SURYA KANT**
> Chief Justice of India



The court said it wanted to examine the proposed Reserve Bank of India (Know Your Customer) Amendment Directions, 2026, which are intended to curb cyberfraud. It said systems must be in place within financial institutions to suspend transactions that uncharacteristically deviate from an account's history. Automated alerts of such transactions must be relayed to police authorities, followed by physical verifications and ascertainment of their genuineness, the court said.

The Bench directed the States to provide information on FIRs registered in digital arrest cases and the status of their investigation and prosecution. The court agreed to schedule the case again before November 30.

A visibly anguished CJI said warnings against digital arrest scams were splashed across all media, besides in repeated orders passed by the top court. *Amicus curiae* N.S. Nappinai said even educated people were falling for the trap. "What is this fear of arrest? Can they not understand a basic thing that no one can be arrested over a mobile phone call... Just throw your mobile against the wall," CJI Kant said.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12

Order on fireworks breached 'left and right': apex court

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday said its orders, year after year, to curb and even ban firecrackers during Deepavali, had been violated "left and right".

The right to religious freedom was also subject to public health and the protection of fundamental rights, a Bench of Justices M.M. Sundresh and P.B. Varale said while hearing a case on the increase in pollution as the festival drew near amidst the loud bangs of firecrackers.

Justice Sundresh reminded that Deepavali is called the 'festival of lights', and said the incessant bursting of firecrackers takes a toll on the health of a large section of the population. "The problem might have started with gunpowder," the judge said. "Our orders are breached left and right. How many contempt petitions can be filed? Every year we try to balance it out... But, armed with our orders, pollution still takes place," Justice Sundresh said. "We understand the sentiments of the public. If we think in a logical sense, celebrations do boost morale," he said. The court also empathised with officers' hesitation to book criminal cases against ordinary people who were "enthusiastic" about celebrations.

Justice Sundresh said the court was not in favour of a complete ban. "That may have a spiralling effect. But having said that, please do not push us to take harsh actions," the Bench said.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 12

In Delhi, BJP's BLAs file forms to exclude Muslim voters

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

In north-east Delhi's Mustafabad, 28 voters against whom Form 7 applications were filed to delete their names from the electoral roll during the ongoing claims and objections period as part of the SIR, citing 'absent/permanently shifted' or 'death' as the reason, were found to be living at their addresses during *The Hindu's* visit.

The applications were filed by Chandra Shekhar Nainwal, a BJP-appointed booth-level agent-2, as per the records of the ECI.

Mustafabad has seen the highest number of Form 7 applications. Of the 597 forms filed by third parties, 96% name BLAs from the BJP as 'objectors'; 572 Form 7s filed by these BLAs are against Muslim electors.

DETAILS ON
» PAGE 4

INBRIEF



Manoj Tiwari takes a dip in Yamuna ahead of Chhath Puja

Delhi BJP MP Manoj Tiwari took a dip in the Yamuna on Thursday ahead of Chhath Puja. He claimed that the pollution load in the river had reduced by half over the past year owing to steps undertaken by the Rekha Gupta government and added that the pending projects will be finished in three years. Later in the day, the BJP Delhi unit asked AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal to take a dip in the river to assess the progress of river cleaning. In response, AAP Delhi chief Saurabh Bharadwaj said the stretch from Palla to Wazirabad was cleaner under the previous government. PTI

Three of family killed as car rams tourist bus in Gurugram

A couple and their daughter were killed and their two other children seriously injured when their car rammed the rear of a stationary tourist bus on the Delhi-Vadodara Expressway near Gurugram's Sohna early on Thursday, the police said. The deceased were identified as Bumbum Kumar, a taxi driver, his wife Roopa, and their nine-year-old daughter. The couple's eight-year-old son and one-year-old daughter are said to be out of danger. An FIR has been registered against the bus driver and further investigation is under way, the police said. PTI

Two held for stealing Aadhaar data via fake health camps

Delhi Police has arrested two men from Mathura for allegedly running fake health camps to collect Aadhaar card details from people on the promise of subsidised medicines. The accused, Jitendra Singh, 29, and Brajesh Kumar, 21, used the biometric details to obtain SIM cards, which they then sold to cybercriminals for nearly ₹2,000 each, police said on Thursday. The SIM cards sold by them were found to have been used in more than 20 cases of cybercrime involving fraud amounting to nearly ₹2.64 crore, the police said.

Stir ends at Jamia as administration issues time frame to hold student union elections

Protesters call off agitation on Day 18 after Registrar issues order specifying May 15, 2027 as the deadline to approve constitution for the student body; polls to be held within six weeks of July 16, start of new academic year; physical classes to resume on Monday; notices against protesters to be revoked

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

The Jamia Millia Islamia (JMI) administration on Thursday agreed to the protesting students' demands to set dates for drafting and approving the students' union constitution and holding elections for the same, following which the protesters called off their 18-day agitation.

Vice-Chancellor Mazhar Asif and Registrar Mahtab Alam Rizvi approached the protesters near Gate No. 7 in Gulistan-e-Ghalib lawns and made the announcement, following which celebrations broke out across the campus, which had been closed during the protest demanding the reinstatement of the students' union.



Jamia Millia Islamia students celebrating on Thursday evening. ANI

As per the Registrar's order, the constitution will be drafted and approved by May 15, 2027.

Following the order, the administration directed that classes, which had been shifted online last week, resume in person on November 2. It asked all departments to arrange offline examinations as per their timetables.

The university directed students to strictly adhere to academic rules and regulations, adding that physical attendance would be mandatory.

The development came on JMI's 106th Foundation Day, which the administration and the protesters celebrated separately.

'Democratic process'

Speaking about the composition of the panel that would draft the students' union constitution, the Registrar said, "The drafting committee will not only have faculty members and legal experts but also student representatives so that their views come to us in a democratic manner. We will send the draft to all stakeholders for comments, then submit it to the Academic Council, the Executive Council, and then to the Visitor Nominee for final approval."

He added that after the framework is approved, the university would issue a notification for the elections in accordance with the Lyngdoh Committee recommendations.

The elections will be held within six weeks of July 16, 2027, the beginning of the next academic year.

In his order, Mr. Rizvi stated that all disciplinary notices against students in connection with their participation in the agitation would be revoked.

Police register FIR

Meanwhile, the police registered an FIR, the second since the protest began, against students on Thursday based on a complaint by the administration alleging vandalism on October 27. On the same day, a Special Executive Magistrate remanded two National Students' Union of India (NSUI) members, who were detained outside the campus on Wednesday, in three days' judicial custody. Three others arrested on October 26 were released on Thursday.

Ebin Basil, a third-year student and general secretary of NSUI's Jamia unit, called off his hunger strike, saying, "The university administration has agreed to all the demands we put forward. A special thanks to [IUML MP] Haris Beeran sir. This is a victory for the students and a victory for democracy."

Talking to reporters in the evening, the MP said he met the V-C during the day to convey the students' demands. "The Vice-Chancellor, Registrar, and the Dean held a meeting among themselves. Then they came out and said they have accepted all the demands," he said.

HC declines plea to restore access of worshippers to Race Course mosque

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Thursday declined to direct restoration of worshippers' access to the Race Course mosque in Lutyens' Delhi, which faces threat of demolition, even as the Centre assured the court that no coercive action would be taken against the structure for the time being.

Justice Anish Dayal, while hearing a petition seeking protection for the mosque, noted the demolition work under way around the structure and raised concerns over the safety of worshippers.

"If somebody gets injured, who is going to pay compensation?" he said.

The Central government's counsel, Ashish Dixit, submitted that the authorities would decide on a representation made by the Delhi Waqf Board within four weeks and that no coercive action would be taken in the meantime.

Opposing the plea to allow worshippers access to the mosque, Mr. Dixit said entry to the premises would be unsafe because of the ongoing demolition work. He said access to a temple on the premises had also been restricted.

The court also directed the authorities to file a status report on the demolition activities in the area.

The matter will be taken up for further hearing on December 16.

Govt. to strengthen food safety checks, increase staff, says Gupta

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday said the Delhi government plans to equip the Food Safety Department with modern equipment and additional staff to strengthen checks against food adulteration.

The announcement follows inspections across the city that detected adulterated and substandard food items.



CM Rekha Gupta urged people to report cases of adulteration, poor quality food. X/@GUPTA_REKHA

On Wednesday, the department had seized 948.9 litres of ghee during inspections at Bhogal Market in south-east Delhi, Najafgarh Market in south-west Delhi, and Shiv Vihar in north-east Delhi, the Chief Minister's Office stated.

In a post on X, Ms. Gupta stated that she has "issued instructions to blacklist offending brands, impose heavy fines, cancel licences, register FIRs, and publicly disclose violators' names through advertisements".

She also urged people to report cases of adulteration, substandard food, and sale of expired products to the department's helpline: 1800113921.

'Delhi-NCR, Punjab miss pollution targets by 40-60%'

Nikhil M. Babu
NEW DELHI

Delhi and its adjoining States of Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan, and Punjab have so far implemented just 40-60% of the anti-pollution measures outlined in their annual action plans, according to official sources.

The action plans were submitted by the States to the Commission for Air Quality Management in the National Capital Region (NCR) and Adjoining Areas in January and finalised in February this year.

"All the States have been directed to accelerate their efforts. The current level of actions is not satisfactory, but it is a good start," an official source said.



Delhi recorded 'poor' air quality on Thursday, with air quality index of 229. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Though the plans span the entire year, actions were supposed to be completed in phased deadlines.

While some have been completed, several deadlines have been missed, the source said. The States had been directed to execute a major portion of the action plans by October 31, ahead of the seasonal spike in air pollution.

According to official data, the air quality index in Delhi and its neighbouring cities has already dipped to the "poor" and "very poor" categories, and is expected to deteriorate further in the coming days.

'Rajasthan worst, U.P. best'

"Rajasthan is the worst performer and U.P. is the best as per data updated till September 30. This is as per weighted average of actions taken by the States, with more weight given to concrete actions taken to reduce air pollution. The redevelopment of bad roads is one area in which all States have not done that well as almost all States have not completed even 50% of the target," an official said.

The action plans are comprehensive strategies covering vehicular emissions, dust mitigation, crop residue management, and other areas, each carrying specific deadlines. Punjab, which is not part of the NCR, is the only exception as its action plan was strictly limited to controlling stubble burning.

3,000 personnel to secure Ramlila Maidan for Nov. 1 INDIA bloc protest

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Security preparations are under way for the Opposition INDIA bloc's November 1 'Chalo Dilli' event at Ramlila Maidan.

Delhi Police will deploy over 3,000 personnel and instal more than 200 CCTV cameras, including AI-enabled surveillance systems, ahead of the protest, an officer said.

The venue, which will host its first major demonstration since the denotification of Jantar Mantar as a protest site on October 11, has been divided into 14 zones to manage protesters.

Control rooms are being set up near the venue, which will also see police personnel equipped with body-worn cameras and vehicles mounted with surveillance systems, the officer said.

On Thursday, workers could be seen setting up the stage, erecting tents, and placing chairs at Ramlila Maidan.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (Central) Rohit Rajbir Singh visited the site to inspect security arrangements.

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OA NO 448/2025 DATE: 21.08.2026
STATE BANK OF INDIA ..APPLICANT
VERSUS
D R SHARMA FUEL CENTRE & ORS. ..RESPONDENT
To,
DEFENDANT
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D/W/S/O- Chaman Singh Khiwai Baraut Road KH NO 903 MEERUT UP 250344 Meerut, UTTAR PRADESH -250344
(2) SHRI CHAMAN SINGH
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(3) SMT ASHA KHIWAI BARAUT ROAD, KHASRA NO 903, MEERUT, UP
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Whereas the above named applicant (s) has / have instituted a case for recovery of Rs. 43,83,831/- (RUPEE FORTY THREE LAKH EIGHTY THREE THOUSAND EIGHT HUNDRED THIRTY ONE ONLY) against you and where as it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance in the Tribunal on 17.12.2026 At 11.00 A.M.
Take notice that in default of your appearance on the day before the mentioned, the case will be heard and determined in your absence.
All the matters will be taken up through Video Conferencing or Physical and for that purpose:-
(i) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the "Cisco Webex" application / software;
(ii) "Meeting ID" and Password for the date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Hon'ble Presiding officer/Registrar shall be displayed in the daily cause list itself at DRT Official Portal i.e. drt.gov.in.
(iii) In any exigency the Advocate/ Litigants can contact the concerned official at Ph. No. 23748478.
Given under my hand and seal of the Tribunal this the 21st day of Aug., 2026
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LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF THE SUBORDINATE JUDGE COURT ARUPPUKOTTAI
O.S. NO. 346/2025
Shahul Hameed
Ali Akbar
- Plaintiffs
-VS-
1.Mr. MAHESH DUTT, S/o. SIL SHANKAR DUTT, Aged not known, R/O 67-B POCKER 2, PASCHIMPURI, NEW DELHI
2.Mr. LALIT SHARMA, S/o.SH. RAMGOPAL SHARMA, Aged not known, 21, BEECHPATTI, PILKUWA DT., GHAZIABAD, (U.P) UTTAR PRADESH
3.Mr. PRATAP SINGH GUSAIN, S/o. Mr. DAULAT SINGH GUSAIN, Aged not known, Door No. 176/3, GALI, No. 03, NEAR RELIANCE TOWER, RAHUL VIHAR- 1, AKBARPUR, BEHRAMPUR, GHAZIABAD, U.P. 201 002
4.Mr. HEMANT SHARMA, S/o. SHRI G.L. SHARMA, Aged not known, B1-46, MULTANIPURA COLONY, MODINAGAR DISTRICT, GHAZIABAD, (U.P)
1 to 4 Defendants
PUBLIC NOTICE
It is hereby informed that the plaintiffs have filed an application before the Court of the Subordinate Judge at Aruppukottai in the above-mentioned Suit O.S. NO. 346/2025. The said application to be taken up for hearing on 30th November 2026 at 10:00 A.M. The concerned parties are directed to appear before the court either in person or through their advocates at the specified time. In the event of non appearance the matter may be proceeded with in their absence, and appropriate orders may be passed in accordance with law.
B. KANNAN, B.A., B.L
ADVOCATE
ARUPPUKOTTAI-626101

AUTOMOTIVE

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• JANAKPURI B-1/2, Main Najafgarh Road,Opp. Metro Pillar 543
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Bengal govt. bars newly appointed teachers from political activities

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Newly appointed teachers in State-run and government-aided schools will no longer be able to engage in political activities and contest elections in West Bengal. The decision was taken at a Cabinet meeting led by Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Wednesday.

"From today onwards, all the new teachers who will be appointed through the School Service Commission will not be able to participate in any direct politics," he said.

Mr. Adhikari, however, clarified that the decision will not affect teachers who are working at present and are involved in politics or have been elected as public representatives.

The CM said the decision will not affect teachers who are working at present and involved in politics

Five Ministers led by the CM himself, including School Education Minister Dipak Barman, have been teachers before switching to active politics.

The move, aimed at improving quality of education in the schools, has sparked criticism by several teachers' associations.

"The government cannot keep teachers and education workers away from politics because they are not government employees," said Swapan Mandal, general secretary of the Bengal Teachers and Education Workers' Association.

Chandan Maiti, general secretary of Advanced Society for Headmasters' Association, urged the government to reconsider the decision.

Congress and Communist Party of India (Marxist) leaders also criticised the decision. "If this initiative is implemented, it will face legal challenges in the courts," senior Congress leader Pradip Bhattacharya said.

CPI(M) leader Sujan Chakraborty raised questions on the poor teacher-student ratio in government schools. "The main job of teachers is to teach. However, they are being used to do 'non-teaching work' like SIR or census. The government should pay attention to that instead."

Timings
DELHI

FRIDAY, OCT. 30			
RISE	06:31	SET	17:38
RISE	21:19	SET	11:02
SATURDAY, OCT. 31			
RISE	06:32	SET	17:37
RISE	22:28	SET	11:58
SUNDAY, NOV. 01			
RISE	06:33	SET	17:37
RISE	23:36	SET	12:47

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	25	19
Safdarjang	25	19
Palam	24	18

Delhi Palam Today
28°C The weather will be comfortable. Night will be slight cool. Chances of light rain and thundershower with gusty winds.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
30°C Morning will be cool with mist and haze. Day will be sight warm. Night also will be pleasant. Dry weather to occur.

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THE HINDU
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West Bengal tightens cracker rules ahead of Deepavali and Chhath

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

The West Bengal government on Thursday announced that it will take strict action against people violating the firecracker norms during Deepavali and Chhath Puja. The police have also arrested one man for wrongfully hoarding banned crackers and recovered around 110 kg crackers.

A *suo motu* case was registered by the police at the Burrabazar police station after which 19-year-old Md. Toufiq was arrested.

State Director General of Police Siddhi Nath Gupta said people will not be allowed to use sky lanterns without proper permission from the fire department. "They can be sold, bought, and used, but if you want to use them, get permission," he said.

The police also said only green crackers will be allowed and that they have methods to ensure sellers do not have fake green cracker labels on their products. Home Secretary Sanghamitra Ghosh urged limited use of green crackers. She also urged people to comply with the pollution control regulations and said they have launched an awareness campaign on polluting crackers.

She said the decibel limit was 125 and 90 for sound-emitting and light-emitting crackers respectively. On Deepavali, the time limit for bursting crackers is between 8 p.m. and 10 p.m. and on Chhath Puja from 6 a.m. to 8 a.m.

Azam Khan, son get bail in dual PAN cards case

Press Trust of India
PRAYAGRAJ

The Allahabad HC on Thursday granted bail to Samajwadi Party leader Azam Khan and his son Mohd. Abdullah Azam Khan in the 'fake' passport and dual PAN cards case. The court also suspended their sentence but refused to stay the conviction.

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INBRIEF



Aaditya opposes floating hoardings along waterfronts

Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Aaditya Thackeray has sought Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis's intervention against "floating hoardings" in Mumbai's seas, calling the decision to permit them highly irresponsible and warning that it would ruin the city's aesthetics. The Mumbai Maritime Board has decided to allow floating advertisements on barges along prominent waterfronts in the city. Mr. Thackeray said there has to be a hoarding policy to regulate LED hoardings that inconvenience citizens at night and limit their numbers. "Aesthetics over cartels must be the norm, but sadly this decision chooses contractors over aesthetics," he said. PTI

Punjab election: BJP seeks early MCC implementation

Punjab BJP leader Sunil Jakhar on Thursday wrote to the Punjab Governor, urging him to recommend to the Election Commission early implementation of the model code of conduct (MCC) in the State, alleging "deteriorating" law and order situation. In a letter to Governor Gulab Chand Kataria, Mr. Jakhar said the State government denied permission to hold an anti-drug marathon in Abohar, citing the prevailing law and order situation. "I wish to draw your attention to Punjab's deteriorating law and order situation, which the Bhagwant Mann government has now itself acknowledged by denying permission even for a marathon event," Mr. Jakhar wrote. PTI

In Delhi, BJP's BLAs file forms to exclude long-time Muslim voters

Party agents submit Form 7s as 'objector' seeking deletions in Mustafabad, which has seen highest number of such applications, all against Muslim voters

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

Sajid Hussain has lived at the same address in the Dayalpur neighbourhood of north-east Delhi's Mustafabad for over two decades. But on Wednesday, the tailor was shocked to learn that Form 7 applications have been filed to delete the names of his son and wife from Delhi's electoral roll during the ongoing claims and objections period as part of special intensive revision (SIR).

Mr. Hussain said he had never heard the name of the person who filed the Form 7s against his son, Asad Raza Zaidi, and wife, Afsana Khatoon. The two were among the 28 voters in the neighbourhood against whom deletions were sought, citing 'absent/permanently shifted' or 'death' as the reason. The applications were all filed by Chandra Shekhar Nainwal, a Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-appointed booth-level agent-2, as per the records of the Election Commission of India (ECI).

However, all 28 electors were found to be living at their addresses during *The Hindu's* visit. All had submitted enumeration forms and were present on the draft electoral roll published on August 31. *The Hindu* met and spoke to 19 of them or their immediate family members who had valid identity proofs, and none had heard Mr. Nainwal's name before.

No notice received

These were the only Form 7s filled in polling booth 129; of these, 18 were listed on the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO)'s daily objections list (Form 10) on October 25, nine on October 21, and one on October 19. These electors have yet to receive a notice generated after an objection is received by the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) and displayed on Form 10.

In the building next to Mr. Hussain's house, Abdul Jabbar's 22-year-old son Mohd. Huzefa and daughter Ayesha's names also featured on the deletion list. Mr. Huzefa identified another familiar name, Ummed Ali, their long-time neighbour who runs a small grocery store.

Similar patterns emerged in other areas of the Mustafabad constituency, where electors' names were sought to be deleted even though they lived at their given addresses.



Afsana Khatoon, left, and Zaheer Ali, against whom Form 7s have been filed during Delhi SIR, in Mustafabad. SURUCHI KUMARI

The Mustafabad constituency has seen the highest number of Form 7 applications, with 843 objections since August 31. Of the 597 forms filed by third parties, 96% name BLAs from the BJP as 'objectors'; 572 Form 7s filed by these BLAs are against Muslim electors across 24 parts of the constituency.

BLAs exceed cap

Ten BLAs, so far, have filed more than 30 Form 7s and nine over 25 applications despite the ECI's October 9 directive mandating a cap of 10 such forms an individual elector can file online and offline. While BLA-2s are permitted to submit 'bulk' forms not exceeding 10 a day, including Forms 6, 7 and 8 filled by other individual electors, they are required to submit a list of such applications along with an undertaking that they have verified the details. However, in all these cases, the BLAs themselves filed the forms as 'objectors'.

"If the BLA is not submitting the forms with the BLA undertaking, and fills them as an 'objector,' then the rules and limits of an individual elector will apply to him," said a senior official. The ECI had also stated the same in a reply to a query sent by the Bengal CEO.

In all these 572 Form 7s against Muslim electors, including those filed by Shashi (42 applications), Raman (35), Manoj Kumar (33) Mohan Madan (33), Sawar Singh (32) Raj Kumar (31), Himanshu (31), Kapil (30), Nitin Kumar (30), Robin Singh Dhama (30), Neeraj Sharma (29), Abhishek Mishra (28), the officials confirmed that all the objectors were registered as BLAs in their records and that "no BLA undertaking has ever been received with these forms".

"BLAs hand these forms to the Booth Level Officers (BLOs), who submit them in the office," said an official. One such form accessed by *The Hindu*, handfilled by Nitin Kumar, did not mention that he was a BLA; the form was also not in the format prescribed for a BLA. In its October 9 directive, the ECI had said that "in case the ERO finds that the complaint is false/fabricated, he shall proceed to take action against the applicant who has knowingly made false statement or declaration in writing in the Form 7 as per the provisions of RP Act."

'Targeting us'

Back in Dayalpur, Mr. Hussain is still flummoxed. "How can only two members of my family move out? There are eight members in my family, and all of us are registered at this address for decades. What kind of joke is this?" he said.

While 25-year-old Zaidi was away for work, Ms. Khatoon said she was at home at all times. "We had given our forms to the BLO when she was here. Then some notice was also served for which we gave our documents. Will we have to submit some documents again," she asked.

Meanwhile, for Zaheer Ali, 76, the reason cited for deletion was 'death'. Shama Parveen, one of his family members, said, "We are being targeted probably because of our identities. We don't see any other reason because we don't know the objector personally."

'Here since birth'

Mohd. Salaman Siddiquie was away at work, but his brother, Mohd. Suleman, said they have been living in the same house for the past three decades, and in the area since they were born. Shagufta Khatoon, his sister, and Ikhlak, his brother-in-law who lived next door, were also present in the list of names.

Double defeat of double engine, says Akhilesh as SP wins 5 of 11 MLC seats

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Samajwadi Party (SP) chief Akhilesh Yadav on Thursday described the Bharatiya Janata Party's (BJP) performance in the Uttar Pradesh Legislative Council elections as "double defeat of the double-engine government" and said the results signify a growing wave of discontent among the State's people against the ruling party.

The BJP won six of the 11 seats while the SP emerged victorious in five, including two seats in Varanasi, with the results of two pending seats officially declared on Thursday afternoon. Both the seats went to the SP.

In a post on X, Mr. Yadav said the BJP lost the Varanasi Graduates' constituency in the initial counting and the recounting. "This is a double defeat of the double engine. The BJP's defeat has set the stage for the Uttar Pradesh Assembly election to be held in 2027," he said.



SP chief Akhilesh Yadav said the U.P. MLC polls proved that the Oppn. gained ground when voting was done using ballot papers. FILE PHOTO

Mr. Yadav said, "The BJP's defeat was the defeat of its policies concerning teachers, students and education, and the educated unemployed graduates also delivered their verdict against the party."

He said the way the BJP caused distress, suffering and humiliation across social groups brought together all those who felt aggrieved.

Mr. Yadav also alleged irregularities in the seats won by the BJP and claimed that the results have triggered an existential crisis within the ruling party and its internal rifts have intensified.

The SP won five seats with its candidates Kanti Singh (Lucknow Division), Lal Bihari Yadav (Varanasi Division), Akash Agarwal (Agra Division), Asutosh Sinha (Varanasi Division) and Man Singh Yadav (Jhansi-Prayagraj) getting elected. In the previous MLC polls held in 2020, the party won only three seats.

The Congress said the victory of the Opposition in five seats signals the resentment against BJP among all sections of society.

'EVM vs ballot papers'

The results have also ignited the old 'EVM vs ballot paper' debate. Elections for 11 Graduates' and Teachers' constituencies seats were held using ballot papers.

After the results, BJP State chief Pankaj Chaudhary targeted the Congress and said, "The BJP has retained its seats... but the parties demanding ballot papers could not muster the courage to contest the elections." In response, the SP said, "The U.P. MLC polls proved that the Opposition gained ground when voting was done by ballot papers."

(With inputs from PTI)

MVA secures 3 of 5 Maharashtra MLC seats; Congress trumps BJP in Nagpur

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

The Opposition Maha Vikas Aghadi (MVA) on Thursday won three of the five Graduates' and Teachers' constituencies where polling for the Maharashtra Legislative Council elections was held on October 23.

With the ruling Mahayuti securing only two seats, cracks surfaced in the coalition within hours of the results. The BJP accused ally Shiv Sena of "non-cooperation" and "undermining the combine". The Mahayuti comprises the BJP, Shiv Sena, and the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) while the MVA consists of the Congress, Shiv Sena (UBT), and NCP (SP).

After vote counting, which began on Tuesday morning, stretched for over 40 hours and concluded in the early hours of Thursday, Congress candidate Abhijeet Wanjari retained the Nagpur Graduates' seat by defeating BJP's Sudhakar Kohale by 3,271 votes. The result holds significance as Nagpur is home to Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, Union Minister Nitin Gadkari, and the RSS headquarters. This is the second consecutive defeat for the BJP in Nagpur. The party had held the seat for 58 years before losing it to the Congress in 2020.



Congress's Abhijeet Wanjarri with supporters after winning in the Nagpur Division Graduates' constituency on Thursday. PTI

NCP (SP) candidates won the other two seats for the MVA - Pune Graduates' and Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar Graduates'. For the Mahayuti, BJP's Kaustubh Gawade won the Pune Teachers' constituency while Shiv Sena candidate Kiran Sarnaik secured the Amravati Teachers' seat.

Reacting to the verdict, State Congress president Harshwardhan Sapkal said, "The illusionary bubble of [Prime Minister Narendra] Modi and [Chief Minister Devendra] Fadnavis has burst. Despite having money and muscle power, the BJP stood defeated."

The Opposition targeted the BJP over its "arrogance" and "overconfidence", citing a post on X that Mr. Fadnavis deleted. The Congress shared a screenshot of the post in which the CM, responding to Mr. Modi's query on how many seats the Congress won in the polls held using ballot paper, allegedly said the party got a "big zero".

Blame game

Meanwhile, the blame game between BJP and Shiv Sena intensified. "In Pune and Nagpur, Sena did not provide the expected cooperation. Driven by greed for one seat in Pune, the Sena put its allies in a spot and squandered the opportunity to win three seats," BJP spokesperson Navnath Ban said. Hitting back, Shiv Sena leader Anand Paranjpe said there was "complete lack of coordination" on seat sharing from Day 1.

Accused men paraded shirtless in Kolkata: NHRC seeks report

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) on Thursday took suo motu cognisance of reports where three accused were paraded in semi-nude condition in city's Behala area and issued a notice to the Commissioner of Kolkata Police, calling for a detailed report on the matter within two weeks.

'Violation of rights'

The commission observed that the contents of the news reports, "if true, raise serious issues of violation of human rights".

"A day before, an 18-year-old youth and his friend, who were reportedly seen with a minor girl, were beaten and humiliated by the girl's family at her house. The youth's father, whom the girl's family summoned, was also assaulted. Subsequently, all three were stripped and forced to walk naked on the road at gunpoint," a press release by the commission stated.

The Kolkata Police on October 27 paraded two of accused who harassed the trio through the same neighbourhood in shorts, without shirts and with ropes tied around their waists, during a reconstruction of the alleged crime.

Civil rights organisations raised questions on the conduct of the police saying that police were trying to "normalise revenge".

'Mother of the world': citing Manusmriti, court gives life term to 3 for cow slaughter

Press Trust of India
GANDHINAGAR

Through a 2017 amendment, Gujarat govt. had enhanced punishment for slaughter of cows

A court in Gujarat's Gandhinagar district has sentenced three persons to life imprisonment in a cow slaughter case after they were found in possession of 277 kg of beef, citing Hindu scriptures to underscore the religious significance of the cow.

Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi hailed the verdict, calling it a clear message that the law will never spare those who commit cow slaughter in the State.

In his judgment on Monday, Additional Sessions Judge B.R. Rajput also imposed a fine of ₹3 lakh on the convicts, Vasim Qureshi, Mohammad Rafiq Qureshi, and Asfaq Bahelim. Quoting the Manusmriti, an ancient Sanskrit text, the court observed that the cow is not merely an animal but is regarded as a pillar of material prosperity and 'dharma' (righteousness).

"Sage Manu entrusted the primary responsibility for the protection and care of cattle to the 'Vaishya' class. Furthermore, in the context of 'Arsha Vivaha' (a traditional form of Vedic marriage), the pair - a cow and a bull - holds special significance," the judge said.

Further quoting the Vedas and other Hindu scriptures, the court said that when drops of 'amrita' (nectar) fell to the earth through the power of penance, the divine cow Kamadhenu emerged and came to be regarded as the progenitor of all bovine species on earth.

'Four legs, four vedas'

"The cow is regarded as the 'mother of the world', serving as an abode for 33 crore deities. Her four legs are symbolic of the four Vedas, the court said.

According to the prosecution, six persons were arrested with 277 kg of beef and tools allegedly used to slaughter cows and buffaloes and a vehicle meant to transport the meat after a raid on a house in Jamla village of Gandhinagar district on August 22, 2024.The prosecution said a father-son duo would purchase weak or non-lactating cows and buffaloes. They would then bring four individuals from Ahmedabad to their home and have the animals slaughtered in a cruel manner for beef, all for the sake of financial gain. Citing the investigation, the prosecution said the accused intended to sell the beef to one Ghulam Moin. After the trial, the court found three of the six men guilty.

Through a 2017 amendment to the Gujarat Animal Preservation Act, 1954, the Gujarat government had enhanced punishment for those found guilty of cow slaughter to life imprisonment, making it the first State to do so.

Stalin seeks T.N. CM Vijay's apology over detention of academic

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI



A. Kalaiyarasan

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Thursday condemned the brief detention of Kalaiyarasan, an associate assistant professor at the Madras Institute of Development Studies, on Wednesday. Mr. Stalin claimed the academic was detained for highlighting the unprecedented price rise, describing it as the height of the TVK's "fascist attitude". He said Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay and the police department must apologise.

Questioning the grounds for detention, Mr. Stalin asked whether Prof. Kalaiyarasan was targeted for highlighting the achievements of the 'Dravidian Model' government and exposing the price rise under the TVK regime.

The TVK denied any "political vendetta" and said it was not related to his remarks on price rise. In a post on X, TVK spokesperson Vivek Gananathan condemned the use of Mr. Kalaiyarasan's photograph on a fake social media account to post obscene comments.

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Kerala HC directs police not to arrest judge in car crash probe

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Kerala High Court on Thursday directed the police not to arrest an additional district judge, father of the 17-year-old boy who drove the car involved in a car accident at Cheranalloor, near here, until further orders.

Justice Kauser Edappagath orally remarked that the court could not succumb to public opinion, saying that "the law has to be strictly followed".

The court allowed the family members of the victim to be added as parties to the anticipatory bail petition moved by the judge.

The court held that since the petitioner was a serving judicial officer, there was no question that he would abscond.

Senior lawyer P. Vijayabhanu argued for the petitioner that he had cooperated with the probe. He contended that he was unaware that his son had taken the vehicle from his house, and only realised it upon receiving a call.

The State, represented by special government pleader C. Rasheed, contended that within 30 minutes of receiving the call, the judge and his wife had reached the site, and remained there for an hour to tamper with evidence.

Naidu puts cyclone loss at ₹4,600 cr.

Central team to visit worst-hit districts of Konaseema and West Godavari today; A.P. requests Telangana to send 1,000 staff for power restoration work; announces compensation for coconut and oil palm growers; IMD forecasts another depression

The Hindu Bureau
VIJAYAWADA

Andhra Pradesh has suffered an estimated loss of ₹4,600 crore due to Cyclone Arnab, as per the government's preliminary assessment, Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu said on Thursday.

Mr. Naidu made an aerial survey of cyclone-hit areas in the Krishna and Godavari regions. He inspected the areas on the way to Cheyyeru village in Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema district, one of the worst-affected areas.

Seven dead

After interacting with flood victims at Gacchakayala Pora village, Mr. Naidu told the media that the cyclone preparedness had helped check the loss of lives. Seven people had died in cyclone-triggered incidents in the State.

The Chief Minister said that he had briefed Union Home Minister Amit Shah about the cyclone damage. "A Central team will arrive in Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema and West Godavari districts on Friday to assess the damage," he said.

He said the State had requested Telangana to depute 1,000 staff to ensure speedy restoration of power supply.

"If need be, we will request Tamil Nadu and Karnataka to send 2,000 personnel for the power restoration work, mostly in the Godavari region. Power restoration work will be finished quickly, and the supply will resume by Saturday," Mr. Naidu said, adding that at least 8,000 electric poles were uprooted in Konaseema district alone. Machines would be brought from other States to ensure speedy installation of poles, he said.



Battered crop: A farmer shows banana plants damaged by Cyclone Arnab at Tadepalli mandal in Guntur district on Thursday. G.N. RAO

"A compensation of ₹1,500 will be given for each coconut and oil palm tree that fell under the influence of the cyclone. The compensation and input subsidy will be decided after the enumeration of the damage to crops," the CM said.

A ₹25-kg rice bag and cash would be given to the families who were shifted to relief camps.

More rain likely

The State may see another spell of heavy rain from November 1, as a low-pressure area formed over the south Andaman Sea may strengthen over the next three days. According to the India Metereological Department, Amaravati, the low-pressure area will move west-northwestwards and concentrate into a depression over the southeast Bay of Bengal and adjoining areas of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands around October 31. Thereafter, it is likely to intensify, and continue to move west-northwestwards towards the Andhra coast. The system is likely to bring heavy rainfall to the coastal places on November 1 and 2.

No U.P. govt. jobs for those seeking change 'through violent means'

The Hindu Bureau
LUCKNOW

Uttar Pradesh has revised character verification norms for candidates selected through direct recruitment in government jobs, making individuals "associated with organisations seeking to change the existing social or political system through violent means" ineligible.

The revised guidelines, issued by Principal Secretary (Appointment and Personnel) M. Devaraj on Wednesday, apply to government departments, public sector corporations, boards, and urban and rural local bodies. The government has clarified that political ideology alone cannot be grounds for disqualification.

The guidelines also provide that if a candidate has participated in violent activities or activities aimed at changing the existing system within three years preceding the verification date, after attaining the age of 21, it may be presumed that the person continues to be actively involved.

The policy also states that the filing of an FIR or a pending investigation will not automatically disqualify a candidate. It clarified that delays in receiving character verification reports need not delay the issuance of appointment letters. "However, if a candidate is found ineligible or to have furnished false information, the appointment will be cancelled," the guidelines state.

(With inputs from PTI)

Top court axes Karnataka law validating 'corrupt' hiring

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday declared unconstitutional a Karnataka State law, which validated the 2011 selection of Gazetted Probationers made through what the court described as a "corrupt" and "blatantly nepotistic" recruitment process conducted by the State Public Service Commission.

A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran held that the Karnataka Civil Services (Validation of Selection and Appointment of 2011 Batch Gazetted Probationers) Act, 2022, was enacted clearly with the intent to countermand the judgments of both the Karnataka High Court and the Supreme Court. The courts had upheld the decision to cancel the entire 2011 recruitment process for 362 posts of Group 'A' and 'B' Officers.

Eight Keralam panchayats to revive *surangam*

The Hindu Bureau
KASARAGOD

A comprehensive project to rejuvenate Keralam's traditional underground water tunnels, known as "*surangams*", is set to be implemented in eight grama panchayats in Kasaragod district to improve groundwater recharge, conserve rainwater, and maintain water flow in rivers amid declining rainfall and increasing drought risks.

The project will initially cover Kayyur-Cheemeni, Kodom-Belur, Kallar, Pallikkara, Bedadka, Puthige, Chengala and Kumbla grama panchayats. The project will make extensive use of workers under the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin).

Surangams are a distinctive traditional water harvesting system found in Kasaragod. They are horizontal tunnels excavated into laterite hills.

GOVERNMENT OF MADHYA PRADESH
DEPARTMENT OF TECHNICAL EDUCATION, SKILL DEVELOPMENT & EMPLOYMENT
(Directorate of Skill Development)

CAMP OFFICE, 4th FLOOR, GAS RAHAT ITI BUILDING, BHOPAL - 462023
Website: https://dsd.mp.gov.in | https://mptenders.gov.in | Email: pmsetu.mp@mp.gov.in
S.NO. / DSD / PMSETU / RFP / 2026 / 1610 / Bhopal: Date 22.10.26

TENDER NOTICE FOR INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS (RFPS)

The Directorate of Skill Development, Government of Madhya Pradesh, invites separate online proposals for selection of Anchor Industry Partners (AIPs) for upgradation, operation and management of Government ITI clusters under Component-I of Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) scheme.

RFPs have been released for the following clusters with Tender ID on mptenders portal: Indore - 2026_MPDSD_544821_1, Ujjain - 2026_MPDSD_518842_2, and Rewa - 2026_MPDSD_518846_3.

Particular	Date / Details
RFP release date	23/10/2026
Last date for queries / clarification requests	30/10/2026
Pre-Bid Meeting	03/11/2026, 11:30 a.m. Conference Hall, Directorate of Skill Development, M.P., 4th Floor, Gas Rahat ITI Building, Raisen Road, Govindpura, Bhopal
Last date for bid submission	13/11/2026
Opening of Technical Bids	16/11/2026
Opening of Financial Bids	Will be communicated separately

Mode of submission: Online through the MP State Tender Portal at https://mptenders.gov.in. Bidders shall submit separate proposals for each cluster in accordance with the respective RFP. The respective RFP documents, eligibility and qualification requirements, formats, scope, cluster details, and instructions available on the portal shall govern the bidding process. Any corrigendum, addendum, clarification or change in schedule shall be published on the portal.

Director
Directorate of Skill Development
Government of Madhya Pradesh

G20669/26

RAJASTHAN HOUSING BOARD

No. :- 196 Dated :- 28/10/2026

NIB : 04/2026-27

Bid for 1. Construction of OHSR, Providing & Laying of Water Supply Distribution Network in Zone 1, Zone 2 and Zone 3, Shiv Badi, Bikaner 2. Sewerage Project For Proposed SRS 1041 Houses, Sector 3 and 4, Badli Housing Scheme, Jodhpur 3.Construction of Rematting and Carpeting work at Manpur Housing Scheme Aburoad at Sector 1, 2 and Sector Part 3) are invited from interested bidders from 30.10.2026 to 18.11.2026 upto 06:00 PM. Other particulars of Bids are available on the procurement portal **(https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in & sppp.rajasthan.gov.in)** of the State and RHB's website **www.rhb.rajasthan.gov.in.**

UBN No. :- RHB2627WLOB00208, RHB2627WSOB00209 & 210

Raj.Samwad/C/26/12652 **Addl. Chief Engineer-II, Jodhpur**

BHARAT COKING COAL LIMITED
(A Mini Ratna Company)
(A Subsidiary of Coal India Limited)

NOTICE

All the tenders issued by Bharat Coking Coal Limited (B.C.C.L.) for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on website of **B.C.C.L. "www.bcclweb.in"** Coal India Limited (CIL) e-procurement portal **"https://coalindiatenders.nic.in"** and Central Public Procurement portal **"https://eprocure.gov.in"** In addition, procurement is also done through GeM portal **"https://gem.gov.in".** This is applicable to all Open (Domestic/Global) Tenders issued through e-procurement portal of CIL.

THE HINDU TeenDigest TD
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THE HINDU GROUP

Children's Day Special Issue

This Children's Day, celebrate curiosity, imagination, and the unforgettable journey called childhood.

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- What if children made all the rules?
- What if the world had no colours?
- What if numbers disappeared tomorrow?

REMEMBERING PANDIT NEHRU
A pictorial journey through the life and legacy of India's beloved Chacha Nehru.

FIRST EXPERIENCES THAT CHANGED LIVES: REAL STORIES FROM YOUNG PEOPLE
- Facing financial hardship
- Learning from failure
- Finding a place to belong

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SCAN TO SUBSCRIBE

HOSUR CITY MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
GENERAL FUND 2026-2027
TENDER NOTICE - FORM OF CONTRACT: ITEM RATE (TWO COVER SYSTEM)

Bids are invited in Two cover system for the following below Works in Online Hosur City Municipal Corporation.

S. No.	Name of Work	Value put to tender (Rs. in Cr)	Period of completion
1	Selection of Service provider for Collection & Transportation of solid Waste through various activities to the Designated Processing Facility/ Dump Site / Depositing Centres and operation and Maintenance of Micro Composting Centres(MCCs) in Hosur City Municipal Corporation for 18 months	**50.71**	**18 Months**

2. The bid documents will be available **from 30.10.2026.** The bid documents can be downloaded from the website https://tntenders.gov.in at free of cost.
3. Bid documents can be downloaded **upto 3.00 PM on 30.11.2026**. Online submission of tender is only accepted.
4. Amount of Earnest Money Deposit will be 1% of the estimate value
5. Any additional / further details and conditions related to this tender can be had from the office of the Hosur City Municipal Corporation on all working days during office hours and Email address **commr.hosur@gmail.com**
6. **Important dates**

1	Date and time of Pre bid meeting	**10.11.2026 at 11.00 AM**
2	Last date and time for downloading bid documents	**30.11.2026 at 03.00 PM**
3	Last Date and time for submission of bid document, including online submission	**30.11.2026 at 03.00 PM**
4	Date and time of opening of the Technical Bid	**30.11.2026 at 03.30 PM**

7. In the event of specified date for submission of bids is declared a holiday, bids will be received and opened on the next working day at the same time and venue.
8. Other details can be seen in the bid documents and E-mail **commr.hosur@gmail.com**.

DIPR/3316/TENDER/2026 **Commissioner, Hosur City Municipal Corporation**

SKUAST Kashmir RBIC Foundation
CIN: U8550JK2025NPL018385 | Sec 8 Company
Shalimar Campus, Srinagar, J&K-190025
NABARD
SKUAST | NABARD

NOTICE INVITING TENDER / REP

Ref: RBIC/ADM/CORR/2026/68 **Date: 28-10-2026**

Proposals are invited from eligible **Chartered Accountant (CA) Firms & Practising Company Secretaries (PCS)** for empanelment for FY 2026-27 (extendable) Under:

- **Category A:** Statutory Auditor (A1: First Auditor | A2: Regular Auditor
- **Category B:** Other CA Services (Accounts, Tax, Grant Accounting, MIS)
- **Category C:** Company Secretarial / PCS Services (ROC/MCA,Governance.
- **Submission Mode**: Email Technical Bid to **rbic@skuastkashmir.ac.in by 10/11/2026 (11:59 PM),** followed by sealed hard copies (Technical & Financial Bids in separate envelopes) to office of RBIC, Director Planning,SKUAST-K,Shalimar Campus, Srinagar-190025 within 7 days.

The detailed REP document, eligibility criteria, & submission formats are available for download at SKUAST-K website: **www.skuastkashmir.ac.in.**

Sd/-
CEO
DIPK-NB-1975/26 **SKUAST Kashmir RBIC Foundation**

rbic@skuastkashmir.ac.in | 0194-457059

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 15-10-2026, one person namely Mohd. Suleman S/O Abdul Rehman R/O Village Koti Tehsil Bani District Kathua lodged a written report at P/S Basohli stating therein that on 14-10-2026 his daughter-in-law namely Nazia Begum, age 19 years went missing from her maternal home at village Dodla Tehsil Basohli. The complainant and other family members made best efforts to search her but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DDR No. 33 dated 15-10-2026 has been entered at Police Station Basohli.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

Description Roll :-

Name	Nazia Begum
Father	Shams Din
Husband	Shoket Ali
Permanent Address	Village Koti Tehsil Bani
Present Address	Village Dodla Tehsil Basohli
Tehsil	Bani
Police Station	Basohli
Age	19 years
Height	5 feet 04 inch
Complexion	Fair
Built	Normal
Face	Oval
Eyes	Brown
Languages known	Hindi/ Dogri



Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311(Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Basohli 9186316022

DIP/J- 13396/26 **Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.**



Villagers, including members of the Dongria Kondh tribe, a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group, staging a protest after marching from Minikhol panchayat to the Muniguda tehsil office on October 26 against alleged fresh attempts to start mining in the Niyamgiri hill ranges and indiscriminate arrest of activists, including Dr. Randall Sequeira. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Jailhouse rock, the 'others' in the dock

A doctor serving Odisha's tribal heartland was arrested for allegedly supporting the resistance against bauxite mining. His name, along with those of other activists, did not figure in the FIR, but the police arrested them under a category of unnamed 'others'. **Satyasundar Barik** speaks to Adivasi and Dalit communities, which allege the police are using the legal process for intimidation

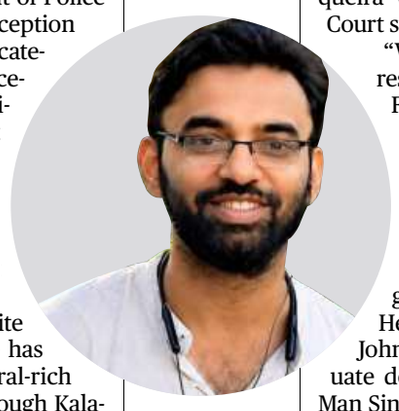
It was close to 11 p.m. on October 16. A posse of police personnel knocked on the door of a rented house in Hilltown, Bhawanipatna, the headquarters of Odisha's Kalahandi district. Dr. Randall Sequeira, 39, opened the door. He was arrested along with Laxman Naik, a 31-year-old Dalit activist who was also in the house.

The following day, the police linked their arrests to a violent clash that had taken place 192 days earlier. Neither Sequeira nor Naik were among the 26 villagers initially named in FIR No. 85/2026, which was registered at the Kashipur police station in the neighbouring Rayagada district. Instead, the police added them later. They were allegedly identified from a category of 100 unnamed 'others' from Kantamal town, in Rayagada's Kashipur, mentioned in the FIR.

"Laxman and I were treated like criminals and made to sleep on the floor of the police station through the night of October 16. The next day, we were taken to another police station. Despite repeatedly asking why we had been arrested, we got no answers. The police did not even allow me to speak to my family," Sequeira says over a phone call from Rayagada jail.

Activists in Odisha's Niyamgiri hills say their arrests point to a pattern: the use of criminal cases to target villagers and activists resisting mining projects. Biswapriya Kanungo, a Bhubaneswar-based lawyer and human rights activist, alleges that Odisha Police has created a "climate of intimidation" across the bauxite-rich region. "The message is unmistakable: anyone who dares to oppose mining must be prepared to risk becoming entangled in police cases," he says, adding that the legal system is being used as a "tool to intimidate dissenters, prolong their legal ordeal, tire them out, and ultimately silence opposition".

However, Rayagada Superintendent of Police Raj Prasad says there is a "misconception about the police misusing the 'others' category in FIRs". "This is a common procedure in cases of rioting. The complainant cannot identify all the accused at one go. Their faces are recognised at later stages from either CCTV footage or from statements of eyewitnesses," he says. He adds that FIRs are based on complaints from villagers. "We just go by the rule book," he says.



Corporate pressure to extract bauxite – the raw material for aluminium – has been intensifying across the mineral-rich Eastern Ghats in Odisha, running through Kalahandi, Rayagada, and Koraput districts. According to the Indian Minerals Yearbook 2023, Kalahandi, Rayagada, and Koraput account for 51% of India's bauxite reserves but contribute 74.64% of the country's bauxite production, earning the region the sobriquet of India's bauxite capital.

Villagers are asking the government not to carve up the hills for mining companies. At stake is the environmental and cultural heritage of the Adivasis and Dalits living in the area. Their resistance dates back to 2003, when the Odisha Mining Corporation (OMC) signed an agreement with the U.K.-based Vedanta Resources to mine bauxite in the Niyamgiri hills.

Lingaraj Azad, adviser to the Niyamgiri Suraksha Samiti (an organisation to safeguard the Niyamgiri hills), and Ladda Sikaka, the organisation's president, are lodged with Sequeira and Naik in the same jail. Both prominent anti-mining activists, they were arrested in separate cases on allegations that they too belonged to the unnamed 'others' category in the FIRs. The Niyamgiri Suraksha Samiti consists of people from tribal communities affected by corporate might and mining in the area. They have been working for two decades to protect the hills.

> Laxman and I were treated like criminals and made to sleep on the floor of the police station through the night of October 16. The next day, we were taken to another police station. Despite repeatedly asking why we had been arrested, we got no answers
>
> **DR. RANDALL SEQUEIRA**
> Works in community medicine in the Niyamgiri hills

Figures compiled by the People's Union for Democratic Rights (PUDR), a New Delhi-based civil liberties organisation, show that over the past three years, 43 cases related to resistance against bauxite mining in Kalahandi and Rayagada have been filed, resulting in more than 100 Adivasis and Dalits being sent to jail.

A doctor's ordeal

Sequeira says he learnt about the charges against him only after a medical examination, when the police handed him the arrest memo. He had been booked under Sections 109(1) and 191(2) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, relating to attempt to murder and rioting respectively.

The case concerned a clash in the early hours of April 7 when villagers of Kantamal, situated near the Sijimali bauxite deposit, resisted the police's attempt to enter the village.

Sequeira terms his arrest "ironic" as the Orissa High Court has already granted him anticipatory bail in connection with the same incident, registered under FIR No. 87/2026 at the Kashipur police station. In all, five complaints – three filed by police personnel and two by magistrates – were registered at the police station on the day of the clash. The police say Sequeira himself has been named in eight cases.

He is not new to the government's gaze. In an unprecedented move in 2025, the District Collector of Rayagada issued an order barring 25 people from entering the district for two months. Sequeira was among those banished. The High Court subsequently struck down the order.

"We have no idea why the police have arrested us under the 'others' category in the FIR," says Laxman, a resident of Kantamal village, over a phone call from Rayagada jail. Laxman has come to know that his name figures in two other FIRs, though the police say there are 16 cases against him.

Sequeira is an MBBS graduate of Bengaluru's St. John's National Academy of Health Sciences, commonly called St. John's Medical College. He has a postgraduate degree in internal medicine from Sawai Man Singh Medical College, Jaipur, and chose to work with underserved communities.

He began his journey in rural Tamil Nadu with the Tribal Health Initiative, a non-profit, before moving to Jharkhand and Odisha to work among the most disadvantaged.

He says working in forested regions, he came to understand how the loss of forests, drying water sources and pollution, alongside inadequate health care, changed the lives of tribals and Dalits. He was struck by how people in remote villages often appeared healthier than those living in urban slums, prompting him to explore the links between environmental health and human well-being.

His visits to settlements near bauxite reserves suggested that residents near operational mines suffered more skin ailments than those in non-mining areas. His research deepened his engagement with communities resisting mining.



> The guns and lathis of the police no longer frighten us. What terrifies us is their ability to arrest unnamed people under 'others' in an FIR. This is followed by months of legal battles
>
> **NARING DEI MAJHI**
> Resident, Sagabari village, Rayagada district

Though emotional during his parents' visit to Rayagada jail on October 26, he vowed not to be cowed by the police's "manipulative" tactics.

A bauxite-rich region

More than 95% of Odisha's bauxite resources are concentrated in the East Coast region, particularly in southern and western Odisha. The area has 44 bauxite deposits of varying sizes, with a majority of the reserves concentrated within a 100-kilometre stretch across Kalahandi, Rayagada, Koraput, and Malkangiri districts.

Several deposits are already operational while others are at different stages of development.

The National Aluminium Company Limited, a Navratna Central Public Sector enterprise under the Union Ministry of Mines, began mining at the Panchpatmali deposit, which has proven reserves of 310 million tonnes, decades ago in Koraput. The company is preparing to begin production at the Pottangi deposit, with reserves of 111 million tonnes, in Koraput.

The Aditya Birla Group has established an alumina refinery, sourcing bauxite from the Baphlimali deposit, which has reserves of 196.98 million tonnes, in Rayagada district.

The State-owned OMC is mining bauxite at Kodingamali, a 77.5-million-tonne deposit straddling Rayagada and Koraput.

The Vedanta Group has received environmental clearance for the Sijimali deposit, which has proven reserves of 311 million tonnes across Rayagada and Kalahandi districts. It has also emerged as the preferred bidder for the Karlapat deposit, estimated to hold 248 million tonnes of bauxite.

The Adani Group has been allotted the Kutrumali deposit, with reserves of 127.737 million tonnes, located a few kilometres from Sijimali. The public hearing required for its environmental clearance is yet to be held. The group also has interests in the Balada bauxite deposit, which has reserves of 22.13 million tonnes in Koraput.

The Aditya Birla Group, too, is yet to commence operations at the Maliparbat bauxite deposit in Koraput, with proven reserves of 15.06 million tonnes.

A delegation of senior citizens, comprising retired civil servants and police officers, met Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi this August to ask him to hold back on mining operations. "Taken together [existing and upcoming bauxite mining], these developments indicate an unusual acceleration of bauxite mining in the Eastern Ghat areas. This raises serious concerns about the cumulative ecological and social impacts of mining," says a member of the delegation.

Anti-mining activists behind bars

Between March 8 and April 8, up to 24 people were arrested and sent to jail, while 217 were named as accused and another 1,140 were listed as "others", according to the PUDR.

Not many cases filed pertaining to the movement against bauxite mining have ended in conviction. In most cases, trial is yet to begin.

Azad, whose name means freedom, is 62. He has spent the past two decades guiding the resistance against bauxite mining. Since his arrest on March 25, the police in Kalahandi and Rayagada have registered eight criminal cases against him. In five of the eight FIRs, his name does not appear. He too has been arrested under the unnamed "others" category.

His son, Allaram Christ Kumar, says, "My father has been in jail for the past seven months. Every time a court grants him bail in one case, the police book him in another. Going by the FIRs, he is accused of attempting murder, rioting, or committing robbery. Of the eight cases, he has secured bail in seven."

At Sagabari, a village likely to be affected by the proposed Sijimali bauxite mine in Rayagada district, 35-year-old Naring Dei Majhi now spends most of her time with her grandson. But the memory of August 2, 2025, remains vivid. That day, the police allegedly swooped down on the District Headquarters Hospital in Rayagada, where her daughter-in-law was about to give birth.

"I was whisked away from the hospital by police personnel dressed in doctors' aprons as if I was some terrorist or hardened criminal. My family members were still outside the labour room," recalls Naring, against whom six FIRs have been registered. In one of them, she is named alongside Sanu Majhi, her husband.

"The guns and lathis of the police no longer frighten us. What terrifies us is their ability to arrest unnamed people under 'others' in an FIR. This is followed by months of legal battles," she says. Naring was released only six months later.

Sharanya Nayak, a human rights activist, alleges that the police administration has "weaponised its authority" by acting on complaints against villagers who oppose mining. Preliminary inquiries may take place days or months later.

"Whether a complaint receives attention at a police station depends on the complainant's position on bauxite mining. Over the past three years, more than 40 cases have been filed at different police stations against people involved in the resistance. Yet, in only one instance has the police registered a complaint filed by Naring, who opposes mining," Nayak says.

Even in that case, she adds, the police have not begun an investigation 18 months later.

Narendra Mohanty, Sikaka's lawyer, remembers being in the same vehicle as his client on September 11 this year. "A police van came from behind and intercepted us. Sikaka was returning home after securing bail in two old cases. He was dragged out of the vehicle. No arrest memo was shown to us," he says.

Mohanty says there are 11 cases against Sikaka, with bail applications filed in seven. Yet, he alleges, records relating to these cases could not be found in the record room.

Sikaka, too, has allegedly been implicated in cases in which his name did not figure initially.

"We have requested the police and the court to provide a list of all cases in which Sikaka is accused and produce him for remand in those cases, so we can seek bail simultaneously. The police, however, will keep tormenting activists by weaponising the 'others' category in FIRs," Mohanty says.

Protests against the police

On October 26, hundreds of villagers, including women from the Dongria Kondh tribe, a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group, marched from Munikhol panchayat to the Muniguda tehsil office in Rayagada district. They were angry over frequent arrests of anti-bauxite mining activists.

"After the gram sabhas of 112 villages under Supreme Court supervision rejected the proposal to mine the ecologically sensitive Niyamgiri hills 13 years ago, fresh attempts are now being made to reopen the bauxite deposits. We will not allow this. Nor will we allow villagers to be arrested by the police on flimsy grounds," says Kartik Majhi, president of the Khandualmali Surakshya Samiti, an anti-mining forum.

Prafulla Samantara, a 2017 Goldman Environmental Prize awardee, says he and activist Medha Patkar were forcibly sent back from Rayagada in the past because the administration did not want villagers to be made aware of what was at stake - their forests, water resources, and livelihoods - in the face of massive bauxite mining.

"The pattern of arresting people without any reason also troubles me. If this is not a reflection of a police state, then what is?" he says.

satyasundar.b@thehindu.co.in





Journey to the ends of the earth Scenes from the Indian expedition to Antarctica; (below) aerial view of Dakshin Gangotri; and Sourabha Rao. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

South-side story

Sourabha Rao, producer of *Miracle in Antarctica*, talks about why the story of Dakshin Gangotri still remains relevant

Preeti Zachariah
preeti.zachariah@thehindu.co.in

Sourabha Rao, the producer of *Miracle in Antarctica*, a new film chronicling the story of the building of Dakshin Gangotri, India's first scientific base station in the frozen continent, says she is constantly surprised by the fact that the story has not been told in as many ways as possible. "It is a privilege for us to tell a story like that," says the Bengaluru-based writer, poet and filmmaker who thinks of this initiative as groundbreaking. "A project of that scale was not accomplished before 1983-84 and hasn't happened since, at least not at that pace; over one Antarctic summer."

The idea for the film, which her husband Santosh Saligram has directed, emerged from a serendipitous meeting with Harsh Kumar Gupta, the geophysicist and seismologist who was sent to Antarctica to lead this impossible mission.

"One of our friends, filmmaker Prakash Matada, bumped into Dr Gupta in early 2025," recalls Sourabha. Gupta, who had already written *Building Dakshin Gangotri at Antarctica: A Miracle*, published in 2021 by the Geological Society of India, was looking for someone to make a film about this mission. Prakash reached out to Sourabha and Santosh, co-founders of the Hamsagatha Foundation, a Bengaluru-based not-for-profit focussed on impactful storytelling. "We decided to take it up."





"Dr Gupta was so humble and approachable when we met him, asking about what we did as professionals instead of jumping straight into talking about his story. That was really nice."

One thing that stayed with Sourabha was what the then 83-year-old scientist told her after he had given her the gist of the project. "He told us that he wanted to do it as quickly as possible, because time was not on his side," she says, adding that this statement cemented their decision.

Back to the past

They began by first reaching out to some of the people who had been part of the expedition: Gupta, who lives in Hyderabad, of course, but also Ashok Hanjura in Delhi and KJ Mathew in Kochi. The biggest challenge at the beginning of the project was funding. "Dr Gupta offered some seed funding to start the project," explains Sourabha, who, with Santosh, began shooting interviews for the film in May last year. Around the same time, they also began looking for funds, which, after plenty of paperwork, their foundation finally received from the Ashraya Hastha Trust, Rohini Nilekani Philanthropies and Samagata Foundation. "Once we knew we were going to get this support, we went all out."

The film uses a mix of interviews, archival material, stock footage and animation to tell the story of not just Gupta's life and memories of that fateful summer, but also the relevance of Antarctica today, especially in the age of global warming and extreme weather events.

"Standing up to the gravitas of the story or the scientists who made it happen was a monumental responsibility," says Santosh, whose biggest practical challenge was finding enough archival material to support the storytelling. "For a contemporary audience or diverse, mixed demographic, there has to be a lot of visual support, and initially there was just not enough material," he says. Meticulous investigation, and yes, a little bit of luck, would soon change that. "We managed to find an old documentary that helped us immensely," he says. Then came the task of putting it all together on the editing table, says Santosh, who also worked with the Indiranagar-based LastBench Studio to help recreate certain scenes and fill the gaps in the narrative. "Using actors wasn't an option, for multiple reasons, so I am glad we found a team who understood what was required and brought in that aesthetic," he says.

While they had initially planned to make a short film, *Miracle in Antarctica* soon grew into a full-length documentary, with a background score by the Indian fusion band, Lakkshya.

What the duo cherishes the most about the entire process was the time spent with the scientists and their families. "They were all such good storytellers," says Sourabha, who has especially fond memories of what happened once the cameras stopped rolling. "A project like this can't just be about nostalgia; it has to be relevant, for the future."

Golfing on time

Omega hosted the fifth edition of the Omega Trophy at Gurugram bringing together accomplished golfers from across India



Tee off At the tournament. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The Hindu Bureau

Omega sports ambassadors Neeraj Chopra, Olympic champion in javelin, and Guido Migliozzi, accomplished Italian professional golfer, were part of the fifth edition of the Omega Trophy at the 18-hole DLF Golf and Country Club in Gurugram, reinforcing the brand's longstanding association with sporting excellence across disciplines.

The Omega Trophy was launched to champion golf excellence around the world; the tournament has become a highlight of the Indian golf calendar and a valued part of Omega's international golf family.

Omega's Master Chronometer Certification represents the brand's pursuit of precision – values that connect watchmaking and sport. This technical excellence makes Omega a partner for athletes pursuing achievement at every level and the tournament saw participation from across India.

City of flowers

de Gournay brings its hand-painted tableware and personalised decoratives, drawing on art history



Geetika Sachdev

Known for its hand-painted wallpapers and textiles, de Gournay has brought its porcelain collection to India for the first time through Thomas Goode at The Oberoi, New Delhi. Alongside dinner services, the collection includes decorative pieces such as vases, figurines and smaller objects for gifting. Clients can also commission pieces to their specifications, choosing colours, shapes, painted motifs and gilded details.

The partnership brings together two houses with longstanding associations with the decorative arts. While de Gournay draws on traditional painting techniques to create its porcelain, Thomas Goode, established in London in 1827, is known for its fine tableware and bespoke design service. The collaboration gives Indian collectors access to de Gournay's porcelain and the opportunity to commission pieces through Thomas Goode.

The porcelain is made in Jingdezhen, China, whose history of porcelain production spans more than a thousand years. Each piece passes through several stages, from shaping and glazing to firing, painting and gilding, with specialised craftspeople bringing different skills to the process.



Fine china (Top) An underglaze demonstration in progress; (above) Flora & Fauna dinner service. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Recording history

Among the collections on offer is Flora & Fauna, whose birds, butterflies and flowers draw inspiration from the 19th Century ornithological illustrations of John Gould and John James Audubon. The designs differ across the service, so that individual plates feature their own compositions.

Clients can further personalise their selections with a family crest or monogram, or by choosing particular colours, motifs and gilding. The process begins with a consultation, followed by drawings and samples. Production takes around three months once the factory approves the design.

"Every commission begins with a conversation, and I think that is often the most interesting part of the entire process," says Reshma Khattar Bhagat, director, Thomas Goode India. "We try to understand the person before we begin discussing patterns or colours."

In 1848, William James Goode established the company's first volumes of crest and monogram designs, a tradition that continues through its bespoke service today. The partnership with de Gournay extends this approach to a collection distinguished by its hand-painted decoration.

For Indian collectors, Reshma believes, the appeal lies in the opportunity to commission something that reflects their own histories rather than select a service off the shelf. A design might take its cue from a flower in the family garden, a favourite colour or a motif passed down through generations.

Reshma has also observed a change in how people use fine tableware. Dinner services once brought out largely for weddings and formal gatherings are increasingly finding their way into everyday settings, mixed with inherited pieces or contemporary designs. Beyond dinner services, the collection includes decorative porcelain, chinoiserie vases, tea sets and smaller objects such as trinket trays. For the launch, the Thomas Goode store presented a festive table featuring de Gournay's Aviary design, hand-painted on a bespoke tablecloth, alongside its Flora & Fauna dinner service. Thomas Goode's Daisy Line crystal glassware, silverware and limited-edition palm-tree candlesticks finished in 24-carat gold completed the setting.

"A dinner service gathers meaning through the people who sit around it and the memories made over countless meals," says Reshma. For her, that is what makes a dinner service worth holding on to long after it is first brought home.



Deciphering the trio Artworks at the exhibition. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



The masters, on paper

The exhibition at CMYK Bookstore brings together 60 original lithographs and etchings to offer a closer look at Picasso, Miró and Dalí

Neeta Lal

Take Picasso, Miró and Dalí off the museum wall and put them on paper, and the familiar starts to shift. Picasso becomes more spare and searching; Miró more elusive; Dalí more exacting. That is the proposition behind Picasso Miró Dalí - Master Impressions, Original Lithographs and Etchings.

The exhibition brings together over 60 original graphic works by the three maestros, offering a concentrated look at practices that have long been overshadowed by their paintings. The works were conceived for lithography and etching, produced in limited editions and individually numbered and signed by the artists.

According to curators of the show Kapil and Priya Kapoor, also directors of Roli Books and CMYK, there is a special reason behind this show. "Our interests increasingly extend into the wider world of collecting that surrounds them – from rare books and limited editions to original graphic works by artists."

The exhibition is part of this continuing exploration, they add, introducing audiences and collectors in India to an important side of the practices of artists whose work is universally familiar, while offering a closer look at their achievements in lithography and etching.

The exhibition is most compelling as a three-way comparison. Picasso pares the figure down with extraordinary economy; Miró builds a vocabulary from signs, creatures and biomorphic forms; Dalí applies meticulous draftsmanship to the fantastic logic of Surrealism. Seen together, their differences are immediate – and illuminating.

Picasso's Portrait de Femme II (1955), a portrait of Jacqueline Roque, the artist's second wife and muse of whom he produced around 400 portraits, is a particular highlight. Produced in an edition of just 50, it captures the economy that makes Picasso's graphic work so compelling. Picasso continually tests how much information a face needs before it becomes an image – and how much can be left unresolved.

Miró's works seem to emerge from a vocabulary of floating signs: eyes, birds, stars, and half-recognisable forms. What initially appears spontaneous is carefully calibrated. His compositions hover between drawing and writing, as though an unknown alphabet were continually being invented.

Placed alongside Picasso, the distinction is striking. Picasso's line reconstructs the visible world; Miró's seems to invent another one. Dalí occupies a third territory. His works return us to the precision of drawing, but place it in the service of Surrealism. Objects and landscapes become vehicles for impossible combinations, while his technique gives even the strangest images credibility.

For artists whose images have been reproduced almost endlessly, Master Impressions offers another way to look at them.

The exhibition is most compelling as a three-way comparison

At CMYK Bookstore, 142, Meharchand Market Fifth Avenue, Lodhi Road, until November 22.

Deemed ineligible

The Supreme Court has pointed to the SIR's flaws by design

At Wednesday's hearing of a petition on the Delhi SIR in the Supreme Court, Justice Joymalya Bagchi asked questions that cut to the heart of the Election Commission of India (ECI)'s SIR of electoral rolls. If an existing voter was "lax, inert or did not respond" to enumeration forms, was that a ground for the ECI to "forfeit his or her right to vote forever"? The Bench headed by the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said that the ECI was in "error" to force such voters, struck off for not returning enumeration forms, to reapply on Form 6 as if they were new voters. It asked why voters who had shifted residences could not just disclose details and why deleted voters could not fill enumeration forms belatedly. This is the central design flaw of the SIR as it shifts the burden of enrolment from the state to the elector, including those who have voted before, and treats a mere change of address as ground for deletion. The share of draft deletions recorded as "shifted" or "absent" rose from 55% in Bihar to 72% in States/Union Territories in Phase 3. In Karnataka, about 84 lakh electors were deleted, marked as "shifted" or "absent" during enumeration. But only a net of 8.2 lakh, including new electors, were added during the claims phase, with the final roll being 64.5 lakh short of the projected adult population. Requiring moved voters to re-register as fresh applicants defeats the ECI's historic mandate of widening the franchise, which was inherent in the 2002-03 intensive revision, where enumerators enrolled shifted voters at their new homes and the Chief Electoral Officer reconciled the old entries.

Justice Bagchi also mentioned that the Bihar judgment was not a "binding precedent" and that the legality of "logical discrepancy" checks, allowed only as an "interim arrangement" in West Bengal, had not been finally adjudicated. No statute or rule provides for judging a voter's eligibility on the basis of family size or the age gap between voters and parents, which were two of the ECI's ludicrous and algorithm-driven "logical discrepancy" checks. In West Bengal these checks resulted in massive disenfranchisement and *The Hindu*'s analysis found that in Delhi, Muslims were disproportionately flagged. But the Court should not merely issue managerial fixes such as extended deadlines or displaying printed lists in blocks, as it has in the past. The final SIR rolls are erroneous as deletions flowed from a flawed design rather than just lapses by the ECI. The dead and duplicate entries that the SIR identified should be removed and newly eligible electors added. Voters wrongly removed from draft rolls must be included again. The larger questions over the Commission's SIR conduct and how its members are appointed must also be settled.

Open to probe

Public functionaries must not use privacy to seek exemption from scrutiny

The Digital News Publishers Association's (DNPA) challenge to the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and its Rules, has drawn attention to concerns that a law to safeguard informational privacy risks creating a serious chilling effect on the media. The absence of a specific exemption for journalistic activity could subject reporters investigating official misconduct or corruption to the obligations of a "data fiduciary", requiring them to notify and seek consent from the very individuals they are investigating. Such onerous requirements could affect investigations undertaken in the public interest. The implications extend to routine newsgathering too, where personal information is integral to reporting. The omission is particularly consequential because the drafts in 2018, 2019 and 2021 carried a journalistic exemption. The Act already provides exemptions for certain forms of data processing, including for research and statistical purposes, making the denial of similar protection to journalists difficult to justify. Non-compliance can attract penalties of up to ₹250 crore, posing an existential threat to smaller and independent newsrooms. The DNPA petition also challenges Section 44(3), which amended the RTI Act, 2005, removing the earlier public-interest qualification concerning disclosure of personal information. The protection of personal information must not be absolute; an overriding public interest must remain a legitimate ground for disclosure, particularly when the information is held by public authorities. Investigations into corruption often rely on asset disclosures and tender documents containing personal data. Restricting access to these records risks reducing journalism to merely reproducing government releases.

The Supreme Court, while issuing notice on the petition, rightly emphasised the need to balance press freedom with the right to privacy. Although journalists in India enjoy no specific statutory protection for their work, freedom of the press is constitutionally protected under Article 19(1)(a). The Court has also shielded newspapers from arbitrary state restrictions. However, growing mistrust of legacy media and the rise of independent content creators have made it difficult to determine who receives such protection. The Centre has also flagged this concern. Yet, carving out distinct categories is no easy task – a 2026 Reuters Institute report shows that the proportion of 18- to 24-year-olds identifying social media as their primary source of news rose from 21% in 2015 to 39% in 2025. A purely legalistic determination of these competing concerns may perhaps prove too onerous. Stakeholders must build consensus on a mutually acceptable framework where public functionaries and those handling public funds are not insulated from scrutiny under the guise of privacy. Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw's indication that he would meet editors is a welcome step towards consensus.

The examination overload, its enormous cost



Furqan Qamar

Vice Chancellor of the Integral University Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh. He was the Secretary General of the Association of Indian Universities (AIU), Vice Chancellor of the Central University of Himachal Pradesh and University of Rajasthan, and Adviser (Education) in the Planning Commission

India's obsession with layers of examinations must end, and the focus must return to the forgotten value of sustained academic performance

Once upon a time, not very long ago, students could focus on their education, confident that their academic results would determine admission to higher education and career opportunities. Today, millions of young Indians face not one examination but a cascade of them – a seemingly endless series of entrance examinations. Besides board examinations, aspiring engineers and doctors generally face entrance tests such as the Joint Entrance Examination (JEE) and the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET), respectively. Architecture and law aspirants must also navigate examinations such as the National Aptitude Test in Architecture (NATA) and the Common Law Admission Test (CLAT). Others must take the Common University Entrance Test (CUET) or institution-specific examinations. With affordable, quality higher education in short supply, many candidates make repeated attempts. Even a good bachelor's degree does not guarantee postgraduate admission.

Postgraduate aspirants face examinations such as the Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering (GATE), Common Admission Test (CAT), Common University Entrance Test for Postgraduate Programmes (CUET-PG) and various university-level entrance tests. Research aspirants face further qualifying examinations, including the National Eligibility Test (NET). The ordeal continues during recruitment. Academic qualifications merely establish eligibility, while employment often depends on examinations conducted by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC), State Public Service Commissions, Staff Selection Commission (SSC) and Institute of Banking Personnel Selection (IBPS). The proliferation of entrance and recruitment examinations has turned education and employment into a relentless cycle of competitive testing.

The cost of competition

Each of these layers of examinations demands months of separate preparation, payment of separate coaching fees, and unexplainable suffering and distress. Somewhere in this labyrinthian relay race, the very examinations that were supposed to certify students' learning, abilities and achievements have been rendered irrelevant. It is time to ask a blunt question: why do we need all these additional gates when the school and university leaving examinations already exist to measure merit?

Separate examinations for admission and jobs were declared inevitable because school board and university examinations were argued to suffer from a lack of uniform standards and their susceptibility to manipulation and rampant use of unfair means. The argument assumes that the new layers of examinations would be free from these deficiencies. The on-the-ground experience has only proven that the designed cure is worse than the disease itself.

Public examinations are marred by allegations of paper leaks and other unfair practices, such as dummy candidates, mark manipulation, and merit garbling, leading to repeated cancellations. Each incident wastes public money, delays admissions and recruitment, and erodes faith in the fairness of the system.

Centralised counselling for seat allotments complicates the process. They also multiply anxiety, stress and mental trauma. Layering examination upon examination rather than distributing this pressure forces students to spend their entire adolescence running an unbroken loop of a preparatory marathon.

Additionally, such examinations entail exorbitant costs that ultimately fall disproportionately on families who can ill afford them. Children from the economically weaker and marginalised sections of society struggle to manage and often cannot. Far from being neutral arbiters of merit, these examinations have come to reward the ability to pay for preparation rather than raw ability or diligence in school.

Youth frustrations may have reached a tipping point, compelling them to take to the streets. Several States have seen protests of varying scales. It remains to be seen whether the proposed strengthening of the law against unfair practices in public examinations and the recommendations of the high-powered committee constituted in July 2026 will address these systemic deficiencies.

The present system of layered examinations suffers from design defects and systemic deficiencies. The National Testing Agency's continuing difficulties, despite a comprehensive review by a committee headed by a former space scientist in 2024, have raised questions about the effectiveness of the reforms. The constitution of another high-powered committee, in 2026, underscores the persistence of these concerns.

We are still thinking only of reforming this broken system without stopping for a moment to ask a critical question: how can we trust centralised public examinations conducted by agencies that have repeatedly failed to fulfil their responsibilities when we cannot trust years of assessment by teachers throughout a student's course of study?

Why bear such a heavy burden when, academically speaking, these layers of examinations cannot possibly substitute for the regular assessment of knowledge acquired over years of study? At most, they can evaluate candidates on a much narrower, often more coachable skill: ticking off the answer choices quickly under pressure in a specific question format, while disregarding years of demonstrated cumulative academic performance.

The result is a strange inversion. Students no longer study to learn; they study to clear filters. Classroom teaching has been relegated in favour of coaching-centre drilling. The board examination becomes a formality, and we have ended up with a system where the credentialing examination that ought to matter most – the one tied to actual classroom learning – now matters the least.

Merit already exists, use it

It makes sense to fix the school and higher education system, which has long been broken and continues to be hammered, causing further damage. Now is the time to focus on restoring the credibility of school and university examinations. Whatever their imperfections, these examinations are not arbitrary, as they assess knowledge acquired over years of study, involve continuous evaluation and are moderated by boards and universities with established standards. With some investment, they can become far better and more reliable measures of merit.

A student's Class XII marks or university Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) already reflect years of consistent performance – a far more holistic and harder-to-game measure of ability and diligence than a single high-stakes examination. If board and university examinations are inconsistent across States or institutions, the answer is to standardise and strengthen them through normalisation, common moderation frameworks, external audits and periodic score equating, rather than building an entirely separate examination system on top of them. If admission committees and employers doubt the rigour of certain boards or universities, those doubts should be addressed by reforming the assessment standards of these institutions, rather than requiring every student in the country to run a second, third or fourth race, regardless of where they studied.

Admissions to higher education institutions ought to be based on standardised and moderated school-leaving examination results. Scholarships and fellowships should be awarded on the basis of academic performance and track records. Recruitment to public services could be based on verified academic records and structured interviews. At most, a single national test at each exit level of the educational hierarchy could be conducted to assess students' scholastic aptitude, with the scores used to moderate board or university examination results.

Global practices

This is not a radical proposal by international standards. Many countries admit students to university primarily based on their school-leaving results, supplemented by references and essays, with marginal weight assigned to scores in language and scholastic aptitude tests. It is India's exceptional layering of tests, often to assess the same competency, tested repeatedly by different bodies, that is the outlier.

The argument for dismantling India's entrance and recruitment examination pyramid is not an argument against standards. It is an argument that standards already exist, embedded in the school and university systems which India has spent enormous public resources building, and that repeatedly re-testing the same students for the same underlying competencies wastes money, invites corruption, and causes real harm to the wellbeing of young people. Reforming and trusting the examinations India already has would do more to promote genuine merit than adding yet another layer of examinations ever could.

A security deal, but not the end of the Arctic contest



Sakti Prasad Srichandan

Assistant Professor, Centre for European Studies, School of International Studies, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi

The Greenland agreement strengthens American security while raising sovereignty concerns

The agreement signed between the United States, Denmark and Greenland on September 22, 2026, marks an important moment in the changing geopolitics of the Arctic. Greenland is an autonomous part of the Kingdom of Denmark. Under the 2009 Self-Government Act, it has extensive control over its domestic affairs, while foreign, defence and security policy remain with Denmark. Greenland came into the news this year because of the Trump administration's repeated interest in gaining control over the island. What began as a territorial controversy gradually became a wider debate about sovereignty, security and the future of the Arctic.

The agreement, signed at the United Nations, expands the American military presence in Greenland while reaffirming Danish sovereignty and Greenland's right to self-determination. It brings, at least for now, an end to the unusual tensions between Washington and Copenhagen over the future of the strategically important island. The agreement's entry into force is subject to the completion of the necessary parliamentary procedures in Denmark and Greenland.

Not a territorial deal

The agreement is essentially a security deal, not a territorial deal. The U.S. has, for the moment, moved away from its earlier demand to acquire Greenland. Instead, Washington has secured greater military access to the island. The agreement allows the expansion of the existing Pituffik Space Base and provides for additional American defence facilities at Narsarsuaq in southern Greenland and Mestersvig in the east, subject to mutually agreed arrangements. American aircraft and ships will have wider access to Greenlandic territory and waters for defence purposes. The important point is simple. Greenland has not changed hands. But the American military presence there is likely to become much larger. The agreement shows how quickly the Arctic is becoming a strategic region. Greenland sits in a crucial location between North America and Europe, a geography that matters for missile warning, space surveillance and the security of the North Atlantic. It is becoming more important as Arctic sea routes open up and competition over resources grows. The agreement includes cooperation related to the proposed Golden Dome defence system. It also places restrictions on investments from countries outside the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO), NATO partner countries and the European Union (EU) in certain sensitive sectors. Economic activity in the Arctic is therefore increasingly being viewed through the lens of national security.

Denmark's balancing act

For Denmark, the challenge was particularly difficult. Copenhagen had to protect its sovereignty over Greenland while avoiding a prolonged confrontation with Washington. The agreement gives Denmark a way to do both.

American military involvement will increase, but within an arrangement that formally recognises Danish sovereignty and Greenlandic self-determination. Greenland's Prime Minister Jens-Frederik Nielsen has also stressed the importance of NATO in Arctic security. The deal brings greater American involvement into Greenland without formally changing its political status.

Yet, the question of sovereignty remains complicated. The agreement recognises Greenland's right to self-determination. It refers to respect for Greenlandic society and its traditional way of life. At the same time, it gives the U.S. extensive military access and introduces restrictions on foreign investment in sensitive areas. The agreement has no expiry date. Some of its provisions would also remain in place even if Greenland becomes independent in the future, creating an unusual situation.

The Arctic's transformation

The Greenland episode tells us something about the future of the Arctic. The region is no longer only about climate change, scientific research and polar exploration. It is now closely linked to missile defence, critical minerals, infrastructure, shipping routes and space security. Russia's military presence and China's growing economic and scientific interests have already changed the strategic environment. But Arctic competition can also create tensions among allies themselves.

For Denmark and Greenland, the agreement provides a way out of a difficult diplomatic situation. For the U.S., it provides greater strategic access without formal annexation. For NATO, it underlines the growing importance of the High North.

But the real test will come later. The question is whether greater American military involvement can strengthen Greenland's security without reducing Greenlanders' control over their future. As Greenland is likely to remain important, its people will have to balance the opportunities that greater international attention brings with the risks of becoming the centre of great-power competition. The way Denmark, the U.S. and Greenland manage this balance will shape the island's future. The answer to that question will ultimately determine the real importance of this agreement.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The right to vote

While maintaining an updated electoral database is a administrative necessity, transforming procedural non-compliance into a mechanism for permanent disenfranchisement is inherently punitive. To dictate that an individual's temporary oversight or bureaucratic inertia should result in the absolute forfeiture of their fundamental right to vote is a distortion of the constitutional mandate. The franchise is an unalienable democratic pillar, not a conditional privilege to be revoked under the guise of rectifying a "logical discrepancy". Furthermore, compelling historically validated citizens to reapply under the strictures reserved for completely new electors creates an artificial hurdle that undermines civic participation. The judiciary's timely intervention (Page 1, October 29) serves as a critical reminder that administrative efficiency must never be achieved at the altar of citizen disenfranchisement.

Nagarajamani M.V.,
Hyderabad

Lathering up excuses

The assertion by the Tamil Nadu Environmental Minister that the massive blankets of toxic foam floating on the Noyyal river in Tiruppur are caused by soap and shampoo used in households is not only the height of comedy but also a sign of his ignorance. This bizarre narrative is a desperate, risible deflection from the real culprits: the rampant, unregulated discharge of untreated effluents from local dyeing and textile units (Tamil Nadu, October 29).

R. Sivakumar,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Are youth worried they will be worse off than their parents?

PARLEY



Gilles Verniers

is a political scientist and researcher at CERI Sciences Po, Paris



Rohit Azad

teaches at JNU and specialises in political economy

Europe is seeing a wave of protests against economic inequalities and poor living standards. The immediate causes vary across countries, from the housing crisis in Spain and issues with the education system in France to public anger over perceived corruption in Serbia and Albania. But one thing is common: youth at the vanguard. Europe always had space for democratic dissent and has seen major protests to influence state systems and public policy. But with more and more youth taking the streets across the continent and beyond, are these protests merely reactionary, or is there a generational, existential anxiety at play? Are youth worried they will be worse off than their parents? Gilles Verniers and Rohit Azad discuss in a conversation moderated by **Vighnesh P. Venkitesh**. Edited excerpts:

Is the current wave of protests a cyclical outburst of generational aspirations, and can it be compared to developments in previous generations like the 1968 protests in Paris?

Gilles Verniers: There are, of course, parallels between the May 1968 Paris revolt and the current wave of protests that are happening in France. Like 1968, it started with students protesting about conditions in educational institutions before gradually spreading into a broader revolt. What began in mid-September with a high school student protesting teacher shortages and so forth has become a nationwide movement about inequality and the cost of living. That said, there is a key difference between 1968 and now: one wanted more freedom; the other wants a future.

Is there an economic stagnation happening around the continent and maybe beyond, and is that what is translating into these protests?

Rohit Azad: Unlike 1968, there is a withdrawal of the State now. The Left was in ascendance then; you had Vietnam fighting a war against U.S. imperialism. The 1968 protests were about pushing a welfare state further to the left. Whereas now, forget about the welfare state; people are demanding basic facilities that the state should provide. It is a crisis of the neoliberal model. So, the two contexts are completely different. In France, the unemployment rate among those aged 15 to 24 is slightly above 20%. That, along with the rising cost of living, falling real wages, and severe cutbacks in public expenditure, definitely becomes the backdrop against which today's movement is taking place.



A call for change: French school and university students protest, demanding better school conditions and government action, on October 15. REUTERS

GV: I completely agree with that. The context in which young people have grown has been a succession of crises. It is what one calls a polycrisis mindset. This generation has lived through the 2008 financial crisis, COVID-19, climate disasters, war in Europe, and now AI, and they are yet to turn 25. And so what they are seeking, first and foremost, is more protection from the state and not more freedom from the state, as it used to be the case before.

Several state systems that exist now have been shaped by the post-war situation in Europe and the fall of the Soviet Union. Is there a generation gap that exists between the current system and youth, creating a rift?

GV: There is a generational gap, not just in terms of age, but in terms of values, priorities, and ways of organising. Older institutions are hierarchical. The youth movements now are leaderless. The gap between the age of the political class and the median age in a country is often very wide. In Europe, you have a large majority of voters who are ageing and want to protect the pension system and the welfare state while schools crumble, literally. There is strong divergence in terms of needs.

RA: I would stress the fact that digital life itself amplifies anxiety, because you are constantly comparing across generations, your global peers, and with the elites. The information gap that would have been there when you did not have a digital life versus what you have now – you can see the inequality right in your face.

GV: And it is a good illustration that social media cuts both ways. Obviously, they function as an amplifier of anxieties. But they also provide a space and the instruments for organisation and

> The context in which young people have grown has been a succession of crises. It is what one calls a polycrisis mindset
> **GILLES VERNIERS**

counter-mobilisation. What is really interesting in this movement is the constant reinvention of new modes of organising and resistance against illiberal regimes, far-right movements, and so forth. The very instrument that sort of generates and amplifies anxieties is also the instrument that allows youth to combat it.

Talking about Serbia and the leaderless aspect of the movements, the current wave has seen students or youth coming together at the spur of the moment. How will a leaderless movement fare against the established state systems?

RA: Even though it was a leaderless movement, the Serbian protests continued for two long years in terms of mobilisation. There were ups and downs, like Lenin said, "One step forward, two steps back," but they were at it no matter what. That is not to say leadership does not matter, but I think when people are up in arms, the leadership question kind of recedes into the background.

GV: And being leaderless proves to be an asset way more than a liability, because the moment you have designated leadership, they become targets. The Serbia case is very striking because they succeeded in toppling down democratically a right-wing illiberal regime. It creates a precedent. But every movement is confronted with very specific national context and conditions, and they may not necessarily produce the same outcomes everywhere.

We see there is a pessimism setting in around AI interventions and the looming climate crisis. Every generation has had its own anxieties, like the Cold War or the fear of a nuclear apocalypse in the 1960s and 1970s. Are the anxieties a cycle, or are youth justified in envisioning a bleak future?

GV: The pessimism in some aspects has a factual, scientific basis. We have data about the rise of inequalities, concentration of wealth and power, climate disruption, and so forth. And we know, at least in Europe, many young people expect to do worse than their parents on housing and pensions and job security. As I said before, their experience of the world is that of a polycrisis. What is sort of different today is that even the conventional avenues for upward social and economic mobility are affected. In the current situation, particularly with AI, it is entry-level, white-collar jobs – the traditional first rung of the 'ladder '– that look more exposed. And that sort of adds to that sentiment of bleakness. Now you have the 'elite segment' of the population who have started to struggle as well and use their social capital to build or participate in these movements. But the struggle for people has been very long in the making.

RA: As far as AI is concerned, there is a double whammy for the youth. One, it has come on top of general economic stagnation, which means low employment generation to begin with. Two, whatever little growth is there, it is increasingly becoming capital-intensive. For both these reasons, the youth see a bleak future.

Coming to the climate crisis, I would say that is the biggest example of generational injustice. The older generations have contributed the most to global warming, but it is the young who are going to suffer the most. I think that creates a kind of resentment against the older generation.

In a late-stage capitalist system or structure, is the youth movement acting as what Lenin put it as a vanguard party?

GV: I think the historical conditions are different. Those vanguard parties of the old days had very coherent ideological clarity that these movements do not necessarily have. The movement today has an element of an alliance of students and workers, but we are not talking about factory workers anymore in Europe. We are talking about a completely scattered, anomic, precarious, salaried class, which has been at the wrong end of the effects of neoliberalism. And so, I would say the conditions are a little bit too different for seeing it as a simple repetition of history.

RA: I do not even know why history should be repeated. I would say that vanguardism had a role at that point in time. Maybe we need a different kind of politics, which is more inclusive, which may have the ideology of the left or broad issues that the left would like to raise, but something which is not centralising in terms of either ideology or in terms of organisation.

To listen to the full interview
Scan the code or go to the link
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NOTEBOOK

The changing address of power

T.N.'s search for a new Secretariat has spanned successive governments; TVK's latest proposal to build one near the coast has revived the debate

B. Kolappan

Covering the Secretariat beat and the Assembly proceedings was traditionally reserved for senior journalists in every newspaper. But at *Dinamani*, its editor, RmT Sambandam, did not believe in rigid rules. He sent a bunch of rookies, including me, to Fort St. George, known as *kottai*, which housed the Secretariat, to cover the Assembly proceedings.

He would send us off with one instruction: "Go and introduce yourself to the man sitting in the first seat in the journalists' lobby." He was referring to the *The Hindu* journalist, invariably the seniormost among the organisation's journalists and, in a sense, among those covering the Assembly. The next seat was allotted to *The Indian Express* – now *The New Indian Express* – followed by *Daily Thanthi*, and then *Dinamani*.

I covered the last session of the AIADMK regime in 1995 and started going to the Assembly regularly after the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) was elected to power in 1996, with M. Karunanidhi, fondly called Kalaignar, occupying the Chief Minister's seat. Jayalalithaa, who had been defeated, was not in the House. I missed the face-to-face exchanges between Karunanidhi and his political rival, Jayalalithaa. Still, we had a great time.

The Tamil Maanila Congress (TMC), launched by G.K. Moopanar and an ally of the DMK, had occupied the main Opposition benches. The bonhomie between the two parties eventually turned bitter. The TMC launched a new front during the 1999 Lok Sabha elections and joined hands with Jayalalithaa's AIADMK in the 2001 Assembly election.

By then, I was representing *The New Indian Express*, sitting next to *The Hindu* in the Assembly.

It was then that the construction of a new Secretariat became a matter of concern for journalists. When Jayalalithaa announced plans to shift the seat of power to Tiruvidanthai on the ECR, journalists, including me, dreaded the prospect of travelling miles to cover the Assembly proceedings and the Secretariat beat. But she gave up the proposal in the face of opposition and instead sought to build a Secretariat complex on the site where Queen Mary's College now stands. That also met with stiff resistance, and she decided to continue functioning from Fort St. George.

After he won again in 2006, Karunanidhi began looking for a place to construct a new Secretariat and Assembly complex. The DMK government zeroed in on the site where the old Admiralty House and MLA hostels stood, just opposite *The Hindu* on the arterial Anna Salai. By the time I joined *The Hindu*, I had moved into the first seats in the journalists' lobby.

The construction of the new complex progressed at a breakneck pace, as Karunanidhi wanted to occupy it before the 2011 election. The dome crowning the building was not ready in time for the inauguration, so art director Thota Tharani was brought in to create a replica.

The Secretariat proved extremely convenient. But the journalists' lobby was shifted to the first floor.

During the last session of the Assembly, when O. Panneerselvam was functioning as Chief Minister after Jayalalithaa was disqualified by the courts, he declared that his party would return to power and that the new government would function from Fort St. George. His words proved prophetic.

There was no talk of a new Secretariat or Assembly complex for the next 10 years. Even when the DMK returned to power in 2021, Chief Minister M.K. Stalin chose to work from Fort St. George. He planned to move the seat of government to Pooncheri, a place near Mamallapuram. But that did not materialise.

Now, once again, the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) government has proposed constructing a new Secretariat, this time close to the Chennai seashore. But the proposal has already run into rough weather.

It remains to be seen whether the government will heed the Opposition's objections and shelve the plan or go ahead with it. I, however, will be spared the prospect of travelling to a new building, as I will no longer be in service by the time its construction is completed.

kolappan.b@thehindu.co.in

PICTURE OF THE WEEK

Battling the waves



Disaster response personnel restore a road washed away by waves during Cyclone Arnab at Uppada coastal village in Kakinada district, Andhra Pradesh on Thursday. V. RAJU

FROM THE ARCHIVES
The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 30, 1976

Indian Navy Submarine in Madras

Madras, Oct. 29: Even as preparations are under way for the Navy Day celebrations, INS Karanj, one of the larger submarines of the Navy is on a routine visit to Madras.

The Russian-made INS Karanj which is described as an advanced conventional submarine belongs to what is perhaps the most powerful arm of the Indian Navy. It has mine-laying capabilities and with its torpedoes packs a lot of punch. It came into the harbour two days ago.

A submarine is said to be more vulnerable than other ships, and it is essential that all the systems in it are continuously monitored and that any defect is set right immediately.

The crew is kept on their toes throughout with emergency drills.

The boat is powered by diesel engines when it cruises on the surface, but underwater it has to draw power from its batteries. For sighting, it is equipped with a periscope, radar, and sonar equipment.

Going into a submarine through its hatch is like going down into a deep mine. The cigar-shaped boat is divided into watertight segments and is so crammed with machinery that there is hardly any space to move about.

For the crew, life on board is very different from that in other warships. Here they are tightly packed and sleep on bunks placed between pieces of machinery.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 30, 1926

Depression in cotton industry

Bombay, Oct. 29: Representatives of the Ahmedabad Millowners' Association were examined by the Tariff Board (Cotton Textile).

Replying to the Chairman, they stated that during the last two or three weeks the condition of the textile industry had changed for the worse. Owing to the heavy drop in cotton prices, cloth merchants had lost their confidence. The purchasing power of the agriculturists was also going down and the phenomenal fall in American cotton prices had accentuated depression in the cotton industry, but did not affect textile industries of America and Japan to any extent. On the other hand, they were making profits. The drop in cotton prices during the last two or three years had been gradual, and it was admitted that the bumper cotton crop of America accentuated the depression.

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Worth of spices seized by Maharashtra FDA till October 29

19.70 in ₹ crore. The Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) has seized 11,963.87 quintals of spices and spice products worth ₹19.70 crore after inspecting 1,057 establishments between April 1 and October 29, officials said on Thursday. The FDA also said it has issued 557 improvement notices during the period. PTI

Special buses to be operated by Himachal ahead of Deepavali

266 The Himachal Road Transport Corporation will operate a total of 266 special buses on November 6 and 7 to help people of the State reach their homes during the Deepavali festival, Deputy Chief Minister Mukesh Agnihotri said on Thursday. The special buses would be run from Delhi, Chandigarh and Baddi to different parts of Himachal Pradesh. PTI

Persons held across Assam in crackdown against child marriage

560 More than 560 people have been arrested in the latest crackdown against child marriage across Assam, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said on Thursday. He had earlier said the State government's efforts in the past few years led to over 12,000 cases being registered, more than 11,000 arrests, and an 81% drop in child marriages across 20 districts. PTI

Minors rescued from child labour in Delhi's Gandhi Nagar

19 Nineteen children, including five below the age of 14, were rescued from garment and artificial jewellery factories in east Delhi's Gandhi Nagar area, where they were allegedly made to work for as little as ₹10 a day, an official said on Thursday. Nine factory owners have been apprehended and nine factories sealed following the crackdown. PTI

Amount received by Rajasthan farmers in crop insurance claims

345 in ₹ crore. The Rajasthan government has facilitated the payment of nearly ₹345 crore in pending crop insurance claims to farmers across nine districts, officials said on Thursday. Agriculture Commissioner Naresh Kumar Goyal said around ₹318 crore was given to farmers in six western districts. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Concerns over the collegium system

Retired SC judge Justice Sanjay Kaul has shared that former CJI D.Y. Chandrachud may have discussed proposed judicial appointments with the Centre before the collegium met to discuss them, prompting a broader debate on the evolution of the collegium system and ways to improve transparency in judicial appointments

EXPLAINER

Rangarajan R.

The Story so far:
Retired judge of the Supreme Court Justice Sanjay Kaul has shared that former Chief Justice of India (CJI) D.Y. Chandrachud may have discussed proposed names for judgeship with the Union Government even before the collegium met to discuss them. He characterised this as seeking the government's 'pre-approval', which erodes the judiciary's autonomy.

Provisions in the Constitution
Article 124 of the Constitution provides that judges of the Supreme Court shall be appointed by the President after consulting the Chief Justice of India (CJI). Similarly, Article 217 provides that judges of a High Court shall be appointed by the President after consulting CJI, Chief Justice of the High Court and Governor of the State. The original Constitution provided for consultation by the executive with the judiciary before appointments to safeguard judicial independence as well as to ensure quality, as judges are best equipped to assess the professional and technical merits of proposed candidates.

The collegium system
As per process laid down in the Constitution, judges were appointed by the government after consultation with the judiciary till 1980s. In the First Judges case (1981), the Supreme Court had upheld the primacy of executive in judicial appointments since it is accountable to the people. However, considering the need to maintain independence of judiciary and insulate it from political favouritism, the Supreme Court in Second Judges case (1993) created the collegium system for appointment of judges. This was reaffirmed by the Supreme Court's opinion in Third Judges case (1998). The collegium currently comprises the CJI and four senior-most Supreme Court judges for appointments to the Supreme Court, and the CJI and two senior-most judges for appointments to High Courts.



The collegium system for judicial appointments is a unique process devised by the SC. FILE PHOTO

The detailed procedure for appointment, as per the guidelines of the Supreme Court in Second and Third Judge cases, is captured in the Memorandum of Procedure (MoP) for appointment of Judges prepared by the Union Law Ministry in 1998. As per the MoP, the collegium initiates the proposal for appointment of judges to the higher judiciary and sends the recommendation to the Central government. The Centre may return a recommendation in case of any objection or reservation with respect to any of the proposed names. However, if the collegium reiterates the recommendation, the appointment should be made.

The Parliament through the 99th Constitutional Amendment in 2014 had set up the National Judicial Appointments Commission (NJAC) to provide recommendations to the executive for the appointment of judges. The NJAC was to consist of the CJI, two senior judges, Union Law Minister and two eminent persons. This was however struck down by the Supreme Court in 2015 as it violated the basic structure of independence of the judiciary. Hence, the collegium process continues till date for appointments.

After the NJAC judgement, the government and the judiciary agreed to revise the MoP to usher in more transparency into the appointment process. However, owing to differences of opinion on some of the aspects of revised MoP drafted by the executive, it has not been finalised even after 11 years.

International practices
The collegium procedure for judicial appointments is a unique process that has been devised by the Indian Supreme Court, that has no parallel in any other democracy.

In the U.S., judges to the Federal Supreme Court are nominated by the President and confirmed by the Senate.

In the United Kingdom, the independent Judicial Appointments Commission comprises 15 commissioners appointed from the judiciary, the legal profession, and the public. This JAC selects candidates for judicial office in courts and tribunals. Appointment of Judges to the U.K. Supreme Court (UKSC) is based on a selection commission that consists of President of the UKSC, a Senior U.K. judge, and three other members that includes a member of JAC.

In South Africa, there is a Judicial Service Commission (JSC) that consists of 23 members, including the Chief Justice and representatives from the judiciary, legislature, executive, lawyers and academia. This JSC recommends names to President for appointment of Judges.

The way forward
The collegium system has ensured the independence of the judiciary from the executive, in the matter of appointments. Nevertheless, it has its own drawbacks like the lack of transparency and accountability. There is also resentment on account of alleged nepotism in this process whereby kith and kin of sitting judges are favoured for appointment to higher judiciary. The immediate reform would be to finalise the revised MoP that would bring in the required transparency and consultative process in appointments.

The long-term reform could be to revive the NJAC with a broader composition. It can include representatives from the legislature, the Bar Council and academia, like in South Africa and the U.K. This would make the consultation process more broad-based and inclusive. The judiciary could still be provided with a veto over the final recommendation to protect its independence.

(Rangarajan R. is a former IAS officer and author of 'Courseware on Polity Simplified.' He currently trains at Officers IAS academy. Views expressed are personal.)

THE GIST

- The collegium system, devised by the Supreme Court, has ensured judicial independence from the executive in the matter of appointments. However, it has drawbacks, including a lack of transparency and accountability
- The long-term reform could be to revive the NJAC with a broader composition. It can include representatives from the legislature, the Bar Council and academia, like in South Africa and the U.K.

Assessing the outcome of MLC elections

The electorate for these polls represents only a section of voters, unlike in general and Assembly elections

Sanjay Kumar
Arindam Kabir

Discussions highlight too much emphasis being given to the recent Legislative Council (MLC) elections across States. Even a sweeping victory or defeat does not necessarily indicate a party's loss or gain in popular support. This is because the electorate in these polls represents only a section of voters, unlike in general and Assembly elections.

Across Uttar Pradesh, 11 constituencies went to polls while Bihar saw eight seats up for grabs. Maharashtra and Karnataka went to the polls in five and four constituencies, respectively.

MLC elections are held for the Vidhan Parishad, the Upper House of a State legislature, which exists in only six of the 28 States – Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. A council can have no more than one-third of the Assembly's strength and never fewer than 40 members. It is a permanent house that cannot be dissolved. Members serve six-year terms and one-third retire every two years, so elections are staggered rather than held all at once.

Members reach the Council by five routes. One-third are elected by MLAs, one-third by local bodies such as municipalities and district boards, one-twelfth by graduates and one-twelfth by teachers. The remaining one-sixth are nominated by the Governor from among people with distinguished work. Voting is by secret ballot under proportional representation by single transferable vote.

Graduate and teacher constituencies are territorial, and the Election Commission conducts the polls. A graduate voter must have held a degree for at least three years, and a teacher must have taught for at least three years in a secondary school or higher institution. Both must live or work in the constituency, and neither is enrolled automatically, since each has to apply to be placed on a separate roll. This is why these electorates are so small. The Council has limited powers, it cannot vote on money bills, and the Assembly can override its recommendations on ordinary legislation. That is another reason these results say little about who governs the State.

Although these elections do not reflect a party's overall electoral performance, their outcomes offer some insight into its organisational functioning and strength. Winning these seats requires identifying candidates, registering voters months in advance and mobilising a small electorate to turn out – tasks that depend on the party machinery, not a wave.

Congress opens account in Nagpur
With its win in one Nagpur seat, the Congress managed to gain some headlines and open its tally. But the party should take this as a lesson, having failed to open its tally even in Karnataka, where it is in power. The BJP-JD(S) alliance swept all four seats there. A ruling party is expected to have the State machinery, cadre and local connect to win at least a seat or two. Failing to do so suggests a gap between the government's position in Bengaluru and the party's organisational presence on the ground. Congress leaders may rightly say that the result is no verdict on the government. But a clean sweep in a State where the party is in power cannot be brushed aside.

BJP's victory and cause for concern
It is fair for the BJP to celebrate winning 13 out of the 28 seats, which does reflect the strong organisational strength of the party across States. What can be seen as a setback for the party is that the graduate voters' constituency has been BJP's stronghold. In the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, according to the Lokniti-CSDS National Election Studies 2024 post-poll survey, BJP alone enjoyed 38% support among graduates and above, while it was 45% for the NDA. A party that has long counted on the educated, urban voter will be concerned to see that cushion thinning.

The loss in five seats in Uttar Pradesh, particularly Varanasi, should be a warning bell for the BJP as the State goes to polls next year. The party's performance in Uttar Pradesh in the 2024 Lok Sabha election left it short of a majority on its own at the national level, forcing it to depend on allies. Varanasi is the Prime Minister's own constituency, making the symbolism hard to ignore, even though the stakes are modest. The BJP cannot afford a repeat in 2027, and any sign that educated, middle-class voters are drifting away will worry its strategists.

Jan Suraaj gains ground in Bihar
The party opening its tally in Bihar can be seen as a sign of its growing organisational strength, especially after its founder, Prashant Kishor, won the Bankipur by-election in August, defeating BJP's Neeraj Kumar by 19,324 votes in a seat the BJP had never lost since 1995. Jan Suraaj had failed to win a single seat in the 2025 Assembly election. Two wins in three months show a party that is converting its campaigning into votes. Whether that carries over to a general election, where it must reach a far larger and more varied electorate, remains an open question.

On that count, the Congress has work to do, the BJP has reason to be careful, and Jan Suraaj Party has reason to feel encouraged. The sensible reading of these results is a modest one; as a rule of thumb in studying elections, we should not overread the data. These elections do not show the will of the entire electorate, but they do indicate a party's organisational strength and mark an important move in boosting the morale of the party cadre.

(Sanjay Kumar is a Professor at CSDS and an election analyst; Arindam Kabir is currently a researcher with Sanjay Kumar at the Centre for the Study of Developing Societies (CSDS). Views are personal.)

IN THE LIMELIGHT



A scene from the 2026 Tamil film *Dorothy*. SONY MUSIC SOUTH/YOUTUBE

Animals as symbols of caste, masculinity and human relations in *Dorothy*

The animals in Karthik Subbaraj's period drama appear in moments of vulnerability and violence; fighting roosters and rams mirror male aggression, while dung beetles guided by the cosmos contrast with people who have clearly lost their moral bearings

Vasudevan Mukunth

Dorothy, the Tamil film written and directed by Karthik Subbaraj, was released in theatres on September 25 and has taken viewers by storm. It is set in rural Madurai in the 1990s. It follows two young men, Subbu and Karthi, and the rigid ideas of masculinity and caste that test their friendship. When Dorothy arrives in their village, her presence challenges all their assumptions. Sananth, Rishikanth, and Keerthy Suresh play the principal roles, alongside Muthukumar as a powerful moneylender.

But as the humans of *Dorothy* impose their systems of domination and control on one another, try as they might, the natural world itself remains indifferent to the social hierarchies they consider so crucial.

Understanding the motifs

In a recent interview, Mr. Subbaraj said he based the motif of the rooster in the film – which Subbu names and nurtures – on his research into Bahuchara Mata, a Hindu goddess associated with transgender communities and whose mount is a rooster. A festival centred on this deity is a guiding light in the film. Mr. Subbaraj also said the motif inspired the cockfighting scenes, and that he included it both to represent a piece of the Madurai landscape and to connote a higher meaning.

Many of the other animals of *Dorothy* are similarly a part of the material world of rural Tamil Nadu, even as they represent the human relationships unfolding within it. Some of the animals people capture and slaughter, force to fight, or turn into weapons against other people.

On the other hand, the scorpion and the dung beetle act independently of human concerns, and in one serendipitous moment, set Karthi's and Subbu's shared journey on a very different path.

The skinned hare suspended from the ceiling in the house of Veeraiya, the local moneylender and Subbu's father, paints an obvious picture of vulnerability stripped of protection, not coincidentally displayed in the home of a man who controls other people through economic dependence and caste power. There is also a disturbing parallel between the hare and Dorothy herself. The house is not just a place where people destroy vulnerable bodies but also normalise the cruelty of such actions.

Masculinity and dominance

Members of Veeraiya's community also breed, train, and pit roosters and rams against one another for their entertainment. The visual meaning is obvious: it is the men that are really aggressive and territorial, seeking dominance over others. Their masculinity is animalistic. Yet all the cruelty we see on screen, especially all that matters to *Dorothy*, is entirely human, arising as it does from caste, property, honour, and gender expectations, rather than anything imposed by nature.

When the ram headbutts that poor man to death, an animal is becoming an instrument of human judgment. The violence is organised and conferred a social purpose, turning the scene into a commentary on the men, who have also conditioned themselves to fight and prove their masculinity.

But then there are also the dung beetle and the scorpion, and the expansive verdant backdrop.

Significance of the landscape

The animals in the film were computer-generated, and what the audience is asked to take away from their presence and actions in certain scenes is what the filmmakers have intended. That said, they themselves are not out of sorts with what we expect.

The landscape itself, from hilltop grasses to weeds in the dilapidated pond, from overgrown shrubs to forests in the distance, are real in both senses and just as important. As cinematographer Tirru said in an interview, the filmmakers deliberately placed people against these views to reveal the smallness of the men's egos and the irrelevance of their prejudices within the larger world.

The scorpion is mindless of human authority and, by being itself, accidentally frustrates Karthi's plan for a murder. When Karthi is treated for the sting, Subbu asks the doctor whether the poison has left his body – a question as much about the literal poison as the foul ideas filling his head and heart. The scorpion has thus become an agent of redemption.

Lost bearings

The dung beetle, finally, made a curious, even amusing, appearance. It has nothing to do with the plot yet it cuts perhaps the most memorable figure. It appears rolling a dungball as three men brawl in the background. The choice reverses our usual hierarchy of attention, which is to put ourselves and our needs first. But as the men risk their lives over their pernicious social expectations, rolling around in the figurative excrement they themselves have laid, the beetle simply gets on with its own, thoroughly unbothered.

Dung beetles also find their way using the moon and stars, being guided by the cosmos itself, whereas the people nearby have evidently lost their moral bearings.

Overall, the animals of *Dorothy* do not create a unified allegory. The cattle, for instance, are just there to reinforce the film's rural locale.

But even though they were simulated on a computer, many of the animals that do make an appearance, especially in moments of violence and vulnerability, deserve our attention.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

Video game publisher Electronic Arts announced the closure of the beloved RPG studio BioWare last week. A quiz on their celebrated space-faring series Mass Effect

Mohammed Hidhayat

QUESTION 1
Banshees are Reaper-indoctrinated versions of which species?

QUESTION 2
Which composer, known for Requiem for a Dream, led ME3's score?

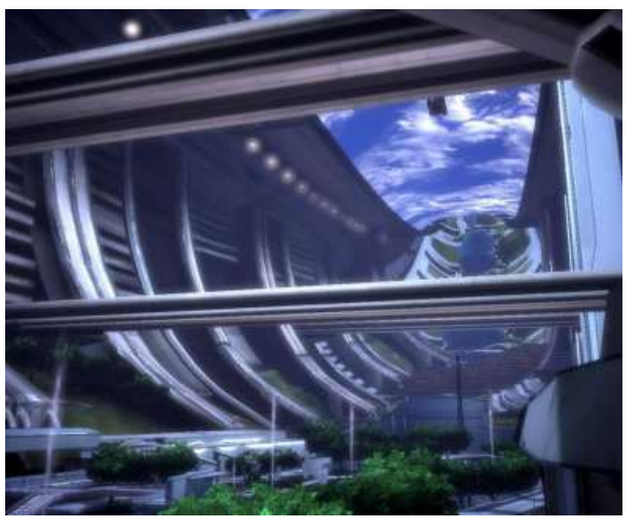
QUESTION 3
What is Garrus Vakarian's favourite activity?
a. Staring into the unknown b. Calibrations c. Dancing

QUESTION 4
Name the biological weapon developed to control Krogan population.

QUESTION 5
Fill in the blank. Quarians wear environmental suits because of a _____.

QUESTION 6
Who is the primary human antagonist that Shepard confronts near the ending? Name the actor who voiced the character.

QUESTION 7
Fill in the blank. The _____is a gigantic, worm-like creature believed to be inspired by Frank Herbert's Dune.



Visual question: Identify this enormous space station that serves as a central hub for galactic politics. BIOWARE

Questions and answers to the previous daily quiz: 1. The Workers' Party or the Partido dos Trabalhadores was formed in this year. **Ans: 1980**
2. Reason for Brazil's Congress and Supreme Court buildings being stormed in 2022. **Ans: Far-right candidate Jair Bolsonaro, the principal opponent of Lula, refused to concede the election and claimed that it was stolen/illegitimate. This led to his supporters storming the buildings**
3. Brazil's top political leaders were hit by scandal when this anti-corruption investigation exposed money laundering and corruption. **Ans: Operation Car Wash**
4. Significance of the number '13' in association with Lula. **Ans: In Brazil, voters punch in a two-digit number to cast their vote. Lula's official ballot number is 13**
5. In 2004, a New York Times article on President Lula infuriated him. Name the reporter and what the article said. **Ans: Larry Rohter; he said that President Lula had a drinking problem**
Visual: Here, Lula is seen with another global leftist leader and icon. Name the revolutionary leader. **Ans: Fidel Castro**
Early birds: Tito Shiladitya| Sudhir Thapa| Sunil Madhavan| Baburam Sapre| Suchit Narottam



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the difference between "dinner" and "supper"? (Nellai S. Murugan, Chennai)
The word "dinner" is normally used by Indians to refer to the meal that is eaten in the evening. Native speakers of English, on the other hand, use the word to refer to the main meal of the day. Some people have their main meal in the afternoon, while others have it in the evening. So what we call "lunch" may be referred to as "dinner" by native speakers of English. The important thing to remember here is that "dinner" is considered by some to be the most important meal of the day. "Supper", on the other hand, is something that is had only in the evening. And unlike "dinner", it is usually a very light meal. One can have it early in the evening or just before going to bed. Americans tend to use the word "supper" quite often. It is usually a meal eaten at home with members of the family. When you invite someone to have a meal with you in the evening, you usually ask them to have "dinner" with you, not supper.

How is the word "tete-a-tete" pronounced? (K. Sankara Narayana, Kurnool)
"Tete" rhymes with the words "date", "hate", and "late". In other words, the final "e" in the word is silent. The "a" which occurs in between is pronounced like the "a" in "bath", "path", and "mask"; the main stress is on the second "tete". Any idea what the word means? When you have a "tete-a-tete" with someone, you have a chat with him/her. A "tete-a-tete" is usually a private conversation between two individuals. Here are a few examples:
The Principal had a tete-a-tete with the Head of the English Department.
Rahul has a regular tete-a-tete with Shoba.

What is the meaning of the idiom "to be all thumbs"? (Keshav Murthy, Uduvalli)
When you say that someone is "all thumbs" what you are implying is that the individual is very clumsy when it comes to working with his hands. He is very awkward and keeps making many mistakes. A person who is all thumbs will not be good at things like painting, stitching, and sewing. Here are a few examples.
I never ask Govind to dust those expensive vases. He's all thumbs.
When it comes to catching, Das is all thumbs.

What is the meaning of "double whammy"? (K.P. Pillai, Kochi)
The expression "double whammy" first appeared in a cartoon strip, which was quite popular in America in the 1920s. Al Capp, the author of the comic strip "Li'l Abner" used this expression to refer to an intense stare, which had a withering effect on its victims. It's meaning has undergone a considerable amount of change since then. This is how slang dictionaries define "double whammy" – double the portion of something, especially something troublesome. When you get a "double whammy" of something, it is usually something really bad. Here is an example:
We thought he'd come alone, but he gave us a double whammy by bringing his wife and children.
Published in The Hindu on May 28, 2002

Word of the day

Fugacious:
lasting a very short time

Synonyms: ephemeral, passing, short-lived, transient

Usage: *The peace between the two countries proved fugacious as tensions soon resurfaced.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/fugacious

International Phonetic Alphabet: /fjuːˈgeɪ.ʃəs/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'

From Page One

SC seeks aid for victims of digital arrest scams

The *amicus curiae* pointed out that psychologists have said the victims may have undergone some sort of hypnosis.

The CJI questioned the state of mind of people who, rather than swinging into action to alert the nearest police officer, allow themselves to be victimised in a democracy. He said digital arrest has turned into the "biggest financial fraud in the history of this country".

The court said the "problem was [that] bank employees are involved". The CJI asked whether the RBI was "soft-pedalling" on bringing in regulatory measures.

Attorney-General R. Venkataramani, appearing for the Union government and the RBI, advised against haste, saying counter-measures cannot be put into effect with "a wave of the magic wand", but only through ongoing and exhaustive consultations between the central bank and stakeholders. He said the proposed RBI (KYC) Amendment Directions, 2026, would be notified by November 30 and operationalised by December 31.

SC says fireworks order breached 'left and right'

The court asked Additional Solicitor-General Aishwarya Bhati, for the Centre and the Delhi government, to ensure enforcement against sellers of spurious and banned firecrackers who want to draw maximum profit from the seasonal business.

The top court said the change has to come from within the people.

"Traders will go by supply and demand... Your officers will have to forget their personal celebrations. They have to go out and see what is happening on the ground... So far, what are the measures you have taken... Show us your enforcement data... Be very serious in giving effect to our orders," the judge said.

The court proposed that the government take the help of celebrities like cricketer Virat Kohli to spread awareness against firecrackers.

In October 2025, the court had permitted the sale and bursting of green firecrackers in Delhi-NCR during Deepavali with conditions aimed at balancing tradition with environmental and health concerns.

37% pre-SIR Form 6 rejected in Telangana due to declaration rule

Swathi Vadlamudi
HYDERABAD

Shifting goal posts by the Election Commission of India (ECI) with regard to the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls have resulted in rejection of lakhs of application forms for new voter enrolments in Telangana.

A large number of applications for fresh voter registration, submitted through Form 6 before the start of the SIR process, got rejected because they were not accompanied by a declaration form mandated as a prerequisite for enrolment. The declaration form, which was an attachment to the Form 6 exclusively for the SIR process, sought details of the voter or the voter's parents/relatives from 2002 SIR. In the absence of such details, the applicants were required to submit any of the listed 12 documents as proof of their citizenship.

As per data obtained from the office of the Telangana Chief Electoral Officer, a total of 5,20,331 applications were received for new enrolments during the pre-SIR period between January 1 and June 14They were not accompanied by the declaration form, which was made mandatory only during the SIR process. As per the Registration of Electors Rules, 196, such claims should be exhibited at the office of the Electoral Registration Officer, and disposed of in a week's time.

Of the total pre-SIR Form 6 applications, only 3,22,785 were accepted as new enrolments till October 28. A total 1,92,574 were rejected.

17 lakh kg of diverted PDS grain seized in Karnataka; 215 held

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

As part of a crackdown on the illegal diversion of ration supplies across Karnataka, officials from the Food, Civil Supplies, and Consumer Affairs Department seized 17.78 lakh kg of rice and other foodgrains meant for public distribution over the past three months.

Since August 1, officials inspected vehicles transporting ration commodities and searched private warehouses in various districts. on the directions of Food and Civil Supplies Minister Rizwan Arshad.

Belagavi district accounted for more than 5 lakh kg of the seized foodgrains, followed by Kolar with 3.5 lakh kg. More than one lakh kg of rice and other foodgrains each were seized in Bagalkot and Vijayapura districts.

The department has registered 238 FIRs at police stations across the State, and arrested 215 persons. It has also confiscated 156 vehicles allegedly used to transport ration.

Census trainers tackle tough queries

Hundreds of sessions being carried out across U.P. and 3 more States before door-to-door enumeration begins on December 1; this phase involves 40 questions, 13 of them new; trainers urge enumerators to exercise caution and sensitivity when seeking responses on caste and Aadhaar details

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI



Mammoth task: Enumerators being trained on Census operations in Ghazipur this week. @DCO_UP/X

At a large hall being used for a training session for Census enumerators in Uttar Pradesh on Thursday, a field trainer explains the importance of question number 37, which seeks the respondent's Aadhaar.

"If any respondent creates an issue, they need to be told that the particular question is only to find out how many people have an Aadhaar. They are to be told clearly that we are not seeking their bank account details and Aadhaar cannot be used without biometrics anyway," the trainer announces on a microphone as more than 50 enumerators, mostly schoolteachers, listen with rapt attention.

This is one of hundreds of training sessions being carried out across Uttar Pradesh and three other poll-bound States, before they begin door-to-door enumeration on December 1, for the second phase of Census 2027. The rest of the country will undergo the same exercise in February 2027. In preparation for the challenging task ahead, trainers flag the thorniest questions, including new queries on caste, age and place of birth of parents, and of course, Aadhaar.

'Citizenship proof'

At one particular session attended by *The Hindu* – its precise location has been withheld to protect the identity of Census officials – the trainer suggests that enumerators offer hesitant respondents an interesting incentive to coax them to share their Aadhaar data.

"At present, there is no single document that proves citizenship. If we get the accurate information during Census, then in the future, this document may act as a proof of citizenship," the trainer says, adding that any information provided during the Census is confidential.

The government has consistently maintained that Aadhaar is not a proof of citizenship, and a senior Census official told *The Hindu* that "no such instructions" have been passed to the trainers.

"There is no instruction to link Aadhaar with citizenship test. The question is optional, if a person says that he or she has or even does not have Aadhaar, it will be recorded as such. The enumerator will ask for the Aadhaar and if the respondent does not want to provide the number, the question can be skipped. The particular field trainer may have had some misconception," the Census official said.

13 new questions

This population enumeration phase involves 40 questions, and enumerators must spend at least 20 to 25 minutes with each respondent, unlike the first houselisting operations phase which only took a few minutes. Each enumeration block comprises 750 to 800 people.

There are 13 questions being asked for the first time: caste (other than Scheduled Tribe/Scheduled Caste), religion, place and date of birth of both parents, number of bank accounts, spouse's name, nationality, digital literacy, permanent residential address, place of COVID-19 vaccination, passport number, driving licence availability, and mobile, Aadhaar, and voter ID numbers, if available.

Question 10 C

Another question that enumerators were told to be cautious about was question number 10 C, which asks the caste of the respondent.

"You have to manually write the caste, as what is being told to you, there will be no dropdown option. It is a sensitive question and your job is not to argue or do any kind of commentary on the issue. You have to navigate this question in a sensible way," the field trainer tells the enumerators. To a pointed question from the audience, the trainer responds, "There will be no separate column for OBCs [Other Backward Classes]."

Other than Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes who can choose the names from a pre-determined drop box, all others will have to type the caste name in an open column. This is Independent India's first caste enumeration. Question number 10 (C) says: "If not SC/ST in this State/UT-Enter Caste name." There are two other options: "Does not want to declare Caste", and "No Caste." The data fields on caste are marked "mandatory".

Age estimation method

The trainer explains to enumerators how they are to determine the age of the parents of elderly respondents.

"For senior citizens, who may not remember the date of birth of their parents, an estimation method may be applied. The age can be approximately calculated by taking into account the age of their siblings, etc. If the place of birth is in India, then the details are also to be recorded," the trainer says.

This is India's first digital Census, meaning that around 34 lakh enumerators will capture respondents' data using an app on their personal phones.

Ready to provide counterterrorism expertise to ASEAN countries: India

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI



Collective approach: Defence Minister Rajnath Singh at the 13th ASEAN Defence Ministers' meeting in Cebu, Philippines. PTI

India is committed to collective regional security and the eradication of terrorism in all its forms and is ready to share its battle-tested counterterrorism expertise with ASEAN partners to strengthen joint capabilities, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said on Thursday.

Addressing the 13th ASEAN Defence Ministers' Meeting-Plus (ADMM-Plus) in Cebu, Philippines, Mr. Singh said India's counter-terrorism experience was not theoretical knowledge but had been acquired through decades of confronting complex security challenges, including cross-border terrorism.

He said India's strategies had been tested and refined through real-world operations, with Operation Sindoor demonstrating the country's proactive counter-terrorism doctrine.

During the operation, India dismantled terrorist infrastructure and enforced a firm red line against state-sponsored terrorism, he said. Emphasising that terrorism knows no borders, Mr. Singh said India was prepared to share its operational experience with ADMM-Plus partners through joint exercises, capacity-building programmes and intelligence sharing.

Counterterrorism remains an important area of cooperation under the ADMM-Plus framework, with India and Malaysia co-chairing the Experts' Working Group on Counter-Terrorism for the 2024-2027 cycle.

In a significant proposal to deepen regional engagement, Mr. Singh called for the establishment of a dedicated defence 'Youth Bridge' to strengthen institutional people-to-people connectivity between India and ASEAN countries. The ASEAN members appreciated the move. The initiative would promote digital innovation and capacity building, while providing greater opportunities for young people to contribute to regional peace and security.

Highlighting the importance of maritime security, Mr. Singh said India had designated 2026 as the ASEAN-India Year of Maritime Cooperation and had conducted the second ASEAN-India Maritime Exercise. He reiterated India's commitment to freedom of navigation, international maritime law and the security of global sea lanes.

Shutdown in Manipur over two missing Kuki youth

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Committee on Tribal Unity (CoTU), an organisation of the Kuki-Zomi communities, has announced a 48-hour shutdown in Manipur's Kangpokpi district, condemning the alleged abduction of two Kuki youth and demanding their safe and unconditional release.

The shutdown began at 5 p.m. on Thursday and will continue until 5 p.m. on October 31.

According to the CoTU, the two youth went missing around 5.30 p.m. on Wednesday while travelling between Hengbung and Taphou Kuki villages in the district.

Non-Kuki extremists are suspected to be involved in the "abduction" of Thangginlun Chongloi and Paominlal Chongloi, both 20-year-olds.

SC reserves verdict on ED plea for CBI probe in I-PAC case

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The ED had blamed Mamata Banerjee for removing records and devices from the sites of the raids

The Supreme Court on Thursday reserved judgment in a petition filed by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) for a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into the alleged obstruction of its raids at the offices of political consultancy firm I-PAC and its co-founder Pratik Jain in Kolkata by then West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, State officials and other individuals.

A Bench headed by Justice Prashant Kumar Mishra closed the final arguments in the case even as senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for Ms. Banerjee, said power in West Bengal had changed hands.

The current dispensation could very well take a call on whether or not to transfer the case to the CBI, Mr. Sibal said.

The ED had arraigned the State of West Bengal, Ms. Banerjee, the State's Director-General of Police, the Kolkata Police Commissioner, and the Deputy Commissioner of Police, South Kolkata.

The agency had blamed Ms. Banerjee for removing records and devices from the sites of the raids. She had at the time countered that the raids were a deliberate attempt to derail the Trinamool Congress ahead of the Assembly election in 2026. The party had consulted with the firm over the past few years.

Election body extends SIR timeline in several States

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Thursday revised the schedule for the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Maharashtra, Delhi, Andhra Pradesh, Haryana, Telangana, and Nagaland.

In Maharashtra, the deadline for filing claims and objections has been extended from October 26 to November 13.

The notice phase and disposal of claims will now run until November 25, and the final roll will be published on November 30. The draft roll came out on August 31, and disposals had earlier been fixed for November 10.

In Delhi, claims and objections can now be filed until November 25, instead of October 30. Disposal of claims has been pushed to December 15.

Itanagar rally seeks release of detained anti-dam protesters

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Over 30 persons were detained after protest against the proposed mega-dam project in Siang

Members of several youth and social organisations carried out a solidarity rally in Arunachal Pradesh's capital, Itanagar, on Thursday, demanding the release of people detained for opposing the push for a mega dam as a counter to China's massive hydropower project on the Yarlung Tsangpo.

More than 30 people were detained after a violent protest in the State's Siang region on October 23 and 24 against the proposed 11,200-megawatt Siang Upper Multipurpose Project (SUMP) on the Siang river. Local people say the project would spell disaster for the land and its people, but the government claims it would minimise the impact of a 60,000-MW project China is building across the border.

'Not against dams'

The Yarlung Tsangpo flows into Arunachal Pradesh as the Siang, which meets the Dibang and Lohit to form the Brahmaputra in Assam.

The protesters, who converged at Itanagar's Indira Gandhi Park, demanded protection of land, rivers, indigenous identity, and the locals' rights. They said they were not against dams, but they could not allow the government to bulldoze its way to build massive structures that threaten the people's existence.

"We, the victims of the proposed SUMP, are fighting for the protection of our land, fundamental rights, culture and existence. We are peace-loving Indians, but the government is treating us like second-class citizens," a leader of one of the local groups said.

'Drop the project'

The protesters asked the government to drop the SUMP plan and withdraw security personnel from the Siang region. "The government is trying to conduct the pre-feasibility survey for the SUMP by militarising the area," a protestor said.

A week ago, mobs opposing the proposed SUMP set fire to an office of the NHPC, which has been entrusted with preparing the pre-feasibility report for the project, and vandalised the houses of three politicians, including two MLAs. At least four women were injured in clashes with the police. The anti-SUMP agitation spread to the Upper Subansiri district, bordering China, where the NHPC is pursuing the proposed 1,605-MW Subansiri Upper Hydroelectric Project, also called the Menga Dam. Violence was reported from several areas, including Upper Subansiri district headquarters Daporijo, during a 12-hour shutdown against the project on Monday.

APPEAL



Master Lukman Latif, Manipal Hospital No.MH019057991, 12 years is suffering from Congenital Heart Disease S/P ICR for TOF with Infundibular Resection done in 2015 No Residual VSD severe RVOT Obstruction (Predominantly Subvalvar and Valvar) confluent branch PAS, LPA smaller than RPA LPA leak gradient of 25 mm HG RV Hypertensive RV Dysfunction Chief Complaint. He requires to undergo early redo RVOT resection surgery. The Estimated cost of the Surgery is Rs.6,00,000/-.

Please send donation however small by Cheque/D.D/M.O Fav. **Save Poor Lives** A/c Lukman Latif, **Our A/c Details:** S/B A/c No. 20000913487. S.B.I. R.A.Puram, IFSC CODE:SBIN0001855. Please Donate by G-pay No.9884607377, UPI Id: savepoorlives@oksbi. Donations are exempted under 80G of I.T. ACT.

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Kharge, Rahul to speak at CEC 'impeachment' event

Former Lok Sabha Speaker Meira Kumar to preside over proceedings; Opposition bloc to avoid imagery that could be seen as mocking Parliament; people affected by SIR to take part in event

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI



Key event: Former Lok Sabha speaker Meira Kumar, Congress leaders Jairam Ramesh, K.C. Venugopal and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and others during a meeting of INDIA bloc leaders on Thursday. PTI

The "public impeachment" of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar planned by the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) over alleged electoral manipulation through the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls will avoid imagery that could be seen as mocking Parliament as an institution.

Sources told *The Hindu* that there are unlikely to be any impersonations, posters, or banners depicting the Prime Minister, the Home Minister, and the CEC. The programme is also likely to avoid any symbolic representation of the Treasury Benches.

However, there is no official word on how the event, intended as a curtain-raiser for the Sunday rally, will unfold on Friday afternoon at Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge's official residence here.

Sources said former Lok Sabha Speaker Meira Kumar is likely to preside over the proceedings, while Mr. Kharge, who is also the Leader of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha, is likely to move the motion against the CEC. Congress leader and MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra is said to be supervising the finer details of the public impeachment.

Timing for speech

Both the LoPs will get about 20 minutes, while the Samajwadi Party and Mamata-Trinamool Congress will get 10 minutes during these proceedings. Other parties will get five minutes each. Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi is likely to be the last speaker, the sources added.

Representatives of civil society, leaders of student organisations and people whose names have been left out of the electoral rolls are expected to attend the event. One leader from each political party is likely to speak on the issue.

On Thursday, Mr. Gandhi released a video appeal urging people to join the INDIA bloc's Chalo Dilli march at the Ramlila Maidan on Sunday.

"Don't worry about the police, don't worry about lathis – the BJP will not have the guts to try any of their antics. Come march with us – we will walk together to protect the Constitution, to protect the Indian nation," he said.

"I urge all student groups, regardless of your political affiliation – if you feel that India is under attack, if you feel you are under attack, your expression, your ideas, your way of thinking is under attack, come, and join us," he said.

BJP has lessons to learn from Uttar Pradesh Legislative Council elections

NEWS ANALYSIS

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI



The BJP bagged six out of the 11 MLC seats that went to the polls in Uttar Pradesh. Votes were counted on Wednesday. ANI

The results of the Legislative Council elections to 11 seats in Uttar Pradesh, including both Graduates' and Teachers' constituencies, have given the BJP much to ponder ahead of the Assembly election scheduled to be held early next year. The outcome suggests that the party may have to jettison more than half of its sitting MLAs going ahead.

The BJP bagged six seats and the Samajwadi Party five. Within this meta narrative, however, are worries for the BJP.

The first big takeaway for the BJP is that the results of the elections demonstrate that the 2024 Lok Sabha results may not be a fluke, when the SP, with 37 seats, brought down the BJP's handsome tallies of 71 seats in 2014 and 62 seats in 2019 to 33 seats in 2024.

In this Legislative Council elections, the SP not only retained the Varanasi Teachers' and Graduates' constituencies, it also won the Lucknow Graduates' constituency and the Agra Teachers' constituency that were previously held by the BJP.

Even in the Gorakhpur-Faizabad seat, the pocket borough of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, the victory margin for the BJP was just 307 votes. There appears to be an overhang of certain grievances carried over from the 2024 Lok Sabha election that have not been addressed yet.

A BJP district office-bearer from Agra, speaking to *The Hindu*, said that the party's loss of seats in Agra and Lucknow was worrying.

"Congress not doing well is no surprise, just like a student who only studies on the eve of the exams, but the BJP is that *padakhu* [studious] student who studies through the year, so this performance does not match the preparations we make," he said.

Internal analysis

An analysis within the BJP after the 2024 election concluded that not changing many MP candidates may have cost the party. Therefore, there is talk that many sitting MLAs may be dropped in the party's final candidate list, amounting to a *tabula rasa* (clean slate) for the party.

This is just one part of the lessons from the Legislative Council elections for the BJP. They are a limited electoral exercise compared with the Assembly or Lok Sabha elections, but the educational qualifications required to both stand for the elections and vote in them point to the elite discomfiture with the BJP.

In the specific instance of Agra, the SP fielded Akash Agarwal, from the upper caste Vaish community, usually considered the backbone of the BJP's voter base. SP chief Akhilesh Yadav later even claimed that the letter 'A' in his formulation of PDA (*Pichhda* or backward, Dalit, and *Alpsankhyak* or minority) could be expanded to include the Agarwal/Vaish community. Some analysts feel that the anger among the upper castes on the University Grants Commission's social equity regulation is still simmering.

More than identity politics, the results also point to local irritations and anxieties. From estimations of what could be brewing beneath the surface, a course correction, which BJP never shies away from, may well be in order.

Cong. needs broader strategy to take on govt.

NEWS ANALYSIS

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

Amid a pause in the agitation seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and opposing the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls because of festivals, the Congress is preparing for a show of strength at the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) rally at the Ramlila Maidan in Delhi on Sunday.

Beyond the rally, however, the Congress and the wider Opposition bloc may need to recalibrate their strategy on the alleged "vote *chori* (theft)" campaign, which has overshadowed issues that affect voters' everyday lives – inflation, unemployment, youth distress, and alleged corruption.

The Congress Working Committee (CWC), which met on August 19 in the aftermath of students' protests against paper leaks and demands for the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as the Union Education Minister, had identified several core issues.

These included the "plight" of the youth, alleged donation theft at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, reports of Chinese incursions into Arunachal Pradesh, and concerns over E20 petrol's lower mileage, compatibility risks and the loss of consumer choice.

Focused on SIR

However, the principal Opposition party and the INDIA bloc have focused almost entirely on alleged vote theft and electoral manipulation through the SIR since reports emerged that two Election Commissioners differed with the CEC over the implementation of the electoral roll revision exercise.



Congress leaders Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi during a protest against CEC.

On October 12, Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, likened the Opposition's protests against vote theft to Lord Shiva's *tandav* (cosmic dance). "There is no need for a plan. A dance is going on, Lord Shiva's dance. And anyone can join Shivji *ki baraat* [the wedding procession of Lord Shiva]," he said.

While the Opposition parties have continued their street protests against the CEC and the SIR, there is also a realisation that the fight against constitutional bodies such as the Election Commission of India is likely to be a prolonged one. The Opposition also needs to raise issues that are closer to people's everyday realities or have the potential to put the government on the defensive in the immediate term.

The U.P. story

In Uttar Pradesh, for instance, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav is keen to focus on donation theft in Ayodhya alongside the SIR.

At a tea party on October 13 at Mr. Gandhi's official residence, Opposition leaders discussed raising other issues but agreed to keep the vote theft campaign at the forefront to avoid losing momentum.

Recent social media posts by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, however, reflect a subtle shift, with inflation during the festive season being linked to "vote *chori*". "The Modi government, desperate to strip away voting rights, now wants to eliminate the right to live as well. Amidst festivals, back-breaking inflation is gobbling up every single penny of earnings," Mr. Kharge said in on X on Wednesday.

On Thursday, responding to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's jibe over the Congress's performance in ballot-based MLC elections across 28 seats in four States, Congress communications chief Jairam Ramesh asked him to reflect on the BJP's losses in Varanasi, his parliamentary constituency, and Nagpur, an RSS stronghold.

The Congress leader urged Mr. Modi to address inflation, unemployment, and stalled private investment. "Drop the arrogance and reflect on these issues!" Mr. Ramesh said.

Cong. questions delay in framing charges in temple donation case

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Questioning the delay in framing charges against the eight accused over alleged donation theft at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, the Congress on Thursday also asked why former temple Trust officials Champat Rai and Anil Mishra were witnesses and not accused in the case.

Charges could not be framed for the third time, Congress general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh said in a post on social media platform X, while questioning the delay in providing the complete CCTV footage and audio recordings.

"Whose secrets will be exposed if the full video footage and audio of the Ram Mandir come to light?" Mr. Ramesh said, alleging that the Bharatiya Janata Party government was protecting those responsible for the alleged misappropriation.

Mr. Ramesh said CCTV footage had captured 105 instances of donation money being removed. He also cited audit warnings issued in 2020, a video of the alleged theft that surfaced on June 4, and an FIR registered on June 25.

The Congress demanded an independent and impartial investigation under the Supreme Court's supervision and sought a comprehensive account of the donations. Targeting Prime Minister Narendra Modi for his silence, Mr. Ramesh asked why he was avoiding accountability despite taking credit for the temple's construction.

PM-Kisan funds to be released today

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will release the 24th instalment of the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN) on Friday in Gujarat.

Over ₹18,690 crore will be transferred directly to the bank accounts of more than 9.34 crore farmers.

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For details and online submission of bid please visit www.etenders.kerala.gov.in
Last date of submission of bids: 07.11.2026, 03.00 PM.
29.10.2026 Director, C-DIT

CJP will help those fighting injustice, says Abhijit Dipke

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijit Dipke on Thursday assured support to all those fighting against injustice, urging people to give the outfit time to respond to various national issues.

In a video message posted on Instagram, Mr. Dipke said CJP stands in solidarity with all voices against injustice – including the family of deceased IIT Bombay student Sahil Wakode, those raising concerns regarding the situation at Jamia Millia Islamia and those protesting against the felling of trees in the Bhimashankar wildlife sanctuary. He added the outfit, formed just a few months ago, has limited resources and is dealing with police action against its leaders and volunteers, making it difficult for the organisation to immediately respond to emerging issues.

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Chief General Manager (S&M)
30001/138/2627 OIPR-30001/30005/1/26-27/0106

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, KHAIRIBHANDAN & DEO IRRIGATION PROJECT, KARANJIA, AT/PO : KARANJIA, DIST:- MAYURBHANJ-757037
Tel : 06796-296144, e-mail - cce.dip.dowr@gmail.com
"e" Procurement Notice No.18/CCEKDIP of 2026-27 - Bid Identification No. 18/CCEKDIP of 2026-27

1.	Nature of the Work	:	Civil Work
2.	Number of Works	:	02 (Two) Nos of Individual Work
3.	Approximate amount put to tender	:	Rs.583.78 Lakh to Rs.584.17 Lakh
4.	Period of Completion	:	9 (Nine) Calendar Months including rainy season
5.	Class of Contractor	:	"A" Class Contractor
6.	Date & time of Availability of Bid document in the portal	:	Dt.03,11.2026 at 10 AM to 17.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM
7.	Last date & time of seeking tender clarification	:	Dt.12.11.2026 up to 1.00 PM
8.	Last date & time of receipt of Bids in the Portal	:	Dt.17,11.2026 up to 5.30 PM
9.	Date, time & place of opening of Technical Bid/s (Cover-I)	:	Dt.18,11.2026 at 10.30 AM in O/o the Chief Construction Engineer, Khairibhandan & Deo Irrigation Project, Karanjia
10.	Date, time & place of opening of Financial Bid/s (Cover-II)	:	To be intimated after evaluation of Technical BID
11.	Name & address of the officer inviting Bid	:	Chief Construction Engineer, Khairibhandan & Deo Irrigation Project, Karanjia, AT/PO-Karanjia, PS-Karanjia, Dist-Mayurbhanj, PIN-757037

*Further details can be seen from the Govt. web site : www.tendersodisha.gov.in.
Any addendum/corrigendum/cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said Website
Chief Construction Engineer, Khairibhandan & Deo Irrigation Project, Karanjia
32001/1174/2627 OIPR-32001/32337/1/26-27/0017

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Sl No.	Tender ID	Items
1	2026_KMML_870461_1	Process Design Consultancy for Vent Gas Scrubbing Systems in IBP
2	2026_KMML_881109_1	Land Remediation in KMML

Chavara 29.10.2026 Sd/- Managing Director for The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd

KSEB KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - Tender Notice
O/o the Executive Engineer, Transmission Division, Kaniyambetta, Wayanad.
E-Tender ID No.2026_KSEB_881475_1, PAC : Rs. 1,71,77,924/-, Last Date: 05.11.2026 04.00 pm
O/o the Chief Engineer, (REES&PED), Vydyuthi Bhavanam, Thiruvananthapuram.
E-Tender ID No.2026_KSEB_879025_1, PAC: Rs.1,75,00,000/-, Last Date: 04.11.2026 05.00 pm
O/o the Deputy Chief engineer, Civil Circle, Pallom, Kottayam.
E-Tender ID No.GEM/2026/B/8207302, PAC: Rs. 2,96,31,360/-, Last Date: 19.11.2026 11.00 am
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SRFDCL invites Expression of Interest from the reputed, well-experienced Agency to PROPOSED SPACE REQUIREMENTS AND PREFERRED COMMERCIAL/REVENUE MODEL FOR THE RIVERSIDE SAVOURIES PROJECT ON THE WEST BANK OF RIVER SABARMATI BETWEEN ELLIS BRIDGE AND NEHRU BRIDGE EOI document is available on web sites https://ahmedabadcity.gov.in, www.tender.nprocure.com and https://www.sabarmatiriverfront.com. Interested consulting firms having good experience are requested to submit their proposal up to 17.00 Hrs., 27.11.2026 offline at the above mentioned address in Sealed hard copy at the address along with their Proposal in sealed cover. The pre-bid Meeting will be arranged on Dt. 12-11-2026. Executive Director, S.R.F.D.C.L

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CSIR-INDIAN INSTITUTE OF CHEMICAL BIOLOGY
(COUNCIL OF SCIENTIFIC & INDUSTRIAL RESEARCH)
4, Raja S. C. Mullick Road, Jadavpur, Kolkata - 700032 (W.B.) India
SHORT TENDER NOTICE
1. Name of work: Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of Different Makes and Models Split-Type (Inverter and Non-Inverter) Air-Conditioning Units and Ductable AC System, and Removal, Shifting and Re-Installation of Existing Split AC Units at CSIR-IICB, Jadavpur and Salt Lake Campus.; 2). Estimated Cost ₹30,36,126/-; 3). E-Tender No. 2026_CSIR_294595_1; 4). Publication date in C.P.P. portal —27.10.2026; 5). For further details please visit https://www.iicb.res.in/tenders, and https://etenders.gov.in/eprocure/app.

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INTERNATIONAL ADVANCED RESEARCH CENTRE FOR POWDER METALLURGY & NEW MATERIALS (ARCI)
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03.	तकनीकी सहायक "ए" Technical Assistant "A	07
04.	सहायक "ए"/ Assistant "A"	06
05.	तकनीशियन "ए"/ Technician "A"	09
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Last Date for submission of online application : 21.11.2026

INBRIEF



HC seeks ED stance on Lalu's plea in money laundering case

The Delhi High Court on Thursday asked the Enforcement Directorate to respond to RJD leader and former Railway Minister Lalu Prasad's petition challenging a trial court order on the framing of money laundering charges against him in a case related to the alleged IRCTC hotel scam. The court issued a notice to the agency on Mr. Prasad's petition against the trial court's September 10 order. The ED case arises from an FIR by the CBI, which has alleged that Mr. Prasad entered into a criminal conspiracy with the owner of Sujata Hotels and IRCTC officials for "undue pecuniary advantage to himself and others" between 2004 and 2014.

29 unrecognised parties from Gujarat record ₹510-cr. income

Twenty-nine Registered Unrecognised Political Parties (RUPPs) from Gujarat recorded the highest reported income of ₹510.41 crore during the Financial Year 2024-2025. This was followed by ₹218.48 crore by 73 parties in Delhi and ₹173.36 crore by 23 RUPPs in Rajasthan, according to a report by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR). Together, the three States accounted for nearly 80.67% of the total reported income of ₹1,118.494 crore of all 734 RUPPs whose audit and contribution reports were available on the respective State Chief Electoral Officer's websites. The ADR report analyses the status of submission of annual audit reports and contribution reports of RUPPs as well as their electoral performance.

Post-cyclone, heavy rain wreaks havoc in Odisha

More than 200 villages in 22 blocks across Ganjam and Gajapati districts severely affected; roads washed away, villages marooned, three rivers in spate, and paddy crops nearing harvest damaged

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR



A drone view of a flooded area in Berhampur in Ganjam district of Odisha on Thursday. PTI

Heavy rain triggered by Cyclone Arnab wreaked havoc in Ganjam, Gajapati, and Kandhamal districts of Odisha on Thursday, washing away roads, marooning villages, and triggering landslides, as State officials struggled to restore normalcy.

The rainfall recorded in the three districts was among the highest ever recorded. "Exceptionally heavy rainfall occurred over south Odisha during the past 24 hours, ending at 8.30 a.m. on Thursday. The highest rainfall of 546 mm was recorded at Patrapur (Ganjam), followed by 503 mm at Sorada (Ganjam), 462 mm at G. Udayagiri (Kandhamal), 458 mm at Mahendragarh (Gajapati), 388 mm at Sanakhemundi (Ganjam) and 309 mm at Chikiti (Ganjam)," the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said.

A stretch of the National Highway 326 connecting Berhampur with Mohana was washed away by swirling floodwaters, disrupting road connectivity. Road infrastructure also suffered extensive damage in Gajapati district. The hilly terrain compounded the situation, as torrents of rainwater rushed downhill into low-lying areas, triggering landslides and damaging infrastructure.

In Ganjam district alone, 42,500 people were marooned by floodwaters, while 11,000 people were shifted from vulnerable areas to designated shelters.

Coast Guard steps in

With roads cut off and hundreds of villages inundated by floodwaters in Ganjam, the State government roped in the Coast Guard to airlift stranded people.

"In response to a distress call received from the Ganjam district administration on the morning of October 29, 2026, the Coast Guard Air Enclave, Bhubaneswar, scrambled an ALH Mk-III helicopter despite severe weather conditions," the Coast Guard said in a statement.

"Despite challenging conditions, the aircrew located the heavily inundated Public Health Centre in Jagmohan, where people were stranded by floodwaters following the storm. Hovering precisely over the submerged area, the crew successfully winched six people, including two women, two children and an elderly person, to safety," the statement said.

The cyclonic storm triggered widespread rainfall across the southern and southwestern districts of Odisha. More than 200 villages in 22 blocks across Ganjam and Gajapati districts were severely affected. The Rushikulya, Vansadhara and Mahendratanaya rivers were in spate.

Besides disrupting normal life and transport, the floods also damaged paddy crops nearing harvest in parts of southern Odisha, dealing a blow to farmers.

Petition filed in SC against post-*NALSA* regulatory regime

Abhinay Lakshman
NEW DELHI

The PIL argues that document change regime 'dilutes' the rights, protections, and entitlements meant for 'biological females'

A public interest litigation (PIL) plea in the Supreme Court has argued that the regulatory regime developed in India on the back of the landmark 2014 *National Legal Services Authority* (NALSA) judgment that recognised transgender identity is "grossly discriminatory" against "biological females".

The PIL plea filed by the India chapter of the U.K.-based Women's Declaration International (WDI) argued that the document change regime also "dilutes" the rights, protections, and entitlements meant for "biological females," and further impinges on the right to freedom of speech and expression by compelling all citizens to "express belief in gender identities".

The trust, which describes itself as a "feminist, non-partisan, all-volunteer and all-female organisation advocating for the rights, dignity, safety, and freedom of women", is seeking to overrule key portions of the *NALSA* judgment, specifically, the portion that ruled that legal recognition of gender identity constituted a part of the right to dignity and freedom guaranteed by the Constitution of India.

A Bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Wednesday issued notices to the Union Ministries of Social Justice and Empowerment, Law, and Health and Family Welfare on the plea. The WDI has argued that while people have a right to "believe in gender identities and hold and express these internal experiences", the regulatory regime that has developed in India through the years since the 2014 judgement has legally recognised gender identity by "overwriting the sex marker in official documents with the person's professed internal experience". It added that this change in "sex marker" has been allowed to propagate into other identity documents like Aadhaar, voter ID, passports, and birth certificates, which has "come at the cost of women's rights to equality, dignity and freedom".

Cancer drug price cuts must reach patients, says former National Health Authority chief

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI



Indu Bhushan

The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority's (NPPA) decision to cap trade margins on 137 anti-cancer medicines is an important step towards reducing the financial burden of cancer treatment, but its success will depend on whether the savings reach patients, Indu Bhushan, healthcare policy expert and former CEO of the National Health Authority, said.

In an exclusive interview with *The Hindu*, Dr. Bhushan said the intervention could substantially reduce costs for patients requiring prolonged treatment. The revised prices are to take effect from November 9.

"The immediate priority should be ensuring that hospitals and pharmacies pass these benefits directly to patients," he said, stressing that uninterrupted availability of medicines is equally important.

The government has introduced the reduction through trade margin rationalisation rather than a direct cut in manufacturers' prices. Under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order, 2013, the NPPA has capped trade margins at 30% of the maximum retail price, excluding applicable GST, for the identified non-scheduled anti-cancer medicines. The measure targets excessive mark-ups across the distribution and retail chain.

However, affordability remains a major challenge. According to a 2023 study involving over 12,000 cancer patients in India, the average annual out-of-pocket expenditure was approximately ₹3.31 lakh per patient. Costs vary depending on the type and stage of cancer, treatment requirements, and the hospital providing care. Families also face expenses on travel, accommodation, and lost income.

India could make cancer care more affordable without compromising medicine quality or pharmaceutical innovation by leveraging generic drugs, biosimilars and domestic manufacturing, while ensuring that lower prices do not weaken manufacturing and testing standards.

For expensive patented medicines, Dr. Bhushan advocates negotiated prices, voluntary licensing where appropriate, and assessments of the additional clinical benefit offered by new treatments.

"The objective is not simply the cheapest medicine. It is the best health outcome at a price that patients and the health system can sustain," he said.

Drawing on his experience in implementing Ayushman Bharat-Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PM-JAY), Dr. Bhushan said financial protection cannot be achieved through price regulation alone. Cancer treatment often extends over months or years, with substantial expenditure incurred outside hospital admissions on medicines, diagnostic tests, consultations, and follow-up care.

Strategic purchasing is also essential, with treatment packages reflecting clinical complexity, quality, and the actual costs of care. Rates set too low could discourage good hospitals from participating, while poorly designed packages could encourage unnecessary procedures or inappropriate treatment.

Dr. Bhushan also stressed the need for greater public investment in cancer prevention, early detection, pathology, radiotherapy, and specialised cancer centres.

"The ultimate objective should be straightforward – no patient should be denied effective cancer treatment because of an inability to pay, and no family should be pushed into poverty because someone has cancer," he said.

Female tiger relocated to Bengal reserve on Oct. 2 moves to Assam

Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA



The tigress crossed the Sankosh river and a road in Assam likely in search of a suitable habitat.

A three-year-old female tiger which had been relocated to the Buxa Tiger Reserve in West Bengal from Bihar on October 2 has crossed into the Raimona National Park in Assam, officials say.

According to the officials, the female tiger, BTR-TF-1 (T-138), crossed the Sankosh river and a road in Gosaigaon in Assam to enter Raimona on Sunday, mostly in search of a suitable habitat.

"Once relocated, it takes a tiger a few times to explore its surroundings and establish its own territory. This female Royal Bengal tiger is also just exploring," West Bengal Forest Minister Manoj Oraon said.

Forest officials from Assam and West Bengal, along with a team from the National Tiger Conservation Authority, are monitoring its movement through the radio collar. The Minister said there was no plan yet to tranquillise it and bring back to Bengal. "It is a tiger's natural habit to explore. We don't want to disturb the tiger or restrict its movement immediately," he said. Buxa was declared a tiger reserve in 1983, but over the past few years there was no tiger presence in the region.

Anantnag Bar elections held 'null and void'

The Hindu Bureau
SRINAGAR

The elections to the District Bar Association Anantnag in south Kashmir held on October 27 have been declared "null and void" by the District Magistrate over alleged violations of official orders and "non-fulfilment of mandatory requirements".

In an order, the DM said these elections "have been conducted in blatant violation of the orders, without fulfilment of the pre requisite conditions, without any intimation to this office and without any permission from this office".

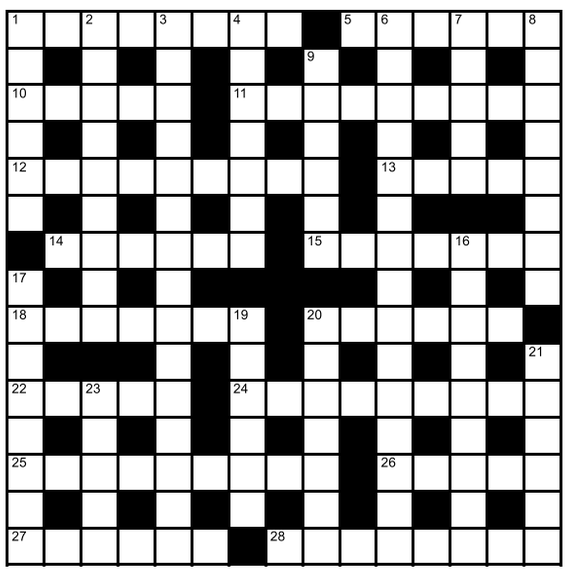
Around 700 lawyers are enrolled in the Bar. The elections were held for the post of president and secretary. "The elections were held after permission and observation of the authorities," said a senior lawyer, on condition of anonymity.

TH CROSSWORD + 14936

(set by Dr. X)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

1 Screams hysterically about a murder (8)
5 Associate works out after gaining weight every time (6)
10 Cavort with European after consuming cocaine (5)
11 Marshal protects a witness (9)
12 Crazy men entering a dangerous Indian city (9)
13 US-Canada defence org. destroyed a drone leaving base (5)
14 Rubbish heap outside fine flat at entrance (6)
15 Recital at opening with medley of flutes is soothing (7)
18 One way or another, escort entertains old male on vacation (7)
20 Former US president's overture to Epstein in tabloid article (6)
22 Starts to holler about vile oppressor causing mayhem (5)
24 The best thing on menu - our rolls (6,3)
25 One captivated by perfect maiden (9)
26 Nervous novice lacks confidence, primarily sheepish (5)
27 Robust model eating special pork meatloaf (6)
28 Come to rest after hosting large shindig at centre from dusk till dawn (3-5)

Down

1 Monsieur's wife is nuts about me (6)
2 Fantastic singers receiving close to twenty million for working together (9)
3 Where paunchy person's belt buckle might be better than average (5,2,3,5)
4 Upset about blood relation being ridiculous (7)
6 Start to dance in the raw, loosen up! (3,4,4,4)
7 Concerning some daft errors (5)
8 Sit astride seat, holding sides of tusker (8)
9 Ogle after drinking whiskey on date, becoming more lascivious (6)
16 Presenting extremely fine American code-breaker (9)
17 Like a small hotel acquired by firm (2,6)
19 Improvise with cleverness to enthral stylish girl (4,2)
20 Modify social media clip about member's retro party (7)
21 Secret desire to have a little romp (6)
23 Repairs anatomical vessel to save military policeman (5)

SUDOKU

	1	4	6			3		
		7					1	
	6			1		9	2	
7			3		9	5		
3			8		5			1
		6	2		1			9
	7	9		5			6	
	3					7		
		8			6	2	5	

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DIFFICULTY RATING: ★☆☆☆☆

Solution to previous puzzle

S	T	O	P	C	O	C	K	
C		D		A		O		N
H	O	O	D	L	U	M		E
I		U		U		M		A
S	C	R	U	M		O	B	N
M		S		N		N		D
			A	I	R	F	R	E
A		S		E		R		R
S	A	T	I	S	F	A	C	T
S		O				C		H
O	R	C	H	E	S	T	R	A
R		K		V		I		L
T	H	E	R	E	T	O		M
E		R		N		N		A
D	E	S	I	S	T		I	N

W	H	I	L	S	T			
	E		A		R			
E	L	L	I	P	S	E		
	A		I		J		A	
N	O	X	I	O	U	S		
D					I		U	
E	S	H	E	N	E	R		
R		O		T		Y		
A	C	T	I	O	N			
	H		K		A		S	
E	S	T	R	A		N	E	P
	L		O		L		E	
	M	A	S	T	O	I	D	
	A		E		M		G	
I	N	E	D	I	B	L	E	

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

4	7	6	3	5	8	9	2	1
3	9	5	1	2	4	7	8	6
8	2	1	6	7	9	5	3	4
5	3	7	2	4	1	8	6	9
1	6	9	5	8	7	2	4	3
2	4	8	9	6	3	1	5	7
9	8	3	4	1	5	6	7	2
7	1	2	8	3	6	4	9	5
6	5	4	7	9	2	3	1	8

FAITH

Mercy of Lord Srinivasa

Swami Vedanta Desika in his composition "Dayasatakam" describes Lord Srinivasa's quality of *daya* (mercy). Valayapettai Ramachariar Swamy said in a discourse that praising the Lord's mercy is equivalent to praising the Lord Himself. Dayasatakam begins with the word *Prapadye*, which refers to *saranagati* (surrender), takes the form of a salutation (*namaskriya*), or denotes supreme faith (*maha vishwasam*), as mentioned in the Rahasya Trayasaram. He takes refuge in an insentient mountain (*girim*) which lacks consciousness and cannot grant boons. Why does he surrender to a mountain? Will it help in accomplishing a goal? Doubt arises.

Swami Desika answers in just two words: *tam girim*, meaning "that mountain." *Tam* (that) in the Upanishads refers to the Supreme Lord of Tirumala Hills. Tirumala is not an ordinary mountain. It is known as Venkatam. *Vem* means sins, *katam* means driving away. It burns away all our sins. Periyazhwar praises Lord Srinivasa as honey, milk, sugar-candy (*kannal*), and nectar. Lord Srinivasa is compared to sweet sugarcane (*kannal*).

The juice of that sugarcane is *daya* (mercy). That mercy overflowed, settled, and crystallised into a rock candy (*kalkandu*). That rock candy is none other than the Tirumala hill. Throughout the Dayasatakam, the quality of mercy is narrated by various names: *daya, kripa, karuna*, and *anukampa*. Lord Srinivasa trembles out of empathy when His devotees suffer. Swami Desika does not surrender to ordinary stone, but to the crystallised embodiment of Lord Srinivasa and Goddess Mahalakshmi, which is the combined mercy of *divyadampatis* (the divine couple).

INBRIEF



U.S. Federal Reserve holds rates despite sticky inflation

The U.S. Federal Reserve held its benchmark interest rates unchanged between 3.75% and 4.0% at its October policy meeting. The 12-member committee voted 10:2 for maintaining status quo while Governor Lisa Cook and Cleveland Federal President Beth Hammack voted in favour of a 25 basis points hike. The decision comes against the backdrop of sticky inflation with the central bank awaiting more economic data before changing the Fed Funds target range. The policy decision was broadly in line with market expectations, with Federal Reserve Chairman Kevin Warsh announcing the Fed would reduce the number of Federal Open Market Committee (FOMC) meetings beginning 2027. One of the FOMC meetings from next year will exclusively address broader monetary policy strategy than rate-setting.

Stock markets rebound over 1% on Fed interest rate pause

Indian equity benchmarks staged a sharp rebound on Thursday, recovering from recent losses as buying in the second half of the session lifted the indices, despite weak global cues and persistent foreign fund outflows. The Nifty gained 1.05% to close at 22,936.77, reclaiming the psychologically significant 22,900 mark, while the Sensex advanced 1.2% to settle at 74,151.04. "Despite volatility surrounding Sensex expiry, investor sentiment improved after the Fed kept interest rates unchanged," said Pabitro Mukherjee, deputy VP, research, Bajaj Broking. Higher U.S. interest rates tend to divert capital away from emerging markets such as India. Meanwhile, the rupee was under pressure, touching two-week low of 95.38 against the dollar before recovering to close nearly unchanged at 95.26. Foreign exchange traders attributed the recovery partly to likely dollar sales by the RBI.

SC rejects beneficiary disclosures of AIFs, FPIs without legal backing

Rapid expansion of Alternative Investment Funds, Foreign Portfolio Investors raises serious concerns over transparency, petition says; Supreme Court bench asks why MP wants to file public interest petition under Article 32 when she could have raised the issue in Parliament

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court refused to direct the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) to mandate full public disclosure of the details of ultimate beneficial owners who own and profit from Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs) and Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) operating within the Indian securities market.

A judicial order mandating full public disclosure of the individuals behind the AIFs and FPIs could not be justified without the support of an existing "legal framework of regulations," the court said.



AIFs, FPIs operated under opaque structures, says Moitra.

A three-judge Bench headed by Justice B.V. Nagarathna said it was ultimately for the Union government and the market regulator (SEBI) to put in a framework based on which the court could issue a mandamus for "full public disclosure". The court asked the Centre and SEBI to consider the need for bringing out suitable transparency Regulations.

"SEBI is the regulator. It has been granted certain powers. The situation in the country and in the international economy keeps on evolving," Justice D.K. Upadhyay said.

The court was hearing a writ petition filed by Member of Parliament Mahua Moitra, represented by advocates Prashant Bhushan and Cheryl D'Souza, who argued the rapid expansion of AIFs and FPIs in financial markets gave rise to serious concerns over transparency.

Unlike mutual funds, (MFs) which were subject to stringent public disclosure norms, AIFs and FPIs operate under opaque structures, raising risks of market manipulation, money laundering and tax evasion, the petition said.

AIFs registered with SEBI had risen over 30 times from 42 in 2013 to 1,528 in 2025, Ms. Moitra said. Their average Assets Under Management (AUM) had risen by more than 835 times from ₹1,437 crore in 2013 to almost ₹13 lakh crore by the end of 2024. Mr. Bhushan submitted Assets Under Custody (AUC) of registered FPIs was over ₹74 lakh crore in 2025.

In contrast, the total AUM of MFs in India was only about ₹68 lakh crore in 2025. While MFs were subject to strict public disclosure norms under the SEBI Mutual Fund Regulations, 1996 and SEBI Collective Investment Scheme Regulation 1999, there was virtually no public disclosure norms for both AIFs and FPIs, the petition said.

Justice Nagarathna said Ms. Moitra could have very well raised the issue on the floor of the House for discussion. Mr. Bhushan said discussions had hardly taken place in the House in the recent past. The senior counsel pointed to Ms. Moitra's expertise as a former investment banker.

"She is also an investor," Mr. Bhushan said. Then this was hardly a petition in public interest, Justice Nagarathna said.

"Is the court saying no MP can approach the SC under Article 32? As an MP, she is concerned about the fate of crores of people who are investing in the stock markets. She believes the opacity may lead to manipulation through AIFs and FPIs," Mr. Bhushan submitted. The judge reminded the counsel the court allowed Ms. Moitra's petition against premature release of 11 convicts in the Bilkis Bano gangrape case.

'Probe, when needed'

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, for SEBI, said disclosures of investments of AIFs and FPIs were made to the regulator and detailed probe was conducted when warranted.

H1 pharma exports rose 5% to $16.14 bn amid key NAFTA dip

N.Ravi Kumar
HYDERABAD

India's pharmaceutical exports rose 4.90% year-on-year to $16,135.93 million in the first six months FY27 aided by market diversification strategy even as shipments to NAFTA region that includes the all crucial U.S. market for generics slid more than 2%.

The April-September numbers, in comparison to $15,382.85 million year earlier period, highlight the scale of exports to Europe, pharma exporters body Pharmexcil said, reporting a 9.66% rise in the shipments at $3,288.27 million.

Europe accounted for 20.38% of the India's pharma exports particularly in Germany, the Netherlands and France, highlighting the opportunities for the exporters to deepen engagement.

Exports to NAFTA, the largest market, which contributed to 32.87% of the total, stood at $5,304.07 million, a 2.05% dip. Other markets that aided growth were Africa with exports rising 6.48% to $2,248.64 million, Latin America at 16.58% to $1,296.94 million and ASEAN 21.54% to $1,058.86 million.

Centre to re-open textile PLI portal

The Union Ministry of Textiles will reopen the portal – https://pli.texmin.gov.in – to receive applications under round four of the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme for textiles from November 1 to December 31.

The focus of the PLI will be on manufacturing of Man-Made Fibre (MMF) apparel, MMF fabrics and technical textiles.

Adani Airports, IHCL plan to build 8 hotels

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Adani Airport Holdings Ltd (AAHL) and Indian Hotels Company Ltd (IHCL) on Thursday signed agreements to develop eight hotels with over 2,000 rooms across Mumbai, Ahmedabad, Lucknow and Guwahati.

The hotels will operate under IHCL's Taj, Vivanta, Gateway and Ginger brands. Adani Airports will develop the properties, to be operated by IHCL.

Adani Airports has formed Adani Airport City Ltd. to develop a land bank of more than 655 acre across eight airports in seven States. In the first phase, Adani Airport City plans to invest more than ₹20,000 crore to develop about 22 million sq ft.

IndiGo Q2 loss narrows to ₹1,879.1 crore on fare gains

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

IndiGo narrowed its consolidated net loss to ₹1,879.1 crore in the second quarter of FY2027 (Q2FY27) from ₹2,582.1 crore a year earlier as higher passenger yields partly cushioned the impact of surging fuel costs amid geopolitical tensions in the Middle East.

The September quarter was marked by exceptionally high fuel costs and continued geopolitical uncertainty, alongside seasonally softer travel demand.

Elevated crude oil prices kept pressure on the airline's earnings.

Fuel, biggest drag

Total expenses rose 18.6% to ₹26,188.4 crore from ₹22,081 crore. Fuel expenses were the biggest drag, climbing 67.2% to ₹9,966.8 crore from ₹5,961.8 crore.



Multiple challenges: Rupee depreciation added to the pressure by increasing the cost of dollar-denominated expenses. REUTERS

Passenger yield–revenue earned/passenger kilometre– rose 34.3% to ₹6.30, helping revenue from operations increase 25.9% to ₹23,363.8 crore.

However, the improvement in yields only partially offset the higher cost base. Capacity, measured in available seat kilometres (ASK) fell 1%, while passenger traffic declined 4.7% to 2.75 crore. The passenger load factor slipped 2.2 percentage points to 80.3% from 82.5% a year earlier.

Rupee depreciation added to the pressure by increasing the cost of dollar-denominated expenses, including aircraft leases and maintenance.

Equitas Bank tanks after CEO steps down

Reuters

India's Equitas Small Finance Bank said its long-time CEO P. N. Vasudevan would resign amid conflict-of-interest concerns as his daughter runs a non-banking finance company, sending its shares down as much as 20%.

Mr. Vasudevan, who has led the lender as managing director and CEO for over a decade, said in his resignation letter that investors had repeatedly raised the issue and that it was weighing on the stock.

Mr. Vasudevan has led Equitas since it started off as a microfinance institution in 2007 and oversaw its conversion to a small finance bank in 2016.

Government of India
Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways
Office of the Chief Engineer & Administrator
Andaman Lakshadweep Harbour Works
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Website : http://andssw1.and.nic.in/alhw
Email : alhw.and@nic.in/ne-alhw@and.nic.in/ nit_alhw@rediffmail.com
SAGARMALA
ITUWTSA NEW DELHI 2024

The Andaman Lakshadweep Harbour Works (ALHW), Sri Vijaya Puram, Andaman & Nicobar Islands, is a subordinate office of the Ministry of Port Shipping & Waterways, inviting applications for filling up of **01 post of "Chief Engineer & Administrator (Pay Level-14)** on deputation in ALHW, For eligibility criteria Annexures and others terms and conditions please visit link: **andssw1.and.nic.in/alhw** and the **Employment News/Rozgar Samachar** dated 26 September -02 October 2026. The last date for receipt of applications is **60 days** from the date of publication of the vacancy notice in **Employment News/Rozgar Samachar.**

BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Shivaji Nagar Division, Thimmaiah Road, Queens Road, Bengaluru.

No.:EE/SJN/E-Proc/31/2026-27 **Date:29.10.2026**

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER (IFT)
(Through KPP Portal Only) (Two Cover System) (Call-VII)

The Executive Engineer, Shivaji Nagar Division, BCCC invites tenders from eligible Contractors registered with CPWD/KPWD/Railways/MES or any State Government Organisations for the works detailed in the table below.

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1.	Park area Development, Construction of seating plaza, Civic center and other finishing works in Ulsoor Lake (Call-VII) **Amount put to Tender :** Rs. 787.20 Lakhs. **EMD:** Rs. 11,80,000/-. **Period of Completion:** 270 Days

1) Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** **2)** Pre bid meeting: **12.11.2026 at 15:00 hrs. 3)** Last Date for submission of tender: **16.11.2026 upto 16:00 Hrs. 3)** Opening of technical bid: **17.11.2026 at 16.30 Hrs. 4)** Opening of Financial Bid: **After Technical bid approved.** Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Executive Engineer, Shivaji Nagar Division.

BENGALURU EAST CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer,
Horamavu Division, Jayanthinagara Circle,
Horamavu Main Road, Horamavu, Bengaluru-560113

No.: BECC/EE/HRM/TEND/05/2026-27 **Date: 29.10.2026**

INVITATION FOR TENDERS (Short Term)
(Only through KPP Protal)

The Executive Engineer, Horamavu Division invites **Item Rate** tenders from eligible tenderers for the work details in the table given below. The tenderers shall be registered in BECC/CPWD/KPWD/Railways/MES/ any State or Central Govt. Organization.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1	Improvements to Roads & Drains at Kothanuru Thimme Gowda Layout Main Roads and Cross Roads and surrounding areas at Census Block Number 20/1 in Ward No. 01 K-Narayanapura. **Estimate Cost (in Lakhs): 100.00, EMD (in Rs.): 2,00,000/-**
2	Improvements to Roads & Drains at Geddhalahalli Village Hirematt Layout Main Roads and Cross Roads and surrounding areas at Census Block Number 1/1 in of Census 2011 Ward No. 01 K-Narayanapura. **Estimate Cost (in Lakhs): 100.00, EMD (in Rs.): 2,00,000/-**
3	Improvements to Roads & Drains at Vaddarapalaya Village Main Roads, Cross Roads and Vaddarapalaya Village Ojus Road at Census Block Number 34 and surrounding area in Ward No. 03 Chelekere. **Estimate Cost (in Lakhs): 100.00, EMD (in Rs.): 2,00,000/-**
4	Improvements to Roads & Drains at Chelkere Village Lakshmi Temple Main Roads and Cross Roads at Census Block Number 46/2 and surrounding area in Ward No. 03 Chelekere. **Estimate Cost (in Lakhs): 100.00, EMD (in Rs.): 2,00,000/-**

Calendar of events: (1) Tender Documents may be downloaded from Government of Karnataka e-procurement website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. (2)** Last date for submission of queries: **04.11.2026** within **11:00 a.m. (3)** Date & time for pre bid meeting: **04.11.2026** at **11:30 a.m. (4)** Last date & time for receipt of tenders: **12.11.2026** upto **4:00 p.m. (5)** Date & time for opening of Technical bid: **13.11.2026** at **4:30 p.m. (6)** Date & time for opening of Financial bid: **16.11.2026** at **4:30 p.m.** Further details may be obtained from the above office during office hours or website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/- Executive Engineer, Horamavu Division, BECC

Secure $15 bn in NMC case, Shetty tells BoB

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

Bavaguthu Raghuram Shetty (B.R. Shetty), founder-promoter of UAE-based failed healthcare venture NMC Healthcare & UAE Exchange, filed two interim applications in Bombay High Court seeking Bank of Baroda (BoB) to secure, earmark or at least disclose his $15 billion damage claim against it and preserve forensic imaging of its systems and $600 million NMC Health settlement papers.

In his application, he sought three tiers of protection pending final disposal of the suit, plus ad-interim relief in the same terms. He has asked Bank of Baroda to furnish security of $15 billion (about ₹1,43,700 crore), with interest as claimed.

The application rests on what it calls the bank's own conduct in 2026 wherein it disclosed in Annual Report FY26 it had a good case in proceedings brought by Joint Administrators of the NMC firms before Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM) Courts.

In a filing, BoB said, "the bank has not been served with such suit. It has not been served with interim applications, subject of today's press inquiries." And it made no provision and disclosed no contingent liability for these claims.

Oracle opens cloud to Google's AI chips

Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

Oracle will offer Google's Tensor Processing Units (TPUs) via cloud infrastructure platform from 2027, marking the first time specialised AI accelerators will be available on a hyperscale cloud platform outside of Google's ecosystem.

Announced on October 27, the partnership will allow Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI) clients to access Google's custom-designed AI chips alongside other computing architectures, expanding options for training and deploying AI models.

TPUs are processors designed by Google to accelerate machine-learning workloads. They offer an alternative to graphics processing units.

Mahesh Thiagarajan, president, Oracle Cloud Infrastructure said, "bringing Google TPUs to OCI gives customers access to multiple leading AI compute architectures on one cloud. The choice gives them the flexibility to choose the right infrastructure for the performance, throughput, and economics of each AI workload."

Under the arrangement, Oracle will provide power, cooling and data-centre networking needed to deploy accelerators while Google will supply TPUs and related software.

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KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru – 560 009. Phone No. 080-22265383. Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-DPR-05/989/2026-27 **Date: 29.10.2026**

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)

KIADB invites tender from reputed consultants/firms under two cover bid system with vast experience and proven record of similar nature of work for project mentioned below.

Name of the Work: Providing Consultancy Services for Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for the formation of Housing Layout at Narendra-Mummugatti Industrial Area, Dharwad Taluk & District (Extent :111.00 Acres) **(2nd Call).**

The last date and time of receipt of tender is :**11.11.2026 Upto 04:00 pm**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/-
Chief Engineer - 2

DIPR/CP/JA/3404/2026-27

TEHRAN

Iran Guards say four tankers on fire after hitting mines in Hormuz



REUTERS

Iran's Revolutionary Guards said on Thursday that four tankers had caught fire after hitting mines while attempting to navigate the Strait of Hormuz, a day after the U.S. military said it had demined key routes through the waterway. The IRGC, in a statement said the vessels had disregarded warnings from the IRGC navy. AFP

WASHINGTON

U.S. fires top military planner over 'leak of classified data', say reports



U.S. ARMY VIA AP

The U.S. has fired a top military planner, media reported, with some outlets saying the dismissal was due to the officer allegedly leaking classified information. Army Lieutenant General Brett Sylvia was removed from his role as head of strategy, plans and policy on the Joint Staff, the media reported on Wednesday. AFP

GAZA CITY

Five people killed in Israeli strikes in Gaza's south, says civil defence



AP

Gaza's civil defence agency and a local hospital said Israeli strikes killed five people and wounded several others in the Palestinian territory on Wednesday. According to reports, three people were killed in a drone attack in Rafah in the south and another person was killed in a strike in Khan Yunis, also in the south. AFP

UNITED NATIONS

India votes in favour of UNGA call for end to U.S. embargo on Cuba



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

India voted in favour of a United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) resolution calling for an end to the economic, commercial and financial embargo imposed by the United States against Cuba, reiterating that the restrictions should be lifted to help the Caribbean nation pursue its development aspirations. PTI

Israel to probe election after Netanyahu's bloc alleges fraud

Arab parties which could play a key role in government formation face unproven accusations of getting foreign funding; they are on track to win 19 seats between them, while the ruling and opposition blocs are well under 61 needed for majority

Agence France-Presse
JERUSALEM

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's bloc on Thursday piled pressure on Israeli Arab leaders over unproven accusations of foreign funding, in a push to neuter parties that could hold the key to forming a government after an inconclusive election.

Israeli President Isaac Herzog called for an investigation into allegations of fraud but cautioned against stigmatising the entire Arab Israeli community.

Israel was nearing the completion of ballot-counting from Tuesday's election, in which neither Mr. Netanyahu nor the opposition bloc led by former military chief Gadi Eisenkot looked able to secure a majority in the parliament known as the Knesset.



A file photo shows Ra'am party leader Mansour Abbas voting at a polling station in Maghar, Israel, on October 27. REUTERS

With nearly 93% of the vote counted, Mr. Netanyahu's bloc was at 53 seats and the opposition forces led by Mr. Eisenkot on 48 - both well under the 61 needed to form a government. The two main Arab formations were on track for an unprecedented 19 seats between them.

The Netanyahu camp's accusations, which a key Arab party has rejected, could bring uncertainty to the electoral process at a time when the threat of a return to war with Iran looms over the region.

Polarised election

Israel's election saw soaring participation by Israeli Arabs as outrage boiled at calls by officials such as National Security Minister Itamar Ben Gvir to treat their community much as Israel has dealt with Palestinians in Gaza and the occupied West Bank.

Following Mr. Netanyahu's accusations of impropriety, Mr. Ben Gvir went so far as to encourage Israel to "immediately" order the arrests of Arab party leaders.

Ra'am party leader Mansour Abbas said he welcomed an investigation, adding that his moderate Islamist party had "no connection" with the accusations.

The Arab parties together have enough votes to take the opposition bloc over the finish line, but Mr. Eisenkot has baulked after attacks by Mr. Netanyahu, who warned his right-wing Jewish base that voting for the opposition would put Arabs in power.

Mr. Eisenkot said the official probe into the claims should run its course without interference, but also accused Netanyahu of seeking to "delegitimise" the election results.

Government officials did not offer evidence to back the allegations, and left-wing candidate Yair Golan accused Mr. Netanyahu of attempting to stir controversy after failing to get a majority.

Netanyahu lost seats, but escaped an outright defeat

NEWS ANALYSIS

Stanly Johny



Benjamin Netanyahu addresses his supporters at a rally after the first exit polls were announced in Jerusalem on Wednesday. AFP

Israel's October 27 election was framed by the Opposition as a referendum on Benjamin Netanyahu. For the country's longest-serving Prime Minister, the election was a battle for survival. For the Opposition led by former military chief Gadi Eisenkot, this was an opportunity to oust Mr. Netanyahu from power. With almost 90% of the vote counted, Israel is divided into three blocs, none of which can govern alone.

The numbers

On the latest count, Mr. Netanyahu's right-religious coalition has 53 seats, eight short of the 61 needed for a majority in the Knesset. His Likud is the largest party with 27 seats, down from 32 four years ago. His far-right partners, Otzma Yehudit of Ithamar Ben-Gvir (7) and Religious Zionism of Bezalel Smotrich (6), hold 13 between them. The remaining seats in his bloc come from the religious parties–Shas and United Torah Judaism.

The Opposition bloc, led by Mr. Eisenkot, has 48 seats, 13 short of a majority. His Yashar party, which was expected to beat Likud, finished second with 21 seats. His allies, B'Yachad of Naftali Bennett (12) and Israel Beytenu of Avigdor Lieberman (7), add a combined 19. But the main surprise factor was the surge of the Arab parties. They have 19 seats between them, with the Joint List winning 12 and the United Arab List (Ra'am) 7.

Likud's slide is real, but it is smaller than the Opposition had hoped. Mr. Netanyahu, a wanted man by the International Criminal Court, a divisive figure at home, and the leader of Israel's right, still commands the single biggest party and the single biggest bloc.

The possibilities

Mr. Netanyahu has built his career on one claim: that only he can "keep Israel safe". This election was the first test of that claim since the failures of October 7, a war in Gaza that has killed over 70,000 Palestinians, and a failed campaign against Iran with global economic consequences. Losing his majority and seeing his party shed seats shows that the claim has weakened, even if it has not collapsed.

But the mechanics of Israeli coalition-building favour the incumbent. As the leader of the largest party and the largest bloc, Mr. Netanyahu can expect to be invited by President Isaac Herzog to form the government. He will have 24 days to prove the majority. He has two ways forward. First, propose a unity government with Mr. Eisenkot and his allies. But it's not clear whether Mr. Eisenkot, who has also promised to form the government, would back Mr. Netanyahu as Prime Minister. Second, Mr. Netanyahu could win the support of one or two of Mr. Eisenkot's right-wing allies (such as Mr. Lieberman or Mr. Bennet) and form a Zionist coalition government. That would break Mr. Eisenkot's coalition.

But if Mr. Netanyahu fails to win a majority, the mandate would pass to Mr. Eisenkot, who faces a harder problem. His 48 seats cannot reach 61 without the Arab parties. Even Ra'am's 7 would take him only to 55. Mr. Eisenkot would need the support of the Joint List as well.

This is the Opposition's central dilemma. Two of Mr. Eisenkot's allies, B'Yachard and Beytenu, have strongly opposed any alliance with Arab parties. '

If neither bloc gets a majority, Israel would return to the polls within months, with Mr. Netanyahu serving as caretaker Prime Minister throughout.

Mr. Netanyahu has lost his majority, his Likud party has shrunk and his claim to be indispensable has been weakened. But the fragmentation of his opponents remains his most reliable asset. He has not won the election, but by denying his opponents an outright victory, he has found a way to cling to power, at least for now.

Ukraine says at least 14 killed in Russian attack on train station

Agence France-Presse
KYIV

At least 14 people were killed when a Russian drone slammed into a platform at the Dnipro railway station in central Ukraine, where a train was parked, Ukrainian authorities said on Thursday.

"Thirteen people were killed in a Russian attack on Dnipro. At least five more were wounded," Dnipropetrovsk regional governor Oleksandr Ganzha said on Telegram. He later said the toll had risen to 14.



Rescuers evacuate a wounded civilian at the Dnipro railway station on Thursday. AP

Dnipro mayor Borys Filatov said that "a drone hit a civilian electric train".

The state Ukrainian Railways operator said a jet-powered Russian drone had hit the Dnipro station. "The strike hit one of the platforms, where train No. 866 Dnipro-Zaporizhzhia was at the time," it said.

Oleksandr Pertsovsky, the rail company's chief, said an elevated threat level had been announced.

"But unfortunately there were still a large number of people on the platform," he said on Facebook.

Bangladesh court sentences Hasina-era minister to death

Agence France-Presse
DHAKA

A Bangladesh court on Thursday sentenced Md Mahbubul Alam Hanif, joint general secretary of ousted leader Sheikh Hasina's Awami League, to death in absentia for his role in the killings of six people during the 2024 uprising, while three other party leaders were sentenced to life imprisonment. Mr. Hanif also served as a minister during Hasina's rule.

The tribunal also ordered the confiscation of half of their immovable properties to be distributed as compensation to the families of people killed or injured during the uprising, Islam said.

As many as 1,400 people were killed between July and August 2024, according to the UN, when Hasina's government attempted to suppress the student-led uprising.

Republicans defend bastions, as Senate comes within reach of Democrats

NEWS ANALYSIS

Sriram Lakshman

As the U.S. heads towards midterm elections next week, the presidency of Donald Trump faces an inflection point, with the prospect of Republican control of Congress weakening. Since early 2026 at least, forecasts have suggested the GOP would lose the U.S. House of Representatives. Recently, however, trends suggest that the Senate too is within reach of the Democrats.

The GOP has a 53-47 majority in the Senate currently, with 35 seats being contested this year. Of these, seven are "toss ups", according to the Cook Political Report (CPR), a non-partisan election analyser. These seats are in Iowa, Arkansas, Kansas, Maine, Michigan, Ohio and Texas. All of these - except Michigan - are currently held by Republicans. Texas has not elected a Democrat from the Senate since 1998. Worries over the economy and cost of living, disillusionment with Mr. Trump's handling of these issues, and relatively lower expected turnout among Republican voters, have put the Republicans at risk of losing one of their bastions.

This week, Mr. Trump made his third campaign visit to Texas in support of GOP candidates up and down the ballot. Republican Greg Abbott is defending his gubernatorial seat against Democratic State legislator Gina Hinojosa, whom he leads narrowly in polls.

In the most watched State race, GOP candidate and Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton, who has been indicted on security fraud and impeached (and acquitted) for the abuse of office, is running against State lawmaker and Presbyterian seminarian James Talarico for the U.S. Senate.

Tight race

The contest is becoming one of the most expensive Senate races on record, as per an analysis from *Reuters*. Republican groups have spent multiples of what Democrat groups supporting Mr. Talarico have, while Mr. Talarico has raised more from individual and grassroots donations than his opponent has. Having moved Tesla, SpaceX and some of his other businesses to the State, Elon Musk has gone on to indirectly donate $158 million in support of Mr. Paxton. Still, the race continues to be tight.

Mr. Paxton's scandals have become a campaign vulnerability for him, as has voter concern over the economy in general. The Republicans have attacked Mr. Talarico as being too liberal for Texas on religious and cultural issues. For instance, his opponents have claimed that he supports sex-change operations in children. Mr Talarico has clarified that he does not support these procedures and that he voted against a Bill banning gender-affirming care for minors because it was too broad.



President Donald Trump throws hats into the crowd at a campaign rally in Chillicothe, Ohio, on Wednesday. AP

At a rally earlier this week in Corpus Christi, Texas, Mr. Trump attacked Mr. Talarico. "He's been a vegan and there's not a damn thing he can do about it," the President said, mocking Mr. Talarico attempting to eat meat and claiming that he gets sick after he eats it. Mr. Talarico has denied being vegan and has integrated barbecue-eating sessions into his campaigning.

But meat has entered the electoral conversation in more than one way. It has become a telling kitchen-table issue that voters are concerned about. There has been an uptick in chicken consumption as beef prices have been rising. The administration took measures in November 2025 and earlier this year to import greater volumes of beef at lower tariffs - a move that was meant to benefit consumers but angered farmers.

Price rise

Food prices, and more generally the cost of living, are at the top of voter concerns. The war on Iran has driven up fuel prices. Costlier petrol and diesel, along with Mr. Trump's tariffs, have pushed up the prices of other goods. Some two-third of Americans disapprove of how Mr. Trump is handling U.S. military action in Iran while a third support it, according to Pew Research Centre data from earlier this month.

Some 85% of voters say the economy is one of the most important issues and 84% say the same about the cost of living as per an AP-NORC poll conducted October 8-11.

A majority of each category of voters want to see "complete and total upheaval" or "substantial change" in the country. That the proportion wanting such change is 58% among Republicans and 90% among Independents poses a significant challenge for the GOP.

Democrats are faced with their own challenges, including not having a coherent and clear message or vision at the national level. Republicans also are perceived as stronger on crime and immigration.

The Republicans have 218 seats in the 435-seat House, all of which are up for grabs. There are 214 Democrats, one Independent who causes with Republicans, and two vacancies. Democrats need to flip three seats , giving them 217 seats (and Republicans 215), to win the House. The CPR's analysis gives Republicans 168 "solid" seats and Democrats 186 such seats. Adding the "likely" Democrat and "leaning" Democrat seats to this gets the party 220 seats. This does not even count the 17 "toss-up" seats which could go either Democrat or Republican, giving Democrats a strong chance of taking control of the House.

If Democrats win the Senate in addition to the House, the future of the second Trump administration will change course, with implications for government funding, foreign policy, judicial appointments and the possibility of investigations and impeachment proceedings against administration officials and the President.

SPINNING A WEB

Wily Warrican leads West Indies' fightback against Bangladesh



AFP

West Indies left-arm spinner Jomel Warrican took five wickets as Bangladesh was dismissed for 272 on day two of the first Test in Mirpur on Thursday. The visitors were 134 for four. **The scores:** Bangladesh 272 in 97.4 overs (Shadman 105, Hridoy 42, Warrican 5/53) vs. WI 134/4 in 48 overs (Campbell 54, Tagenarine 43 batting).

BACK TO WINNING WAYS

Duckett shines as England ends campaign on a bright note



AP

Ben Duckett hit 167 as England beat Sri Lanka by 55 runs to post a consolation win in the ODI tri-series in Lahore on Thursday. **The scores:** England 386/5 in 50 overs (Banton 74, Duckett 167, Brook 44, Cox 43) bt Sri Lanka 331 in 45.1 overs (Avishka 48, Kusal Mendis 89, Pavan 118, Dawson 4/49). **Toss:** Lanka; **PoM:** Duckett.

DREAM RUN

Rybakina makes sure of finishing the year as the No. 1 player



REUTERS

World No. 1 Elena Rybakina secured the year-end top ranking after beating fellow Kazakh Yulia Putintseva 6-2, 6-3 at the Pan-Pacific Open in Japan on Thursday. Rybakina became the No. 1 player for the first time last month during her winning run at the US Open, replacing Aryna Sabalenka at the summit.

SETBACK

Mirabai pulls out of World championships with back sprain



PTI

Mirabai Chanu pulled out of the women's 53kg competition due to a back sprain at the World weightlifting championships in Ningbo on Thursday. Gyaneshwari Yadav, the other Indian in fray in 53kg, competed in Group 'C' and finished an overall eighth with a total lift of 198kg, including 88kg in snatch and 110kg in clean and jerk.

India could be tempted to play Kuldeep and Varun

Having sealed the series, the visitor is likely to make a few changes in the last two games; the Kiwis will be hoping for a much improved show with the ball and a change of fortunes at the toss

INDIA IN NZ

Press Trust of India
AUCKLAND

India, with the series already sealed, will have the opportunity to give much-needed game time to the likes of Kuldeep Yadav and Varun Chakaravarthy when it takes on New Zealand in the fourth and penultimate T20 International here on Friday.

Both the spinners have played sporadically over the past couple of months with the team management packing the side with batters till No. 8.

But as stakes are significantly lower in the last two games, the Indians might just be tempted to experiment with their combination.



Wicket-takers: Both Kuldeep and Varun have the ability to strike in the middle overs. CREIMAS/BCCI

While Varun has battled indifferent form over the past six months, Kuldeep has time and again underlined his immense value to the side by picking up wickets in the middle overs.

In the pace bowling department, veteran Bhuvneshwar Kumar showed flashes of brilliance in the death overs of the previous game in Wellington, landing yorkers consistently in his final over.

However, he has been a tad expensive with 139 runs conceded off his 72 balls in the first three games.

Prince Yadav was preferred in place of Mayank Yadav in the last two games. It remains to be seen if Mayank returns for more game time or the team sticks with the impressive Prince.

There is still no clarity on the availability of Ishan Kishan, who missed the last two matches due to a groin injury.

Nitish Reddy has been playing ahead of Shivam Dube but now with the series in the bag, the former could be rested.

For New Zealand, the biggest challenge has been posed by the Indian top-order. Captain Mitchell Santner has been excellent with his left-arm spin but has not got much support from his teammates.

For starters, Santner would be hoping to win the toss for the first time in the series. Considering the conditions, bowling first has been the preferred template.

After Matt Henry, Lockie Ferguson has also been ruled out of the series due to a calf injury.

Match starts at 12.30 p.m. IST.



Tilak. CREIMAS/BCCI

'Batting at No. 5 makes me go for it from ball one'

Press Trust of India
AUCKLAND

India vice-captain Tilak Varma says moving down from No. 3 to 5 in the batting order has led to a slight change in his mindset and he now eyes boundaries from ball one instead of trying to settle in first.

"I already had the power game; I have scored runs at (number) three as well. Now, batting at number five or six, I think about going for a boundary off the very first ball only if it's there to be hit," he said ahead of the fourth T20I here.

"Otherwise, I focus on taking the game deep. I take a bit more time. Initially, I focus on singles and doubles, finding gaps for fours," he added.

Tilak said the team is determined to make it 5-0. "We are thinking this is a great opportunity to achieve a clean sweep".

Klinger happy with Giants' purchases at WPL mini auction

P.K. Ajith Kumar
KOCHI

The last time Michael Klinger came to Kochi he was an IPL player. A decade and a half later, he is back as coach of WPL franchise Gujarat Giants.

The Aussie, who played three T20Is and was a run machine in domestic cricket down under, will probably fly back to Melbourne in a happy frame of mind, having got what he wanted from Wednesday's mini auction.

G. Kamalini was the player he was most keen on. And the Giants got her for her base price of ₹40 lakh. He is also glad that he could rope in Ireland's Orla Prendergast.

"We had a really good squad before the auction and had a lot of bases covered, but to top up with some players who can easily play in the starting eleven for us was our main aim," Klinger told *The Hindu* on Thursday.

"So now we have got some difficult decisions to make come WPL time. But they are good problems."

Having made the playoffs in the last two editions, Klinger believes he has the team that could go all the way this time. "We have a mix of experienced players and youngsters," he said. "It is great to have champion players like Beth Mooney, Ashleigh Gardner and Sophie Devine."



Klinger. R.K. NITHIN

I was very happy to see Yastika score hundred for India in the Lord's Test

There are exciting Indian talents like Yastika Bhatia. "I was very happy to see Yastika score that hundred for India in the Lord's Test on her comeback after injury," he says. "I think she could play in the Indian T20 team too, purely as a batter."

Looking back to his own career as a prolific batter, he says it is alright that he could only play three matches for Australia, in which he made 38, 43 and 62, against Sri Lanka in 2017. He amassed 24,729 runs across First Class, List A and T20s.

At the IPL, he played for Kochi Tuskers, which existed for just that one season in 2011.

Sindhu enters the last eight; Malvika and Isharani exit

Press Trust of India
SAARBRUCKEN (GERMANY)

P.V. Sindhu stormed into the quarterfinals of the Hylo Open Super 500 badminton tournament with a 21-9, 21-6 win over France's Rosy Oktavia Pancasari on Thursday. However, Malvika Bansod and Isharani Baruah bowed out.

Malvika went down to Canada's Wen Yu Zhang 11-21, 17-21 while Isharani lost to eighth seed Line Hojmark Kjaersfeldt of Denmark 14-21, 19-21.

Australia seizes the advantage

Agencies
CAPE TOWN

Nathan Lyon dismissed captain Temba Bavuma late on the third day as Australia pressed for a series-deciding victory in the third Test against South Africa at Newlands on Thursday. At close, South Africa was 140 for four in the second innings, 40 runs ahead with six wickets remaining.

The scores: South Africa 329 & 140/4 in 47 overs (Ackerman 62) vs. Australia 429 in 125.1 overs (Renshaw 74, Inglis 102, Carey 80, Harmer 4/104).

India registers hard-fought victory over a spirited China

ACT

Uthra Ganesan
JALANDHAR

India coach Craig Fulton had admitted that the Chinese team at the Asian Champions Trophy was unknown and it was difficult to plan against. India was clearly the better side but struggled to find the gaps before prevailing 5-2 on Thursday.

After the goal-fest against Bangladesh, India was up against a Chinese side with a very clear plan – pack the midfield, deny the home team space on the ground and force it to go in the air, then defend with everything they have. It almost worked, the Indians having to adapt, relying on their experience to enter not only the Chinese circle but also to keep them at bay.

A long aerial pass from India's 25-yard line by Jugraj Singh was controlled just inside the circle by Sukhjeet Singh. He carried it a couple of steps ahead on the stick before unleashing a rasping hit over the head of the advancing goalkeeper Huanyu Wu in the 12th minute.



In the limelight: Harmanpreet scored a brace. X@THEHOCKEYINDIA

To China's credit, its structure held firm with a counterattack and a couple of shots on goal.

It finally levelled through Yang Peng's penalty corner conversion in the 26th minute, only for Mandeep Singh to be checked on a counter and hand India a PC of its own. Harmanpreet Singh made no mistake to restore the lead.

The big positive was India's sustained momentum either side of the break, something Fulton has admitted as frustratingly lacking. Two goals ins the first four minutes on resumption of action made it 4-1, Harmanpreet and Sukhjeet adding one each.

Another PC in the 36th minute for China and another goal made it 4-2 before Jugraj Singh got on the scoresheet with a PC.

Fulton would also be happy with India's pace and the fact that not only the aerials were used to good effect but also the midfield's ability to constantly rotate and stretch the opposition thin to move ahead.

The results: India 5 (Sukhjeet Singh 12, 34, Harmanpreet Singh 27-pc, 31-pc, Jugraj Singh 47-pc) bt China 2 (Yang Peng 26-pc, Chen Chongcong 36-pc); Malaysia 3 (Azimuddin Kamaruddin 10, Akhimullah Anuar 36-pc, Faizal Saari 50) bt Korea 1 (Song Haeseong 31); Japan 1 (Raiki Fujishima 40-pc) bt Bangladesh 0.

Former Dortmund star Schmelzer recalls the *Der Klassiker* battles

FOOTBALL

P.K. Ajith Kumar
KOCHI



Schmelzer. THULASI KAKKAT

Marcel Schmelzer has featured in *Der Klassiker* on several occasions. He has played for Borussia Dortmund in 14 seasons of Bundesliga, after all.

Dortmund's clash on Saturday with Bayern Munich would be a new experience for him. He would be watching the match along with Dortmund's fans in Kochi, at Padma Theatre here.

Schmelzer, who is in the city for the Bundesliga 'Z' Football Week, is looking forward to the game. After ending his career as a defender at Dortmund in 2022, he has taken up a coaching job at the club.

The former captain has fond memories of *Der Klassiker*. "My most cherished memory is our 5-2 win in the Cup final in 2012," he said. "It was an amazing game and an amazing season. I am hoping that we will get three points against Bayern on Saturday, too."

Schmelzer, who played 16 games for Germany, is part of the Dortmund coaching staff that will conduct a clinic for local players and conduct workshops for trainers. This is a joint venture by Zee Entertainment and Bundesliga Eagles FC as the local partner.

Eagle FC's chairman Shaffi Mather said the response from young players and coaches was excellent.

"We are glad that we could bring the Dortmund's coaches to Kochi," he said. "And Dortmund has a strong following here. There is a registered fans association for the club here."

Suresh Letchmanan, Managing Director, Asia-Pacific, Borussia Dortmund, said developing young talent was an important part of the club's philosophy.

Ankur star attraction as main draw begins today

WTT FEEDER CHENNAI

K. Keerthivasan
CHENNAI

India will have brute strength in numbers – and the seedings to match – when the three-day main draw of the World Table Tennis Feeder Chennai gets underway at the Tamil Nadu Physical Education and Sports University near here on Friday.

The host will look to turn its numerical advantage into a rich medal haul.

India has seeded players in all five categories – men's and women's singles, men's and women's doubles, and mixed doubles. It does not hold the top seed tag in just one event: women's singles where South Korea's Yang Ha Eun (World No. 64) leads the field.

The spotlight is likely to fall on Ankur Bhattacharjee, one of India's most exciting young paddlers. The 19-year-old, ranked 73 in the world, has enjoyed an impressive year, winning the WTT Feeder men's singles title in Olomouc (Czechia), finishing runner-up in Puerto Princesa (Philippines) and reaching the semifinals in Prishtina (Kosovo) and Istanbul. The reigning Commonwealth champion is confident of adding another singles title and a doubles crown with Akash Pal where the pair is the No. 1 seed.



In prime shape: Ankur believes he is mentally and physically at his best. FILE PHOTO: SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

"I am mentally and physically at my best, and I feel I can win here, too," Ankur, the second seed, told *The Hindu*.

Top seed Manav Thakkar (World No. 49), G. Sathiyan (85) and Harmeet Desai (101) will be Ankur's main challengers.

In the absence of Yashaswini Ghorparde, third seed Divyanshi Bhowmick, (111) will be eyeing a second Feeder crown in women's singles.

The qualifiers: Men:
Singles: Neil Mulye, Divyansh Srivastava, Rupam Sardar, Shridhar Joushi, Nikunj Attri, Sahil Rawat, Arjav Gupta and Jungmok Lee (Kor).
Doubles: Sounav Barman & Priyanshu Karmakar, Soham Mukherjee & Rupam Sardar, Rajiv Sahu & Aaron Farias, Shridhar Joushi & Rahul Malik.

Women: Kavya Baskar, Subhankrita Datta, Swara Karmarkar, Sampada Bhiwandkar, Ananya Chande, Avisha Karmakar, Garima Goyal and Kim Seoyun (Kor).
Doubles: Avisha Karmakar & Aarushi Nandi, Ditsa Roy & Subhankrita Datta, Sataporni De & Gungun Sahu, Advika Agrawal & Shriya Anand.
Mixed doubles: Shridhar Joushi & Pritha Vartikar, Rupam Sardar & Subhankrita Datta, Mehan Senthil & Ananya Muralidharan, Divyansh Srivastava & Ananya Chande.

INBRIEF



Vihari not to turn out for Tripura this Ranji season

Batter Hanuma Vihari will not turn out for Tripura in this season's Ranji Trophy, the northeast side's head coach Satrajit Lahiri confirmed. "Vihari has informed us that he will not play this season because of personal reasons. I don't know what they are. It's a big blow because last season he scored a lot of runs," Lahiri said after Tripura lost to Karnataka in its Ranji Trophy match at Mysuru on Thursday.

India loses to Afghanistan in FIFA u-15 WC and Festival

India lost 1-2 to Afghanistan in the quarterfinals for positions 81 to 88 in the FIFA u-15 World Cup and Festival in Baku on Thursday. The Blue Colts will face Kazakhstan, which lost to Hungary, in the semifinals for positions 85 to 88.

The result: Afghanistan 2 (Mohammad Mustafa 15, Shahzada Sultani 27) bt India 1 (Nibas Meetei Wahengbam 36).



Inter leaves it late, Mbangula helps Bologna sink AC Milan

Inter Milan returned to the Serie A summit with a nervy 2-0 win at bottom side Venezia on Wednesday, while a Samuel Mbangula, *in pic*, hat-trick sealed a 4-2 win for Bologna at San Siro to inflict a first league defeat of the season on AC Milan.

The results: AC Milan 2 (Cisse 14, 27) lost to Bologna 4 (Mbangula 8, 62, 86, Bartesaghi 60-og); Parma 0 drew with Udinese 0; Venezia 0 lost to Inter Milan 2 (Moreno 80-og, Halhal 82-og); Genoa 2 (Ehizibue 12, Baldanzi 28) bt Juventus 0; Monza 1 (Varela 43) lost to Napoli 4 (Hojlund 10, Politano 48, Marin 62, De Bruyne 67).

WTA Chennai Open: Shrivalli, Diya get qualifying wild cards

Shrivalli Bhamidipaty, ranked 640, and Tamil Nadu's Diya Ramesh have been given qualifying wild cards for the WTA Chennai Open 250 starting on Saturday. Shrivalli is making a comeback after recovering from a back injury. Last year, she reached the second round of the main draw.

Espanyol unveils Sarabia as new coach

Eder Sarabia was unveiled as Espanyol's new coach on Wednesday, a day after Manolo Gonzalez was sacked following the club's first round Copa del Rey defeat by fourth division Sestao River. Sarabia, 46, was the head coach of Andorra and then Elche, which he guided into La Liga.



Yusha and Unnati claim National u-19 squash crowns

Uttar Pradesh's Yusha Nafees and Unnati Tripathi clinched the boys' and girls' u-19 titles in the National sub-junior and junior squash championships in Jaipur on Thursday.

The results (all finals): Boys: U-19: Yusha Nafees (U.P.) bt Purav Rambhia (Mah) 11-9, 11-6, 11-6; **u-17:** Hridhaan Shah (Mah) bt Shiven Agarwal (TN) 11-8, 8-11, 11-2, 9-11, 11-2; **u-15:** Dhruv Johri (Har) bt Vedant Agarwal (Jha) 11-6, 11-8, 11-4; **u-13:** Aaron Arambhan (Mah) bt S.K. Aryan (Kar) 11-1, 11-7, 12-10; **u-11:** Agastya Uppal (Del) bt Yuvaan Verma (Raj) 11-9, 6-11, 11-5, 11-6.
Girls: U-19: Unnati Tripathi (U.P.) bt Akanksha Gupta (Mah) 8-11, 11-8, 11-2, 11-5; **u-17:** Saanvi Kalanki (MP) bt Riyansika Verma (Kar) 9-11, 11-5, 11-5, 11-7; **u-15:** Divyanshi Jain (Raj) bt Anika Kalanki (MP) 11-8, 11-2, 11-8; **u-13:** Alia Kankaria (WB) bt Riyaa Dalal (Mah) 11-13, 11-6, 12-10, 8-11, 11-7; **u-11:** Inaya Andrabi (Raj) bt Gaurvi Ajmera (Raj) 12-10, 11-5, 9-11, 5-11, 11-7.

Rigorous training routine works wonders for Badoni

The Delhi captain hits a second double hundred on the trot in the drawn encounter against Jharkhand; he wants to make as many runs as possible and realise the dream to play for India

RANJI TROPHY

Vivek Krishnan
RANCHI

As the persistent drizzle prevailed and prevented any play on the final two days of the Ranji Trophy contest between Jharkhand and Delhi, Ayush Badoni flashed a shy smile. The 26-year-old's expression was emblematic of his mixed emotions at the end as he was adjudged the Player-of-the-Match for his fourth double hundred in First Class cricket in a rain-marred draw.

Badoni's individual accolade, for scoring an unbeaten 210 on Tuesday, came after the fourth day's play was called off by noon on Thursday. Both teams had to be content with a point each.

Delhi would be justified to be annoyed by the gloomy weather. It had reduced the host to 131 for four after amassing 515 for five declared in its first innings.

"We were well ahead. It is unfortunate that the rain played spoilsport, and we have not been able to get six points," skipper Badoni told *The Hindu* after the game.



Making a statement: Badoni won the Player-of-the-Match award for his unbeaten 210. R.V. MOORTHY

The stalemate shouldn't detract from Badoni's prolific form. He has racked up double tons in his last two games, bolstering his First Class average to a formidable 63.84.

The middle-order batter explains his current surge as a response to two subpar red-ball outings for India-A, against Australia-A and South Africa-A, in 2025.

"Last season, the games didn't go very well for India-A. I wanted to make a statement. The dream is to play for India. So, I am just thinking now to make as many runs as possible and not give away my wicket," he said.

A rigorous training routine, in keeping with the demands of the format, has also worked wonders.

"Having played two to three Ranji seasons, I realised that I needed to alter my preparation," Badoni revealed.

"In the build-up to this season, I practised for six hours of batting in a day. We play for six hours everyday in a Ranji game. So I trained like that from morning to evening, with breaks for lunch and tea".

RANJI TROPHY SCORES – ROUND THREE, DAY FOUR

Elite:
Group A:
At Vadodara: Baroda 616 drew with J&K 303 & 316/6 in 96 overs (Sahil Lotra 96 n.o., Abdul Samad 143). **Points: Baroda 3(17), J&K 1(2).**
At Nagpur: Goa 220 & 195 in 76 overs (Manthan Khutkar 70, Shivendra Bhujbal 45 n.o., Harsh Dubey 4/38) lost to Vidarbha 442/8 decl. **Vidharbha 7(19), Goa 0(0).**
At Puducherry: Uttar Pradesh 333 drew with Pondicherry 172 & 211/8 in 98 overs (Ritesh Gudge 41, Aman Khan 62, Kartik Yadav 6/42). **U.P. 3(16), Pondicherry 1(2).**
Group B:
At Vijayawada: Andhra 231 & 184/3 decl. in 32 overs (Ricky Bhui 72 n.o., Karan Shinde 53 n.o.) lost to Chhattisgarh 237 in 107.3 overs (Amandeep Khare 89 n.o., T. Vijay 4/76) & 182/5 in 35.1 overs (Anuj Tiwary 60). **Chhattisgarh 6(7), Andhra 0(3).**
At Hyderabad: Punjab 431 & 240/6 decl. in 78 overs (Vihaan Malhotra 53, Prabhhsimran Singh 68, Uday Saharan 55 n.o.) drew with Hyderabad 380. **Punjab 3(12), Hyderabad 1(14).**
At Mysuru: Tripura 194 & 180 in 78.1 overs (Sridam Paul 50, Shreyas Gopal 5/36) lost to Karnataka 490/9 decl. **Karnataka 7(9), Tripura 0(0).**
At Rajkot: Assam 281 & 94 in 44 overs (Parth Bhut 8/17) lost to Saurashtra 387 in 131.4 overs. **Saurashtra 7(13), Assam 0(7).**
Group C:
At Ranchi: Delhi 515/5 decl. drew with Jharkhand 131/4 in 47 overs. No play on fourth day. **Delhi 1(4), Jharkhand 1(5).**
At Bhubaneswar: Odisha 194 drew with Services 40/0 in 12 overs. **Odisha 1(1), Services 1(1).**
At Pune: Gujarat 223 & 446/5 decl. in 101.1 overs (Aarya Desai 151, Jaymeet Patel 119 n.o., Urvil Patel 96) drew with Maharashtra 330 & 141/4 in 47 overs (Digvijay Patil 55 n.o.). **Maharashtra 3(12), Gujarat 1(9).**
At Thiruvananthapuram: Bengal 350 & 198 bt Kerala 141 & 120 in 38.4 overs (Pradipta Pramanik 6/51). **Bengal 6(18), Kerala 0(8).**
Group D:
At Dehradun: Rajasthan 272 & 290/5 decl. in 101.4 overs drew with Uttarakhand 194 & 38/0 in 9 overs. No play on fourth day. **Rajasthan 3(9), Uttarakhand 1(4).**
At Chandigarh: Chandigarh 685/5 decl. drew with Himachal Pradesh 559/6 in 177 overs (Innesh Mahajan 121, Shubham Arora 96, Pukhraj Mann 51, Vaibhav Kalta 82, Akash Vashist 126 n.o.). **Chandigarh 1(1), Himachal 1(1).**
At Mumbai: Mumbai 430 & 97/0 in 10.4 overs (Angkrish Raghuvanshi 67 n.o.) bt Haryana 270 & 256 in 85.3 overs (Himanshu Rana 46, Nishant Sindhu 44, Samant Jakhar 40, Anuj Thakral 40 n.o., Tanush Kotian 8/81). **Mumbai 7(21), Haryana 0(13).**
Plate:
At Rangpo: Nagaland 187 & 208 drew with Sikkim 184 & 117/5 in 46 overs. **Nagaland 3(4), Sikkim 1(9).**
At Ahmedabad: Arunachal Pradesh 111 & 431 lost to Manipur 364 & 180/6 in 48.4 overs (Ronald Longjam 70 n.o., Langlonyamba Keishangbam 51). **Manipur 6(12), Arunachal 0(0).**
At Nadiad: Meghalaya 562 & 60/2 decl. in 22 overs drew with Mizoram 430 in 168.2 overs (Lalhruaizela 51, Chinmay Sutar 125, Joseph Lalthankhuma 95, Khiangte Vanrotlinga 66, Abhishek Kumar 5/95). **Meghalaya 3(12), Mizoram 1(4).**

Uchchaihshravas for the feature event

HYDERABAD: The five-year-old Uchchaihshravas, who ran second in his last start, should make amends in the Telangana Race Horse Owners Association Trophy, the main event of the concluding day's races here on Friday (Oct. 30).

1 BLUE MAX PLATE (1,200m), 5-y-o and upward, rated upto 25 (Cat. III), 1.15 p.m.: 1. Pranava (6) D.S. Deora 61.5, 2. Most Beautiful (2) Sohan K 61, 3. Aashritha Pet (4) Santosh Raj 60, 4. Amboseli (1) Darshan 58.5, 5. Golden Inzio (7) A.A. Vikrant 58, 6. Char Ek Char (8) Kuldeep Sr. 55.5, 7. Hopewell Island (5) G. Naresh 51.5, 8. Iconic Star (9) Rafique Sk. 51.5 and 9. Niloufer The Great (3) Arjun 50.
1. PRANAVA, 2. AASHRITHA'S PET, 3. AMBOSELI

2 SIRCILIA PLATE (DIV. II) (1,400m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 1.50: 1. Winning Attitude (4) A.A. Vikrant 60, 2. Hoping Star (1) Sohan K 59, 3. Beverley (8) Arjun 57.5, 4. Agasthyeshawara (9) Md. Ismail 56.5, 5. Belgium Waffle (2) Mohit 55.5, 6. Lina O Lina (3) V.S. Shekhawat 55, 7. Bayone (5) D.S. Deora 54.5, 8. Ashwa Vivegam (6) Gaurav 54 and 9. Celestial Power (7) Surya Prakash 53.5.
1. WINNING ATTITUDE, 2. BELGIUM WAFFLE, 3. AGASTHYESHAWARA

3 SHAMSHABAD PLATE (1,600m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 2.25: 1. Ashwa Jaffna (2) Gaurav 60, 2. Hoping High (1) Arjun 57.5, 3. December Rain (4) Mohit 56.5, 4. Aakarshaka (6) Neeraj 55.5, 5. Wind Castle (5) D.S. Deora 52 and 6. Lego (3) Uday Kiran 50.
1. AAKARSHAKA, 2. ASHWA JAFFNA

4 SHAPHIR PLATE (1,600m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), 3.00: 1. White Pearl (3) Abhay Singh 60, 2. Special Star (6) P. Sai K 59, 3. Love All (5) Akshay K 58.5, 4. La Quinta (1) Kuldeep Sr. 56.5, 5. Crimson Flame (2) Surya Prakash 55 and 6. Federer (4) Arjun 55.
1. LOVE ALL, 2. SPECIAL STAR

5 SMT. TEEGALA SULOCHANA REDDY MEMORIAL TROPHY (2,000m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 60 to 85 (Cat. II), 3.35: 1. Celestial (2) Antony Raj 60, 2. Silver Act (7) Mukesh K 59.5, 3. Racing Ruler (1) Kuldeep Sr. 58.5, 4. Tiger Ruby (4) Darshan 55.5, 5. Corte Madera (3) P. Sai K 55, 6. One Nation (6) Akshay K 55 and 7. Shadow Of The Moon (5) A.A. Vikrant 54.5.
1. CORTE MADERA, 2. RACING RULER, 3. ONE NATION

6 TELANGANA RACE HORSE OWNERS ASSOCIATION TROPHY (1,600m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 80 and above (Cat. I), 4.10: 1. Star Of Night (3) Antony Raj 60, 2. Golden Thunder (2) Akshay K 59.5, 3. N R I Superpower (6) B.R. Kumar 58, 4. Diablo (7) Swarup 57, 5. Reigning Beauty (5) Md. Ismail 56.5, 6. Uchchaishravas (4) Neeraj 55.5 and 7. Cherie Chevalier (1) P. Sai K 54.
1. UCHCHAIHSHARAVAS, 2. GOLDEN THUNDER, 3. CHERIE CHEVALIER

7 SIRCILLA PLATE (DIV. I) (1,400m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 4.45: 1. American Affair (6) V.S. Shekhawat 60, 2. Aprameya (3) Md. Ismail 58.5, 3. Nyanza (8) Darshan 55.5, 4. Secret Option (2) Kuldeep Sr. 55, 5. Veera's Lakshmi (5) Santosh Raj 55, 6. Vespucci (10) Arjun 54.5, 7. Sara (4) Mohit 54, 8. Moonlight Rose (7) Surya Prakash 53, 9. Star Lit (1) Gaurav 53 and 10. Meadow (9) D.S. Deora 52.5.
1. APRAMEYA, 2. VEERA'S LAKSHMI, 3. SECRET OPTION
Day's Best: **LOVE ALL**
Jackpot: 3, 4, 5, 6 & 7.
Mini Jackpot: (i) 1, 2, 3 & 4, (ii) 4, 5, 6 & 7.
Treble: (i) 2, 3 & 4, (ii) 5, 6 & 7.
Tanala: All races.

Indian Navy and Army ensure semifinal spots

MURUGAPPA GOLD CUP

S. Prasanna Venkatesan
CHENNAI

Indian Navy sealed the second semifinal berth from Pool-B with a 4-2 victory over Malaysia Junior Team in the 97th All-India MCC-Murugappa Gold Cup hockey tournament at the SDAT Mayor Radhakrishnan Stadium here on Thursday.

Indian Army advanced as the second team from Pool-A after Railways and Punjab National Bank (PNB) played out a 4-4 draw. The result denied PNB the seven-goal winning margin it needed to qualify.

Navy will face Pool-A topper and defending champion Indian Railways in Saturday's semifinal, while Pool-B winner Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd. (BPCL) will take on Army.

Navy, which needed only a draw to progress, dominated play and created several scoring opportunities. It took the lead in the eighth minute through Bhavin Kushalappa after Sushil Dhanwar had struck the left post two minutes earlier.



On target: Selvaraj poised to fire in Navy's second goal. R. RAGU

Malaysia drew level in the 27th minute when Muhamad Harith scored from close range, having earlier sent a shot just over the bar.

Navy regained the lead in the 30th minute. Sanjit Toppo's drag-flick off Pawan Rajbhar's penalty-corner delivery was deflected into the net by K. Selvaraj.

Rajbhar extended the lead in the 36th minute with a close-range flick into the top of the net. Nitesh made it 4-1 in the 43rd minute, before Muhammad Aizat pulled one back for Malaysia a minute later, diving to push the ball past a defender from close range.

The results: Pool-A: Indian Railways 4 (Sheshe Gowda 26-pc & 28-pc, Lovepreet Singh 31, Jaswinder Singh 47) drew with Punjab National Bank 4 (Gursimran Singh 11-pc, Naveen Antil 57, 59 & 60).

Pool-B: Indian Navy 4 (Bhavin Kushalappa 8, K. Selvaraj 30-pc, Pawan Rajbhar 36, Nitesh 43) bt Malaysia Junior Team 2 (Muhamad Harith 27, Muhammad Aizat 44).

Manisha in the title round

Sports Bureau

Manisha Bhanwala (59kg) was the third Indian woman to enter the final at the World wrestling championships in Astana on Thursday. Manisha shocked World championships bronze medallist Laurence Beauregard by pinning the Canadian in the second period.

Then she beat Mongolian Olympian Bolortuya Khurelkhuu 6-0 and pinned Kazakhstan's World under-23 bronze medallist Altyn Shagayeva to reach the title clash.

In the final on Friday, Manisha will face USA's Pan-American champion Abigail Elizabeth Nette.

Earlier, Neelam Sirohi (50kg) and Kajal Dhochak (76kg) secured silver medals for the country. Ahilya Shinde (55kg) was beaten 9-6 by Turkiye's Tuba Demir in the last-eight stage.

In men's freestyle, Vicky (97kg) was defeated 12-2 by Japan's Asian champion Arash Yoshida in the quarterfinals. The Indian made it to the repechage round to stay in the race for a bronze medal.

First thought was always to come back to Blasters: Luna

ISL

Sankar Narayanan E.H.

The footballing landscape has shifted in India and Keralam since Adrian Luna had to leave Kerala Blasters FC on loan to Persik.

In the time he was away from his beloved KBFC, the State added an 'm' to its name, the club welcomed new owners from the UAE, and the Indian Super League – after a truncated and delayed season that led to Luna's exit – moved to a club-led model.

Luna, a household name in Keralam since 2021, admitted he was relieved when he finally got the message to return 'home'. "If you have to wait six months to get the deal, it affects you as you don't know when or if you will start. But once you begin training, you forget about this," Luna told *The Hindu* during a virtual interaction on Thursday.



Fan favourite: Luna... one of KBFC's own. FILE PHOTO: THULASI KAKKAT

"When nobody speaks to you, you start thinking, 'maybe this is it?' But until anyone told me it was over, I didn't look for any other options. My first thought was always to come back to Kerala."

The 34-year-old Uruguayan said he agreed to the Indonesian loan strictly to "help out the club" through a tough spot.

"Everybody knows what happened in Indian football. I told the previous owner, 'I don't want to go, but I will because you are asking me to help you.'

"I had a conversation with my mom and she said: 'These people helped you when you were very low, so you have to pay them back'. In gratitude, I decided to go," he explained.

Luna insists he doesn't worry too much about who owns the club or runs the league.

"Football is football. When you step on the pitch, you don't think about who's running the league or who is the boss. You just play like when you were a kid."

On head coach Ashley Westwood choosing Indian players for captaincy this season, Luna said: "My role doesn't change with or without the armband. It's the coach's decision. I still have the same commitment and respect for everyone at the club."

Through all the turmoil at KBFC, Luna never once doubted the bond between the team and its supporters, the Manjappada.

"You stand with your club like you stand with your family. I understand they were disappointed by past results, which is fair. But I knew they would return because this is the club they love, and it's a way of life here".

Nov. 1 races in Bengaluru cancelled

Sports Bureau

The stewards of the Bangalore Turf Club have decided to cancel the races scheduled to be held on November 1 (Sunday) due to paucity of entries.

LIVE TELECAST

Bangladesh vs. West Indies: First Test, Day 3, FanCode, 9.30 a.m.
New Zealand vs. India: Fourth T20I, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 12.30 p.m.
South Africa vs. Australia: Third Test, Day 4, Eurosport & FanCode, 2 p.m.
ISL: Sony LIV, 7.30 p.m.
New Zealand-A vs India-A: Second 'Test', Day 1, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 3.30 a.m. (Saturday)



Vaishnavi — India's new orchestrator



The left-arm spinner may not have burst onto the scene but is making a case for herself with stellar performances for the National team. Those who have followed her from close quarters believe that the 20-year-old is just getting started

Lavanya L.
VADODARA

The year was 2025. Left-arm spinner Vaishnavi Sharma had made her T20I debut for India against Sri Lanka in Visakhapatnam. She went wicketless but conceded only 16 runs in her four-over spell. After the game, she was snapped sheepishly skirting around the press conference room.

"*Jis baat ka dar tha, wahi hua mere saath* (What I feared has happened to me)," a nervous Vaishnavi had told the BCCI videoperson tailing players for their post-match vlog.

Almost a year and seven India fixtures later, Vaishnavi – now 14 wickets old in international cricket – was not any less nervous when entering the sprawling but sparsely populated media room at the BCA Stadium in Kotambi. She had just taken a sensational five-wicket haul to help India clinch the third ODI against Zimbabwe. This after coolly picking four wickets in the second fixture a few days earlier.

"*Aise kya?* (Is that so?) I am surprised," Chandrakant Pandit, director of cricket at the Madhya Pradesh Cricket Association, exclaimed on hearing about her jitters.

The Vaishnavi he knows is not someone he associates fear or hesitation with. "When I began at Madhya Pradesh in this capacity, I was looking for young talent to give them exposure. Vaishnavi was around 13 then, if I remember correctly," he told *The Hindu*.

"We had a truncated BCCI short-format tournament right after the Covid-19 pandemic. BCCI allowed us to field a squad of 22 because no one could enter or leave the bio-bubble. Vaishnavi was selected and immediately showed promise. It was more about her attitude than her bowling. So I put that 13-year-old in the senior team."

Pandit is not an easy man to impress. He's known to like discipline and order. So it meant something when he said he had not seen a player more confident when approaching him. He quite happily played into that confidence by constantly telling her, "You should be playing for India."

Competition for places

Vaishnavi has not been a regular starter in the National side. India's experiments with a seam-heavy attack and fellow left-arm tweaker N. Shree Charani's meteoric success mean Vaishnavi has had to bite her cheek and wait. She was not selected for India's T20 World Cup campaign in England and Wales a few months ago.

"Something about her destiny has always been like this," Lovekesh Chaudhary, her childhood coach and relative, said.

"For the under-19 T20 World Cup, she wasn't picked initially but was later chosen... she did splendidly. In the Women's Premier League, she didn't get picked first and was then roped in as a replacement. She also missed the World Cup. With Vaishnavi, things get delayed, but they eventually happen. She's not the one to sit back and feel bad that a chance was lost. She is beyond this stuff. It pushes her even more," he explained.

Having two left-arm spinners opens both up for scrutiny, often by being pitted against each other. Shree Charani is a taller bowler and is fast through the air. Vaishnavi is shorter, more loopy and uses her fingers to give the ball more revolutions.

Shree Charani likes squeezing the batters for space while Vaishnavi draws them out, uses width to trick them with turn. But Vaishnavi knows comparisons barely matter if one doesn't use the chance presented to them. It's what helped her dust off the disappointment of missing out on the World Cup.

"The months between my T20I debut and now were good (even if she missed the tournament)," Vaishnavi said after the game on Wednesday.

"I got a good gap to work on myself, to get stronger physically and mentally. It gave me space to figure out the requirements of the game, be it with the ball, bat or in the field. I had the space to develop my game a little more," she added.

During this time, Chaudhary, her 'Chandu sir', coaches of the Madhya Pradesh team and the BCCI's Centre of Excellence and India bowling coach Aavishkar Salvi were voices in her airwaves. But this wasn't a 'too many cooks' situation. There was synergy in what everyone wanted Vaishnavi to master.

"First, [they taught me] to stay calm," she chuckled. "They wanted me to follow the batter from start to finish and repeat that constantly to get better results."

Bhawna Srivastava, the MP u-19 women's coach who saw Vaishnavi as a raw spinner eager to master control, remembered how the desperation to play brought an inkling of doubt to her approach to cricket.

"Serious conversations with her happen rarely. She spoke about working on her batting so she could evolve as an all-rounder. It's hard to stay patient, but it is important. Just one wall had to break and she'd get through," Bhawna said.



CREIMAS BCCI

The value of repetition

Training under Chaudhary and at the MPCA had some fortunate intersections. Both involved mixed gender training hours. Both believed in allowing youngsters time with senior players for skills to evolve.

Somewhere, it also helped Vaishnavi figure out settling into a side with people far more experienced. Much like the Indian National team.

"Vaishnavi played in the higher divisions and also with the u-19 boys in training. Yashbardhan Singh Chauhan, who has captained the India u-19 team, is among the players who train at my academy (Tansen Academy). There are a few others who have played the Ranji Trophy and Cooch Behar Trophy. Vaishnavi has trained alongside them," Chaudhary revealed.

Whenever Vaishnavi is in Gwalior, training goes on for a six-hour block from morning till evening with Lovekesh. She has worked extensively on using the crease, using her fingers to give more revolutions to the ball and more. There's also knowledge exchange with fellow spinners.

Bhawna believes Vaishnavi's probing quality as a person trumps that same gene as a player. "She was quite curious right from the start. The mindset was to keep taking wickets... she'd have a lot of questions if she wasn't able to and would chart out the next course of action. She always wants to learn, it is why she has made it this far," Bhawna felt.

In the two ODIs she featured in recently, Vaishnavi hurled her bag of variations at the Zimbabweans, who had no answers. Her 37 dots bowled in the second game were the joint second-most (along with Sayali Satghare), while she had 46 dot balls in the third fixture, the best in that clash.

"She bowled from around the wicket because the batters were stepping out. These are things she didn't instinctively know before, it is good to see her implementing the things she is learning," Bhawna added.

Target practice became a key part of training.

"I've worked on gaining more control of the ball. I worked on a single wicket and bowled deliveries into one particular spot. It's a simple strategy with a focus on the stump line. My coaches also pushed me to have greater belief in my stock ball," Vaishnavi said.

Innovations within variations

She's also tried to use potentially slow surfaces, like the one that the BCA strip eventually became, to even attempt innovations within variations. "If you can manage more revs on the ball, it will turn... you could also deploy the arm ball against certain batters. It was a good bowling surface."

Despite not being as tall as someone like Shree Charani, Vaishnavi can dip the ball, something Chaudhary calls "a natural gift". Her evolving flight, however, has come from years of innovating against older players and taller male batters in training.

She made it to the MP senior team when she about 13, revealed Pandit

"When she started out, there weren't many revs on the ball when she bowled. We made her understand that the ball's spin is in our hands. Getting turn or not, meanwhile, isn't; that's on the pitch. We see her doing drills to keep the rotation in the hand," Bhawna said.

"We do see a marked improvement in how she's doing it. She's able to spin the ball on any kind of pitch and manage decent turn in the process. It's a big plus point."

Just one flipside though. An intelligent cricketer also always wants the validation of return. Wickets are a bit of an obsession for the cherubic, jovial tweaker.

"I called her after she took four wickets in the second game. Towards the end, she kept saying, 'God, please give me one more wicket'," and the TV mics caught it. So I told her: 'Speak carefully, Vaishnavi, everyone's listening'," Chaudhary quipped. "But in all that fun and games, there's aggression. She is hungry for wickets and is a fighter," he said, proudly.

For Pandit, the worry has always been to ensure confidence doesn't become overconfidence. "She is a bold bowler and she feels like she needs to deploy variations with every ball she bowls. I keep telling her that it might not always work and that it might not always be necessary

"You can learn to settle into a rhythm and then change it up. But she wants a wicket at any cost. I keep reminding her that it might backfire if she loses her line. She's a match-winner, but needs to stay grounded as well," he explained.

The impact of that intervention is visible. Vaishnavi was expensive on her ODI debut against Australia in Hobart earlier this year, going at 8.5 runs an over in her four-over spell. Zimbabwe is a weaker batting side, but she will be buoyed by a stingy 3.9 economy rate. In the third game, though, constantly varying the line and length also resulted in a no ball and five wides, something Pandit has noted down for later.

Bhawna is silently hoping that the innocence in her finds a way to endure. "That excitement she has, that's what makes a player perform. Once that goes away, one starts getting very jaded with their craft. I hope she finds a way to keep that sense of wonder in her as she goes along," Bhawna said.

The work doesn't stop for the 20-year-old. She's already called Pandit to book coaching blocks. "She's a bold girl. This is only the start," he added.

Vaishnavi has been late to every list and early to every wicket. Sooner or later, history will stop keeping track of the difference.

THE GIST

- India's experiments with a seam-heavy attack and fellow left-arm tweaker Shree Charani's meteoric success mean Vaishnavi has had to bite her cheek and wait
- In the two ODIs she featured in recently, Vaishnavi hurled her bag of variations at the Zimbabweans, who had no answers
- Her practice sessions under Chaudhary and at the MPCA have involved mixed gender training. It has helped her evolve

Whenever Vaishnavi is in Gwalior, training goes on for a six-hour block. She has worked extensively on using the crease, using her fingers to give more revolutions to the ball. There's also knowledge exchange with fellow spinners

Vaishnavi knows comparisons barely matter if one doesn't use the chance presented to them. It's what helped her dust off the disappointment of missing out on the T20 World Cup

Can new fortified potato variety help with India's hidden hunger problem?

Kufri Jamunia is a purple skinned and fleshy potato with higher levels of certain nutrients compared to regular potatoes; at present, however, taking into account its production costs, pricing, uptake in the market and its ability to deliver these nutrients, it is unclear if it can help with hidden hunger

Vasudevan Mukunth

Scientists at the ICAR-Central Potato Research Institute (CPRI) have developed a new potato variety called 'kufri jamunia' that has higher levels of anthocyanins, vitamin C, and certain micronutrients than regular potatoes. The Central government has been promoting it of late as a means to address hidden hunger, i.e. when people consume enough calories but still do not receive the necessary nutrients.

Usually, experts who fortify foods, focus on items like rice and iodised salt, which a large number of people in India consume, often throughout the year, thus ensuring the added nutrients are delivered to a significant chunk of the population. Kufri jamunia is however a potato, which people in India generally consume much less consistently than rice or salt, and the micronutrient intake depends on preparation methods and how the body absorbs them.

Kufri jamunia offers nutritional advantages, but they are substantial in some aspects more than others. Questions also linger about its ability to resist disease and retain nutrients through different Indian cooking methods.

The variety reportedly has a mealy texture. In one CPRI assessment involving 64 people, 95% rated its overall acceptability 'good to excellent' and 56% said its taste was very good. This study cohort, though, is too small to generalise the results. CPRI researchers themselves have proposed that kufri jamunia can be used in curries, parathas, soups, baked goods, and dehydrated flours.

Importantly, kufri jamunia potatoes also have purple skin and flesh, which could affect consumer interest. Research on other biofortified foods has already shown that while people are generally willing to pay modest premiums – the national average cost of ordinary potatoes purchased wholesale is around ₹17/kg – whether they accept a new variety depends on its appearance, their awareness, taste, and of course local preferences.



Solving an issue: The variety reportedly has a mealy texture. CPRI researchers themselves have proposed that kufri jamunia can be used in curries, parathas, soups, baked goods, and dehydrated flours. THULASI KAKKAT/PIB

How was is developed

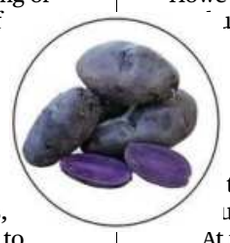
The CPRI team developed the kufri jamunia variety by crossing two potato lines, MS/8-1148 and CP4242, in 2015. MS/8-1148 is high in vitamin C whereas CP4242 had purple skin and flesh. The result, formally called MSP/16-307, could naturally accumulate higher concentrations of specific nutrients as it grew. The team then conducted trials, including multi-location testing, in 2021-2023.

Based on the trial data, the Central Sub-Committee on Crop Standards, Notification and Release of Varieties for Horticultural Crops approved the variety in mid-2024 and the government notified it in November that year. The variety's plants produce 10-12 medium to large tubers each and mature in around 90 days. The purple colour comes from anthocyanins – organic compounds also found in jamun and blueberries.

According to the Press Information Bureau, 100 g of kufri jamunia flesh contains around 42.75 mg of vitamin C (versus 23.15 mg in regular potatoes), 42.05 mg of anthocyanins, 2.28 mg of zinc (versus 0.28 mg), 3.22 mg of iron (versus 0.57 mg), and 161 micrograms of carotenoids. And per the CPRI team's findings themselves, published in *Potato Journal* in 2025, 100 g of kufri jamunia was found to have a range of carotenoid levels, from 15.6 micrograms in Kanpur to 298.4 micrograms in Raipur, during the multi-location trials. Kufri jamunia also contains slightly less zinc than kufri neelkanth and slightly less iron than kufri manik; the latter are other coloured potato varieties developed at the Institute.

Anthocyanins are known to have antioxidant properties, although whether the same benefits will accrue when delivered by kufri jamunia potatoes is not known. And in the absence of similar studies, the same caveat goes for iron and zinc. A 2016 study in *Food Chemistry* examined purple-fleshed potatoes and reported that steaming and microwaving generally preserved more of the nutritional substances than stir-frying did.

A 2016 study examined purple-fleshed potatoes and reported that steaming and microwaving generally preserved more of the nutritional substances than stir-frying did



However, again, research specific to kufri jamunia is not available.

Cultivation factors

Nutrient availability and delivery constitutes one half of a biofortification programme; the other half is determined by cultivation.

At the Modipuram research station, according to the *Potato Journal* paper, the team recorded an average yield of 49.01 tonnes per hectare after three months, across three seasons, whereas subsequent multi-location trials, including at Modipuram, recorded an overall mean of 31.96 tonnes per hectare across north (36.77 tonnes), central (33.79 tonnes), and eastern (25.91 tonnes) India.

On the other hand, at these locations, kufri manik yielded 31.52 tonnes per hectare and kufri neelkanth 36.61 tonnes per hectare. Further, kufri jamunia could moderately resist late blight, a disease caused by the water mould *Phytophthera infestans*, in laboratory conditions but has been reported as 'susceptible' in the field. Late blight is a devastator of potato crops and the CPRI team has already recommended that farmers apply fungicide.

Next, the multi-location trials also produced 29.19 tonnes of marketable potatoes per hectare, versus 33.48 tonnes for kufri neelkanth. So if the costs of cultivation were equal, kufri jamunia farmers could need a 15% premium on the selling price to attain the same gross revenue. (A study published by a CPRI in *Indian Horticulture* in 2020 estimated that, for regular potatoes, the seed material accounted for 40-50% of the production costs vis-a-vis regular potatoes, with a per-hectare seed cost of around ₹60,000-75,000 per hectare.)

Taken together, there are many unknowns about kufri jamunia at this point to assess its overall cost-benefit ratio, including the cost of seeds and disease management, pricing, its uptake in the market, and how efficaciously it will deliver iron and zinc to the population. It would be premature as a result to deem kufri jamunia to be a proven solution to address India's hidden hunger.

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THE GIST

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SNIPPETS

Latest updates from the world of health

Open access to peptides



Reuters

U.S. Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. has pushed forward a policy allowing licensed pharmacies and physicians to compound certain unapproved peptides while regulators consider whether to formally permit their use in compounded medicines.

Published in the Federal Register as Mr. Kennedy's "enforcement discretion policy," it enables U.S. compounding of six peptides, including the BPC-157 and TB-500 – popularly known as the "Wolverine stack" – without fear of FDA reprisal.

U.S. funds for Ebola vaccine



Reuters

IAVI, a biomedical research organisation, said on Wednesday it was awarded $36 million under a U.S. government contract worth up to $99 million to advance development of its single-dose vaccine candidate against the Bundibugyo strain of the Ebola virus.

The number of confirmed Ebola cases in Democratic Republic of Congo has risen above 10,000, government data showed on Tuesday, making the Bundibugyo outbreak the country's largest and deadliest outbreak.

Dutch govt.'s bird flu curbs



Reuters

Farmers across the Netherlands have been instructed to keep poultry indoors following three reported bird flu outbreaks.

"The risk of further infections is significant. To prevent as much suffering as possible for both animals and business owners, I have decided to implement a nationwide requirement to keep birds indoors or otherwise shielded," Minister Silvio Erkens said.

Detections typically increase during the fall and spring, when migrating birds can spread virus to domestic poultry.

How brain imaging offers a crucial window to identify, assess and treat wake-up strokes

Serena Josephine M.

Time is brain, when it comes to the treatment of strokes. But a stroke occurring during sleep may go unnoticed until a person wakes up with symptoms, leaving doctors without a clear timeline of its onset. This is where brain imaging helps doctors identify patients with wake-up strokes and assess the extent of injury to pave the way for prompt treatment. Neurologists underscore the need to seek medical care immediately to ensure timely treatment.

M. Radha, head of department and professor of neurology, Government Kilpauk Medical College (KMC) Hospital, Chennai, said that the prevalence of wake-up strokes is 20% – one in five ischaemic strokes is a wake-up stroke. "This means a person wakes up from his/her sleep with symptoms of stroke. The symptoms include facial drooping, difficulty speaking, sudden vision problems and weakness on one side of the body," she said.

If a patient arrives at a hospital within 4.5 hours of stroke symptoms, then thrombolysis can be done, she said, adding: "However, in wake-up stroke, we cannot calculate the time of the onset of symptoms. We do not know the window. So, acting fast is important. In case of any symptoms, patients should reach the hospital on time."



BE FAST is the acronym to spot the signs of a stroke: Balance, Eyes, Face, Arm, Speech and Time. GETTY IMAGES

Role of imaging

In wake-up strokes, imaging helps give a clear picture for the doctors. "An MRI brain scan should be taken immediately. If it is not available, a CT angiogram should be taken. The scans help us assess the extent of brain injury and blood flow to different parts of the brain. They can determine whether there is diffusion-perfusion mismatch. The difference may represent brain tissue that is still salvageable and can be potentially saved. Like in regular strokes, 'time is brain' in wake-up strokes too, making prompt diagnosis and treatment crucial," she explained.

Shubha Subramanian, senior consultant - neurology, Kauvery Hospitals, Chennai, said that in ischemic strokes, thrombolysis is used to dissolve the blood clot if a patient presents within 4.5 hours of symptom onset. "In cases involving a large vessel occlusion, mechanical thrombectomy is performed within 24 hours of symptom onset, depending on the patient's eligibility. In wake-up strokes, we do not know when the stroke started; it could be at night or early in the morning. What we do next is crucial. This is why we rely on imaging techniques," she added.

"MRI has a lot of sequences. If you compare the diffusion-weighted imaging and FLAIR (Fluid-Attenuated Inversion Recovery) imaging, a mismatch in that shows that the brain tissue is still salvageable. So even if we do not know the time of onset of stroke, we can still go ahead and thrombolyse the patient. In the same way, MRI perfusion or CT perfusion studies will also give us a clue regarding salvageable brain tissue. This will help us in taking crucial decisions regarding thrombolysis or mechanical thrombectomy or whether to go for conservative management," she elaborated.

Under the Tamil Nadu Accident and Emergency Care Initiative and Stroke Care and Rapid Intervention with Plasminogen activator and Thrombectomy (SCRIPT) programme implemented by the State government and with facilities available at the new JICA building at KMC, patients with with wake-up strokes are regularly treated, Dr. Radha noted.

"There is effective coordination between the administration, the emergency department, radiology and neurology departments. We have a green channel in place. As a result, once the patients with symptoms of stroke enter the Emergency Department, the neurologist is intimated. Our doctor goes to the radiology department which has significantly reduced the door to needle time," she said.

BE FAST is the acronym to spot the warning signs of stroke, denoting Balance, Eyes, Face, Arm, Speech and Time. "We do see that the awareness of stroke symptoms is increasing and the referral system has also improved," Dr. Radha said.

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